northward as far as Tungí, a distance of about fourteen miles, the greater part of which is now covered with jungle. His government appears to have been noteworthy, rather as a period of general tranquillity and prosperity than for any remarkable military achievements. Provisions were procurable at moderate prices, and the general state of the country is represented as having been most flourishing. In obedience to the orders of the Emperor Aurangzeb, this Nawáb confiscated the different English factories in the country, and kept the commercial agents at Dacca in irons for some time.

"On the dismissal from the government of the Nawáb Ibráhim Khán, after the breaking out of Sobhá Singh's insurrection in Bardwán, the Emperor Aurangzeb appointed his grandson, Prince Azímu-Shán, to the Nizámat of Bengal. With a view to increasing the revenue, in which there had been no improvement since the time of Sultán Shujá, he bestowed the Díwání upon Murshid Kulí Khán, who had already brought himself into notice in the inferior offices of that department. This official disbanded the royal household cavalry, which were of little use in a low country like Dacca, and resumed the *jágírs* assigned for their support. This and other measures of retrenchment were most distasteful to Prince Azímu-Shán, who strongly objected to the control exercised over the State expenditure. He therefore organised a conspiracy, the object of which was the assassination of the Díwán. The plot was foiled by the boldness of Murshid Kulí Khán, who forced his way through the soldiers that had been hired to murder him, and succeeded in reaching the palace. There he accused Azím-u-Shán of treachery, and challenged him to single combat, which the Prince declined. The Díwán sent an account of the matter to the Emperor, and considering himself no longer safe at Dacca, proceeded to Murshidábád, where he took up his residence. In consequence of this affair Prince Azím-u-Shán was ordered to proceed to Behar. No one having been nominated as his successor in Bengal, he left the government to his son Farrukh Siyar, who made himself universally esteemed by his wise and liberal measures. Subsequently, Murshid Kulí Khán was appointed Názim by Aurangzeb, but he was not formally recognised as such till Farrukh Siyar became Emperor of Delhi. From this time (1704) Dacca ceased to be the seat of the Viceregal government, and the eastern Districts were made over to a Náib or Deputy of the Názim. The *niábat* or government extended from the Gáro Hills on the north to the Sundarbans on the south, and

from the Tipperah Hills on the east to Jessor on the west, thus comprising a far greater extent of country than the present Dacca District. It was considered the highest and most lucrative appointment under the Nizámat.

"The history of the Dacca and neighbouring Districts, from this time to the acquisition of the Díwání by the Honourable East India Company, in 1765, presents little worthy of note. It may be mentioned, however, that the Tipperah territory, the subjection of which to the Mughul Government had hitherto been merely nominal, was annexed to the Province during the Government of Mirzá Latífullah, who was appointed Náib in 1713. The subsequent Náibs appear to have resided for the most part at Murshidábád, the government at Dacca being administered by deputies. The natural consequences of this state of things followed. The prosperity or otherwise of the country depended chiefly on the personal character of the Náib Názim or the deputies, some of whom seem to have governed well and wisely, while others made it their chief object to amass wealth at the expense of the provinces committed to their charge. Among these latter may be mentioned Rájballabh, Peshkár of the Nawárá, and subsequently appointed Deputy-Governor, who is said, during his short term of office, to have amassed the enormous sum of two crores of rupees (£2,000,000). He also acquired a great quantity of land, which afterwards constituted the valuable *zamíndárí* of Rájnagar. Near a village of the same name, on the south side of the Padmá or Kirtinásá, are still to be seen the ruins of the splendid residence erected by this Rájá Rájballabh, whose descendants are still living, though greatly reduced in circumstances. A large portion of the money amassed by this man was conveyed out of the District by his son Krishna Dás, who was supposed to have taken it into Fort-William. It was in search of this treasure, it is said, that Siráj-ud-Daulah was induced to commence hostilities against the English, which ended in their obtaining possession of the country in 1757. With this date, the history of Dacca under the native dynasties virtually ceases. On the establishment of the British power, the representatives of the native rulers were pensioned by Lord Clive, but the empty title of Nawáb was still continued in the family. In the year 1845, the title and dignity became extinct, on the death of the last incumbent without heirs. The pecuniary allowances thereupon lapsed, but a small sum was allowed for the maintenance of the female connections and servants of the late

Nawáb, a few of whom are still pensioners of Government. At the Company's accession to the Díwání in 1765, the administration of the Dacca Province was carried on by two departments—Huzúrí and Nizámat; the former was under the Provincial Díwán, who resided at Murshidábád, and carried on the business at Dacca by deputy. The jurisdiction of this officer comprised the charge of the crown finances, and the settlement of all disputes relating to revenue. The department of the Nizámat related chiefly to civil and criminal suits, and the collection of a portion of the revenue which was assigned to defray the expense of this establishment. In 1769 a supervisor of revenue was appointed with entire control over the departments of Huzúrí and Nizámat. In 1772 the title was changed to that of Collector; and in the same year, on assumption by the Company of the office of Díwán in the place of Muhammad Rezá Khán, a court of Díwání Adálat was instituted, of which the Collector was made the superintendent. In 1774 the Provincial Council was established; Náibs were appointed to collect the revenue, and to hold the court of Díwání Adálat, from which an appeal lay to the Council. In 1781 the Council was abolished, Mr Day was appointed Collector and Magistrate, and a Court of Judicature was established, of which Mr Duncanson was the first Judge.

"The French and Dutch factories were taken possession of by the English in the years 1778 and 1781 respectively. The falling off of the general Dacca trade took place as far back as 1801, previously to which the yearly advances made by the East India Company and private traders for Dacca muslins were estimated at upwards of twenty-five lákhs of rupees (£250,000). In 1807, the Company's investments had fallen to £59,590, and the private trade to about £56,020. In 1813, the private trade did not exceed £20,595, and that of the Company was scarcely more considerable. In 1817, the English Commercial Residency was altogether discontinued." [I find that in my description of Dacca City, condensed from Dr Taylor, these sentences are included, inadvertently without acknowledgment.]

THE MUTINY OF 1857 AT DACCA.—The only political disturbance which has taken place in Dacca District since the English obtained possession of the country was the Mutiny of 1857, In that year the sepoys stationed in the city consisted of two companies of the 73rd Native Infantry. Upon the arrival of the news of the outbreak at Meerut, an uneasy feeling manifested itself among the Dacca sepoys, which gradually increased till the Government found it neces-

sary to despatch a force of a hundred men of the Indian Navy for the protection of the town. The European and East Indian residents, to the number of about sixty, also enrolled themselves as volunteers. This force sufficed to keep the sepoys from any overt act till the 26th November, when the news arrived that the sepoys stationed at Chittagong had mutinied, plundered the treasury, and carried off about three lákhs of rupees. It was thereupon resolved that the Dacca sepoys should be disarmed, and for this purpose the volunteers and sailors were warned to be ready at five o'clock the following morning. The occurrence is thus described by Mr Brennand, Principal of the Dacca College, and quoted from the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division":—

"At the time appointed, there were assembled the Commissioner, the Judge, and some other civilians, and from twenty to thirty volunteers. It was still dark, and we waited a short time for the signal. The plan was, to begin by disarming the Treasury guard, to place the disarmed men in charge of the volunteers; the sailors would then proceed with their whole force to the Lál Bágh; and it was hoped that the men there would have given up their arms without opposition. Everything appeared to go on well; the guards at the Treasury were disarmed before the signal was given for the volunteers to advance. There were about fifteen of the sepoys standing or sitting outside of their quarters, and the rest of them, making altogether about thirty-six, were supposed to be inside the building. They appeared to be very much dejected, and they reproached their officers for subjecting them to such disgrace, protesting that they would have given up their arms at once to their own officers had they only been asked to do so.

"In the meantime the sailors, on reaching the Lál Bágh, found the sepoys drawn out prepared to make a resistance; they had evidently been apprised of our intention to disarm them. The sentry fired his musket and killed one of our men; his example was followed by the others, and a volley was fired on the sailors as they advanced through the broken wall near the southern gateway. The guns had been placed in position in front of Bibí Parí's tomb, so as to command the entrance, and they opened fire upon our men with grape. As soon as the sailors had got well into the place, they fired a volley. Lieutenant Lewis then led them up the ramparts to the left, charging the sepoys, and driving them before them at the point of the bayonet. The sepoys took shelter in their quarters, but they were driven on

from building to building by the sailors. At this time Mr Mays, a midshipman, at the head of eight men, who were under his command, made a gallant charge from the ramparts down upon the sepoy guns; they were soon taken and spiked, and the sepoys began flying in every direction. There was a severe struggle at the end of the rampart: many of the sepoys were driven over the parapet. Mr Bainbridge had also a fall over the parapet as he stepped back to avoid the thrust of one of the sepoys. The sailors obtained a complete victory; the sepoys fled and concealed themselves in the jungle, leaving about forty of their number killed. Many of those who escaped were severely wounded. Our loss was one killed on the field, four severely wounded, since dead, and nine more or less severely wounded. Dr Green, who accompanied the sailors, was wounded in the thigh. He was kneeling down at the time attending to one of the sailors who had also been wounded."

The mutineers fled towards Maimansinh and Silhet, but several of the fugitives were captured, brought in, and executed. A portion of them are said to have ultimately succeeded in reaching Bhután territory.

ADMINISTRATIVE HISTORY; REVENUE UNDER THE MUGHUL GOVERNMENT.—The following is condensed from Dr Taylor's account in his "Topography of Dacca":—The two revenue divisions which comprised the Province of Dacca at the time Bengal was parcelled out by Rájá Todar Mall, the finance minister of Akbar, in 1558, were Bázúhá and Sonárgáon—the former included the city, and stretched eastward from Barbakábád towards Silhet; the latter was chiefly situated on the eastern side of the Ganges and Brahmaputra. The assessments levied by the Mughul Emperors were classed under the heads of *Mahal*, or revenue derived directly from the land; and *Sáyer*, or customs duties levied on nearly every article of trade at the markets and bázárs. With reference to the land revenue, the Bázúhá Division was divided into thirty-two Fiscal Divisions (*parganás*), assessed at £98,792; Sonárgáon contained fifty-two Fiscal Divisions (*parganás*), assessed at £25,828; making a total land revenue of £124,620. The assessment was levied at a fixed rate. In 1722 the Divisions of Bengal, as arranged by Todar Mall, were altered, and formed into thirteen *chaklás*, or military and civil jurisdictions. The Division of Jahángírnagar, or Dacca, included Sonárgáon, Bákarganj, portions of Bázúhá and Noákhálí as far as the river Phení, and also Tipperah and the Sundarbans.

This extensive tract, which comprised an area of 15,397 square miles, was subdivided into a number of large estates (*zamindáris*), containing 236 Fiscal Divisions, and assessed at £192,829. The landed estates (*jágírs*) assigned for the support of the civil and military establishments were computed to comprise one-third of the territory of Dacca. The principal of these estates was called the Nawárá, for the support of armed vessels to guard the coast against the Maghs and Assamese. At the time this fleet was established by the Emperor Akbar, it consisted of upwards of 3000 vessels. The Nawárá estate included the best land, and was subdivided into a number of smaller estates (*táluks*), which were granted to the boatmen and artificers of the fleet in lieu of wages. The second great military estate was that called Amlá Ahshám, and which was appropriated for the maintenance of a force of 2820 troops and artillery for the defence of the forts on the sea-coast. Another estate, called Sarkár Alí, was an assignment to defray the expenses of the Nawáb; half of it lay within the Dacca District. The estate of the Commander-in-chief, and for the support of his command of 2650 horse, lay chiefly in Dacca and Silhet Districts.

Connected with the territorial revenue were a number of assessments called *abwábs*, of which the most important in the Dacca Province were the following:—(1) A fee exacted from the landholders on the renewal of their leases; (2) a fee to cover the expenses of the presents sent to court at the time of the 'Id and other great Muhammadan festivals; (3) a percentage on the original territorial rent, distributed into several smaller assessments; (4) a permanent tax on the land, which was raised by the Náib, or Deputy-Governor, after Dacca had ceased to be the seat of the Bengal Viceroyalty, and which was retained by him as a perquisite of office; (5) the Marhattá *chauth*, a tax imposed by Alí Virdí Khán on the crown lands to defray the tribute exacted from him by the Marhattás. Other *abwábs*, or taxes on the land, were also levied by subsequent Governors.

The second great branch of revenue, called *Sáyer*, was levied at an early period of the Mughul administration. It consisted of duties or customs upon almost every article of life, and of imposts on trades, professions, and personal property. These taxes were collected at all markets, bázárs, and landing-places, and were generally farmed out either to the superior landlords in the neighbourhood, or were placed under the charge of Government

officers, who entered into engagements for the payment of the annual collections. The rate of assessment and mode of collection were not well defined, and being in most cases left to the uncontrolled management of renters and their subordinates, these taxes were generally very arbitrary and oppressive. The most important of them were the following:—(1) A tax on boat-building, varying from 1s. to 2s. 6d. according to the size of the vessel. It was also levied upon all boats arriving at or leaving the city, whose crews were not residents of the District. This proved extremely oppressive and injurious to the inland trade. But it was considered beneficial in leading to the detection of river robbers (*dákáits*); a register of all boats and their crews belonging to the District being kept by the landholders. (2) A tax on all articles sold in the market-place. (3) A tax on the sellers of grass in the city, varying from 4s. to 12s. a year. (4) A tax on persons bringing wood, bamboos, and thatching-grass into the city for sale. (5) A tax upon the makers of shields and accoutrements, varying from 2s. to 3s. per annum; besides the leather and other articles employed in the trade, which were separately taxed. (6) A tax on the manufacture of *sindur*, the red paint used by the Hindus. (7) A tax on betel-leaf sold in the city, and which was regulated according to the fluctuations in the price of the article. In 1773 this assessment was farmed out for the sum of £1844. (8) A tax on the sellers of vegetables, varying from 2s. to 10s. a year according to the extent of their dealings. (9) A tax upon the sellers of paper, at the rate of £3, 12s. per shop per year. (10) A tax on all persons engaged in trade in the city, varying from 2s. to 5s. per year. (11) Taxes on sundry artificers and shopkeepers in the city, including the manufacturers of gold and silver thread and of fireworks, of shell-cutters, weavers of flowered muslins, and gold and silver smiths. (12) A tax on bear or monkey leaders, snake-charmers, bird-catchers, singers, and conjurors. (13) A tax on musicians of every kind. The aggregate amount of this and the preceding tax averaged £450 a year. (14) Taxes on the sale of wood, and on the sellers of dried fish and salt. (15) A tax levied by officers who were appointed to regulate and inspect the weights and measures in the city. As no salary was allowed to these officers, they were allowed a percentage at the rate of 1s. upon every £10 worth of merchandise. This tax was continued for some time after the Company's accession. Besides these duties, which were mostly collected in the towns, other taxes of the same

sort were levied at all the markets in the country. The whole of them were abolished in 1790, and compensation was granted to the landholders for the loss they sustained by their abolition; but as late as 1839 they continued to be exacted by the landlords under the head of ground-rent. No information is given as to the total revenue derived from these *Sáyer* duties. Some of them still survive.

Turning to the expenditure side of the account under the Mughul rule, it is stated that the charges incurred in the collection of the revenue never exceeded 10 per cent. of the amount, and were defrayed by appropriating to the use of the landholders one or more estates under the designation of *Nánkár*, to which the rights of pasturage, fuel, and fishing were subsequently added. The principal item of expenditure was a sum of £9000 for the maintenance of troops. Other disbursements consisted of subsistence allowances, either in land or money, to religious and learned men.

ADMINISTRATION UNDER THE COMPANY.—On the acquisition of the administration of the country by the East India Company in 1765, the general assessment, which under the previous administration of Muhammad Reza Khán is mentioned at £380,000, was reduced to £205,000. At this time the area of the District is stated to have been 15,397 square miles. Seven years later, a settlement of the District was made for five years, for a net revenue of £269,304. Several tracts, including Silhet and other parts, were afterwards separated from Dacca; but at the time of the Permanent Settlement in 1793, the Dacca Collectorate included not only the present District of Dacca, but also Bákarganj and Faríḍpur. In 1803 the land revenue amounted to £125,000, paid by 16,000 landed proprietors. A tax on spirituous liquors distilled and sold in the city was introduced in 1790, when the *Sáyer* duties were abolished. Opium was taxed in 1795–96. The principal items of revenue in 1836–37, after the separation of Bákarganj and Faríḍpur, and their constitution into separate Collectorates, is returned by Mr Taylor as follows:—Land revenue, £43,035; excise (*ábkárí*) and stamp duties, £12,403; total, £55,438, exclusive of the Police-Tax, and the revenue derived from Ferries and the Post-Office. From this time to the end of the Company's administration, I have no means of ascertaining the amount of the revenue at any subsequent period, as the Collector reports that the records have been destroyed.

REVENUE AND EXPENDITURE UNDER THE CROWN.—In 1860–61, the total net revenue of the District, after making all deductions on

account of transfer
total civil expendit
showed a total ne
of £49,803. Dur
1870–71, the reven
diture by 11 per c

The following
expenditure of the
items of land reve
receipts; and on t
cal, jails, postal
charges of the year

BALANCE-S

	REVENU
Land Revenue	
Sale of Government Estates	
Rent of Police Lands	
Málikáná (Proprietary allowance)	
Excise	
Stamp Revenue	
Miscellaneous	
Income-Tax	
Jail Manufactures	
Postal Receipts	
Total	

In order to arriv
establishment of th
The amount prop
£827, 7s. 4d. Thi
tration within the I

THE LAND-TAX

the District Rent
parceners, paying
making an average
each individual pr
Estimate showed 8
or coparceners, in

of property, which is now noticeable in nearly every District of Bengal. The net revenue paid by these 16,688 proprietors amounted to £52,700, making an average payment of £6 by each estate, or of £3, 3s. by each registered proprietor or coparcener. In 1867 there were said to be 9341 estates on the rent roll of the District, and the following particulars with regard to them are obtained from Mr Clay's account in the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division," pp. 52–54:—Of the 9341 estates on the rent roll in 1867, two pay an annual revenue of less than 1½d.; 381 pay between 1½d. and 1s. a year; 571 between 1s. and 2s.; 4554 from 2s. to £1; 2575 between £1 and £5; 495 between £5 and £10; 571 between £10 and £50; 101 between £50 and £100; 79 between £100 and £500; 8 between £500 and £1000; and 4 above £1000. The highest amount of revenue paid by any one estate is £1427, 16s. 9½d., and the lowest only a fraction above three farthings. Of the total number of estates on the rent roll, 7035 were settled in perpetuity at the time of the Permanent Settlement, and 180 have been so settled since that time. Of these 180 estates, 1 had been bought by Government at a sale for the recovery of arrears of revenue; 51 were resumed *lákhiráj* (rent free or lightly assessed) estates; and 128 were *chars* or islands, resumed under Regulation II. of 1819. The number of estates in which Government has sold its rights as landlord is 1350, and the total amount realised as the sale proceeds thereof is £91,160. Of these 1350 estates, 234 were purchased estates; 26 were resumed *chars;* 1 was a *ghair-bandobastí* or newly discovered estate; and 1089 were resumed military tenures (*jágírs*), granted by the Nawábs of Dacca, and resumed by the Government on the extinction of their family. Of the 234 purchased estates, 207 were sold by public auction, and 27 were sold to the owners thereof at a price equal to two years' assessment. Of the 1089 resumed military estates, 897 were sold to their holders at a price equal to twelve years' assessment, and the remaining 192 were put up to public auction. Up to 1867 Government had retained its rights in 506 estates, of which 179 were purchased estates; 4 were unclaimed; 2 were newly discovered; 262 were *chars* resumed under Regulation II. of 1819; 30 were resumed rent-free estates; 12 were military tenures; and 17 were fishing (*jalkar*) estates resumed under orders of Government. The aggregate revenue of these estates amounted to £6699 in 1866–67. Twenty estates only are recorded as held exempt from the payment

of public revenue. Many more exist, but their number is not known. Permanently settled estates are liable to be brought to public auction, for non-payment of arrears of revenue on or before the latest dates fixed by the Board of Revenue for such payments. These dates are, in Dacca District, the 12th January, 28th March, 28th June, and the 28th September. Petty estates paying less that £1 a year of Government revenue are only liable once in the year to be sold for non-payment of arrears; estates paying between £1 and £5 a year are twice liable to be sold; and those paying between £5 and £10 are liable to sale three times a year. In special cases, arrears due from farmers of Government estates are recoverable by attachment of the farm, arrest of the defaulter or his surety if there be one, or by sale of land or other property belonging to such defaulter or his surety. As far as can be ascertained from the Collectorate records, 292 estates have been resumed from time to time up to 1866–67, of which the total revenue amounts to £4167, 12s. A large number of estates were apparently resumed by Special Deputy-Collectors appointed for the purpose. Eighteen tenures which were brought under resumption proceedings were released, the probable assets of which amounted to £196, 10s. In the course of the Survey operations many rent-free tenures came to light. Some of these were resumed, but the greater part were released; because in many cases it appeared that Government had lost its right by lapse of time; in others it was found that the tenures were not revenue free, but formed portions of permanently settled estates, and had been granted by the proprietors free of rent.

THE AMOUNT OF PROTECTION TO PERSON AND PROPERTY has steadily increased. In 1850 there were six Magisterial and nineteen Civil and Revenue Courts in the whole District; in 1862 the number had increased to ten Magisterial, and twenty-six Civil and Revenue Courts, the increase in the latter being partly due to the number of rent cases instituted under Act X. of 1859; in 1869 there were eight Magisterial Courts sitting throughout the year, besides one Honorary Magistrate's Court, and twenty-five Civil and Revenue Courts. The number of Covenanted Officers has not increased of late years; four European officers were stationed in the District in 1850, and the same number in 1869. There are no records in existence showing the number of Courts and Covenanted Officers prior to 1850. The number of rent cases instituted under the provisions of Act X. of 1859 is as follows:—In 1861–62, 4335 original suits

were instituted, besides 435 miscellaneous applications; in 1862–63, there were 2214 original suits, and 643 miscellaneous applications; in 1866-67, 1992 original suits were instituted, besides 1410 miscellaneous applications; in 1868–69, the number of original suits had decreased to 1791, or less than half what they were in 1861–62, while the number of miscellaneous applications had increased to 1356, or upwards of three times what they were in the former year.

POLICE.—A great improvement has also taken place in the organisation of the Police Force within the last thirty years. In 1840 the cost of officering the District Police was £1353, 12s.; in that year there were 190 constables or village policemen, maintained at a charge of £684. In 1860, there were 200 constables, maintained at a cost of £942; the expense of officering the police in that year being £3067. The present Police Force of Dacca District consists of the Regular Police, the Village Watch, and a Municipal Police in the three large towns. At the end of 1871, the Regular Force of the District stood as follows:—2 European superintendents, on a total salary of £1140 per annum; 68 native subordinate officers, on an average pay of £43, 15s. 3d. per annum; and 360 foot constables, on an average pay of £8, 2s. 2d. a year; making a total strength of 430 officers and men, maintained at a total cost of £8552, 14s., including travelling allowances, office establishment, contingencies, and all other charges. The Surveyor-General, in 1871, returned the area of the District at 2902 square miles, and by the Census of 1872 the population was ascertained to be 1,852,993 souls. The strength of the Regular Police of all ranks, as compared with the area of the District, is therefore one man to every 6·7 square miles, and as compared with the population, one man to every 4309 souls. The cost of maintaining this force is £2, 19s. for every square mile of area, or a fraction over a penny per head of the population. Attached to the Regular Force is a River Patrol, consisting of one boat with a crew of nine men, carrying two police-officers and two constables. The annual cost of this river police amounted to £68, 8s. in 1871, including the hire of the boat. This sum is included in the total cost of the Regular Police. The Village Watch or Rural Police, in 1871, amounted to 3068 men, receiving an estimated pay of £6903, paid by the villagers, or an average pay of £2, 5s. a year per head, equal to a charge of £2, 7s. 6d. per square mile, or just over three farthings per head of the population. Each rural watchman has, on the average, 94 houses under his charge, according to the Census

Report. The Municipal Police is a force stationed in the three large towns of Dacca, Mánikganj, and Náráinganj. It consisted, in 1871, of 12 native officers and 251 men, maintained at a cost of £2022, 18s. per annum. Including the Regular Force, the Village Watch, and the Municipal Police, the force of all ranks amounts to 3761 men, being one man to every 0·8 square miles, or one to every 493 of the population. The total expense of the force is £17,478, 12s. The total cost, therefore, of protecting person and property in Dacca District is £6, os. 5d. per square mile, or a fraction over 2¼d. per head of the population. During the year 1871, the police conducted 2084 cognisable cases, the final percentage of convictions to men brought to trial being 53·9 per cent.; the number of non-cognisable cases was 4101, the proportion of convictions to cases brought to trial being 52·5 per cent. In serious cases the police were not very successful; of five persons accused of murder not one was convicted; and in nine gang robberies they failed to obtain a single conviction. The Lieutenant-Governor, in his Resolution on the Report on the Police of the Lower Provinces for the year 1870, observes, "It is remarkable that the three Districts at the bottom of the list in regard to percentage of convictions for murder are Húglí, Dacca, and Nadiyá, all Jury Districts." The value of the property stolen during the year was reported to be £5931, 8s., of which only property to the value of £949 was recovered, or under 16 per cent. of the total value of the stolen goods.

Criminal Classes.—Crime is not very prevalent in Dacca, the chief offences being theft, mischief, voluntarily causing hurt, assault, using criminal force, wrongful restraint, wrongful confinement, and enticing away married women for illicit purposes. In 1868 the daily average number of prisoners in the District jail, as well as the subordinate lock-ups at Mánikganj, Munshíganj, and Mádárípur, was 436, including 8 females, or one person always in jail to every 4250 of the population. The total number admitted during the year amounted to 1575, including 38 women; the average term of residence of each prisoner in jail being 98·82 days. The average daily number on the sick list was 14, the constant sickness rate being 3 per cent. of the total jail population. Sixteen deaths occurred during the year, said to be chiefly among prisoners who were in a hopeless state at the time of their admission. In 1869 the daily average number of prisoners in jail was 465, of whom 7 were females. The total number admitted into jail from all causes was 2272, and 567

prisoners remained in jail on the 31st December 1869. Fifteen deaths occurred during the year. The cost of maintenance during the years 1868 and 1869 was as follows:—In 1868 the cost for rations amounted to £2, 12s. 3d. per head; establishment, hospital charges, clothing, repairs, and contingencies, amounted to £2, 7s. 1d. per prisoner, making a gross total of £4, 19s. 4d. per head. Deducting, however, the sum of £166, 7s. 5d. from the cost of the jail, as the value of the prisoners' labour, the result leaves a net charge of £4, 11s. 5¾d. a head. In 1869 the charge was considerably higher; rations amounted to £3, 11s. 3¾d., and all other charges to £2, 11s. 0¾d., making a total gross charge of £6, 2s. 4½d., or, deducting the value of the prison labour, a net charge of £6, 0s. 1¼d. The articles manufactured in the Dacca jail are cloths of several kinds, such as prisoners' clothing, dusters, fancy cloths for door-screens, tablecovers, rattan chairs, cane stools, country paper, and mustard-oil.

EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS.—An English seminary was first established by Government in Dacca in 1835. Two years later it is described as being well attended, and in a very flourishing and promising condition. In 1841 the school was raised to the position of a college, and the foundation laid of the present building, which was completed in 1846. The College is affiliated to the Calcutta University, and is open to all who have passed the University Entrance Examination. In 1867 the College staff consisted of the Principal, two Professors, an Assistant Professor, and a Law Lecturer. The students pay a fee of ten shillings a month. An English school is also attached to the College, conducted, in 1867, by a Head-Master, assisted by eight Sub-Masters, a *Pandit* for teaching Sanskrit, and a *Munshí* for Urdu and Persian. The schooling fees vary from three shillings to six shillings per month. The other principal educational institutions in the town are the Pogose School, established by a wealthy Armenian gentleman, the Bráhma School, the Boys' School, and the Bángálá Bázár School, at all of which English is taught. There are also two Government Normal Schools, one for training male, and the other for female teachers.

The following table illustrates the progress of education during the fifteen years ending 1870–71. In 1856–57 there was a total of 13 Government and aided Schools, attended by 1449 pupils; in 1860–61 the number of Government and aided schools had increased to 21, and the pupils to 2003; and in 1870–71 the

Government and aided schools numbered 149, attended by a total of 7155 pupils. The cost to Government has increased from £3174, 9s. 2d. in 1856–57 to £3722, 16s. 5d. in 1860–61, and to £6945, 8s. in 1870–71. The amount derived from fees, subscriptions, and other private sources, was £1473, 5s. 8d in 1856–57; £1565, 12s. 7d. in 1860–61; and £4423, 2s. 10d. in 1870–71. The total expenditure on Government and aided schools has increased from £4545, 17s. 6d. in 1856–57 to £5287, 16s. 7d. in 1860–61, and to £11,343, 14s. 2d. in 1870–71. A striking feature in the following table is the smallness of the number of Musalmán pupils. Although the Muhammadans form 56·7 per cent of the whole population, the numbers attending the Government or aided schools was only 8 per cent. of the total pupils in 1870–71. The table is given on opposite page.

It must be borne in mind that this table only includes the Government and aided schools, which are under the direct supervision of the Educational Department. Of course there are a large number of private schools, but those who do not receive, and have no expectation of receiving, Government aid, seldom take the trouble to make returns to the Inspectors, or to give them any assistance. It is impossible, therefore, to give any trustworthy statistics as to even the approximate total number of schools, Government, aided, and private. There are also numerous Sanskrit *tols*, or Sanskrit schools, where logic, rhetoric, grammar, and astronomy are taught. These are principally situated in Bikrampur, which, as regards Sanskrit learning, ranks second only to Nadiyá in all Bengal. English education is making great progress among the Hindu population, who regard it as a *sine qua non* for obtaining any of the higher-paid Government appointments. The vernacular scholarships have also afforded a strong stimulus to vernacular education, and the Collector reports that a school of this class exists in almost every village of the District. Female education, however, does not make much progress. Parents do not object to their daughters being instructed, so long as they do not have to pay anything; but they remove the girls from school at an early age. A few years ago a native institution called the Antashpur Strí Sikshá Sabhá was established for the purpose of advancing female education.

RETURN OF GOVERNMENT AND AIDED SCHOOLS IN DACCA DISTRICT FOR THE YEARS 1856–57, 1860–61, AND 1870–71.

Classification of Schools.	Number.			Pupils.											Cost to Government.			Fees, Subscriptions, and other Private Contributions.			Expenditure.		
				Hindus.			Muhammadans.			Others.			Total.											
	1856-57.	1860-61.	1870-71.	1856-57.	1860-61.	1870-71.	1856-57.	1860-61.	1870-71.	1856-57.	1860-61.	1870-71.	1856-57.	1860-61.	1870-71.	1856-57.	1860-61.	1870-71.	1856-57.	1860-61.	1870-71.	1856-57.	1860-61.	1870-71.
																£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.
Dacca Government College,	1	1	1	38	74	108	1	2	2	4	...	2	43	76	112	1271 0 6	1230 7 6	2931 13 1	100 3 11	90 0 6	671 11 10	1371 4 5	1320 8 0	3603 4 11
Dacca Collegiate School (Government),	1	1	1	305	221	266	12	5	10	25	20	10	342	246	286	1472 18 4	1103 5 4	990 13 8	794 1 0	593 15 7	567 8 0	2266 19 4	1699 0 11	1558 1 7
Government Vernacular Schools,	1	1	1	151	203	131	14	44	24	...	...	...	165	247	155	...	...	60 0 0	1 19 0	60 14 6	43 9 6	1 19 0	60 14 6	103 9 6
Government Institutions for special education,*	1	1	3	95	115	188	...	1	3	...	...	18	95	116	209	245 0 4	1098 13 4	1186 9 6	...	7 15 5	420 12 0	245 0 4	1106 8 9	1486 17 3
Aided English Schools,	7	8	39	696	912	1831	25	43	154	4	13	25	725	968	2010	176 15 0	203 17 3	754 17 6	509 6 7	722 14 0	1702 5 6	595 6 11	927 10 9	2531 19 2
Aided Vernacular Schools,	2	†6	92	72	199	3747	4	20	376	3	...	30	79	276	4153	8 15 0	48 5 0	972 9 1	67 15 2	64 11 1	973 19 6	65 7 6	108 8 10	1940 5 2
Aided Girls' Schools,	...	3	12	...	72	212	...	1	8	...	1	10	...	74	230	...	38 8 0	49 5 2	...	24 1 6	43 16 6	...	65 4 10	119 16 7
Total,	13	21	149	1357	1796	6483	56	116	577	36	34	95	1449	2003	7155	3174 9 2	3722 16 5	6945 8 0	1473 5 8	1565 12 7	4423 2 10	4545 17 6	5287 16 7	11343 14 2

* The Government Institutions for special education consist of, (1) A Law Class attached to the Dacca College; (2) The Dacca Normal School; and (3) A Training School for mistresses.

† In the year 1860-61, detailed returns are not given for two aided vernacular schools, the total number of pupils only being given, and no information as to receipts or expenditure.

INCREASED USE OF POST-OFFICE IN DACCA DISTRICT, 1861–71.

	1861–62.		1865–66.		1870–71.	
	Received.	Despatched.	Received.	Despatched.	Received.	Despatched.
Service letters,	33,782	43,916	37,930	39,644	...	
Private letters,	149,987	316,766	184,675	259,241	...	Return of
Total letters,	183,769	360,682	222,605	298,885	317,223	letters,
Service newspapers,	566	...	1,472	145	...	&c., de-
Private newspapers,	23,288	25,644	21,505	16,865	...	spatched
Total newspapers,	23,854	25,644	22,977	17,010	28,050	in 1870–71
Service parcels,	3,749	1,020	2,214	1,389	...	has not
Private parcels,	1,069	658	1,044	835	...	yet been
Total parcels,	4,818	1,678	3,258	2,224	3,404	received.
Total books,	2,273	1,336	2,295	1,750	4,357	
Receipts from sale of postage stamps,	£742 7 10		£1,121 15 6		£1,357 4 2	
Receipts from cash collections,	£875 6 7		£995 0 3		£1,550 8 0	
Total receipts,	£1,617 14 5		£2,116 15 9		£2,907 12 2	
Total charges,	£1,514 5 4		£1,529 15 10		£3,011 16 2	

POLITICAL DIVISIONS.—Dacca District is divided into three Administrative Subdivisions according to the Census. The population statistics are taken from the Census Report for 1872; Appendix, Statements 1 A and 1 B. The Administrative statistics are taken from the special report furnished to me by the Collector:—

The Headquarters Subdivision, including the City of Dacca, contains an area of 1926 square miles, with 3302 villages or townships, 165,537 houses, and a total population of 1,007,073 souls; of whom 413,293 are Hindus; 585,805 Muhammadans; 4 Buddhists; 7308 Christians; and 663 of other denominations; proportion of Muhammadans to total population, 58·2 per cent.; proportion of males to total population. 50·0 per cent. Average number of persons per square mile, 523; average number of villages or townships per square mile, 1·71; average number of persons per village or township, 305; average number of houses per square mile, 86; average number of inmates per house, 6·1. The subdivision consists of the seven police circles (*thánás*), Lál Bágh, Sábhár, Kápásiá, Ráipur, Rúpganj, Náráinganj, and Nawábganj. In 1869 it contained ten Revenue and Magisterial Courts, and a Police Force as under—4 inspectors, 12 sub-inspectors, 48 head constables, and 486 constables. This includes both the Regular and Municipal Police. The Village Watch or Rural Police, in the same year, numbered 1192; the separate cost of Subdivisional Administration is returned at £3067, 7s. from District funds, besides £1714, 8s. expended by the Municipality.

MUNSHÍGANJ SUBDIVISION was first formed in December 1845. The Census Report of 1872 returns it as containing an area of 446 square miles, with 650 villages or townships, 59,544 houses, and a total population of 459,874; of whom 224,345, or 48·8 per cent. are Hindus; 234,956, or 51·1 per cent. Muhammadans; 530 Christians; and 43 of other denominations. Proportion of males 46·5 per cent. of the total population. Average pressure of the population per square mile, 1031; average number of villages or townships per square mile, 1·45; average number of persons per village or township, 707; average number of houses per square mile, 133; average number of persons per house, 7·7. The Subdivision consists of the two police circles of Munshíganj and Srínagar. In 1869 it contained one Court, a Regular Police of 88 officers and men; a Municipal Police of 30 officers and men, and a Village Watch of 830 men. The separate cost of Subdivisional Administration is returned at £3996 from District, and £206 from Municipal Funds.

MÁNIKGANJ SUBDIVISION, formed in May 1845. In 1872, according to the Census Report, it contained an area of 525 square miles, with 1064 villages or towns, 65,512 houses, and 386,046 inhabitants; of whom 156,151, or 40·5 per cent. were Hindus; 229,370, or 59·4 per cent. Muhammadans; 6 Christians; and 519 of other denominations. Proportion of males to total population, 48·9; average number of persons per square mile, 735; average number of villages per square mile, 203; average number of persons per village, 363; average number of houses per square mile, 125; average number of persons per house, 5·8. The subdivision consists of the three police circles of Mánikganj, Jafarganj, and Harirámpur. In 1869 it contained one Court, and maintained a Regular Police Force of 68 officers and men, a Municipal Force of 40 officers and men, and a Village Watch of 769. The separate cost of Subdivisional Administration amounted to £3742, 11s. to the District, and £27, 16s. to the Municipality.

FISCAL DIVISIONS.—In 1870 the number of villages or rural communes in Dacca District was returned at 2885, containing an estimated population of about 314 souls each according to the results of the Survey. In the same year there were thirty-two towns or large villages which contained an estimated population of two thousand souls or upwards. For police purposes the District is divided into thirteen police stations (*thánás*), and nine outposts. The number of Fiscal Divisions (*parganás* and *tappás*) were returned as 182 in

1870 as follow:—(1) Aglá, (2) Akhrá Khalá Kopá tappá, (3) Alípur tappá, (4) Ambarpur tappá, (5) Amírábád, (6) Amírábád tappá, (7) Amírpur tappá, (8) Aoliánagar tappá, (9) Atiá, (10) Aurangábád, (11) Aurangábád tappá, (12) Azímpur Bangáon, (13) Bághmárá Kásimpur, (14) Bahar, (15) Baikunthpur, (16) Bákípur tappá, (17) Balaur, (18) Balrámpur, (19) Balrámpur tappá, (20) Bandarkholá, (21) Bandar Ikrámpur, (22) Bángrorá, (23) Barai Kándi tappá, (24) Bardákhát, (25) Barbáju, (26) Bhabánínagar tappá, (27) Bhabánípur, (28) Bháwál, (29) Bihrol, (30) Bikrampur, (31) Bírmohan, (32) Bírmohan tappá, (33) Boáliyá, (34) Chánd Pratáp, (35) Chandradwíp, (36) Charhái, (37) Chunákhálí, (38) Dakshín Sháhbázpur, (39) Dakshín Sháhpur, (40) Dánistánagar tappá, (41) Daulatpur tappá, (42) Diánatpur tappá, (43) Dohar, (44) Durgápur, (45) Fathijangpur, (46) Fatullápur, (47) Ganj Sakhrábád, (48) Girdbandar, (49) Gobindpur, (50) Gobindpur tappá, (51) Gopálpur tappá, (52) Gunánandí, (53) Habíbpur, (54) Haidarábád tappá, (55) Hájíkhánpur tappá, (56) Hájípur Gopálpur tappá, (57) Hakikatpur tappá, (58) Hasanábád, (59) Hasanábád tappá, (60) Hásárá, (61) Hávilí Jahánábád tappá, (62) Hávilí Mahmúdpur tappá, (63) Hávilí tappá, (64) Hazratpur, (65) Ibádatpur tappá, (66) Ibráhimpur, (67) Ichhápur tappá, (68) Idgáon, (69) Idalpur, (70) Idrakpur, (71) Ikrámpur, (72) Ináyetnagar, (73) Isakhábád, (74) Islámpur, (75) Itbárnagar tappá, (76) Jafarnagar tappá, (77) Jafarujiál, (78) Jahanábád, (79) Jahángírnagar, (80) Jalálpur, (81) Janárddanpur, (82) Juánsháhí, (83) Kalmá tappá, (84) Kámrápur tappá, (85) Kártikpur Shujábád, (86) Káshtaságará tappá, (87) Kásimnagar, (88) Kásimpur, (89) Kásimpur Kalyán Srí, (90) Kásimpur Sásanbásan, (91) Kásipur, (92) Kátármúlya, (93) Káthorábo tappá, (94) Khalilábád, (95) Khalsí tappá, (96) Khánjá Bahádurnagar, (97) Khánpur, (98) Kharagpur, (99) Khizirpur, (100) Kosá, (101) Khurd Dhámrái tappá, (102) Kurikhái tappá, (103) Mádárípur, (104) Maheswardí tappá, (105) Mahiaddípur, (106) Majidpur, (107) Májampur, (108) Maksúdpur, (109) Maksúdpur Bahádurpur tappá, (110) Mirakpúr tappá, (111) Mirakpur Sháhbandar, (112) Mirzápur tappá (113) Mubárakujiál, (114) Muhabbatpur, (115) Muhammadpur, (116) Mukímpur, (117) Mukundiáchar, (118) Mukímábád, (119) Nandlálpur tappá, (120) Nárándiá tappá, (121) Narsinhpur, (122) Nasratsháhí, (123) Nayábád Talipábád, (124) Názírpur tappá, (125) Nikhli tappá, (126) Núrullápur, (127) Páchbhág tappá, (128) Paril tappá, (129) Pátpasár, (130) Pukhariá, (131) Purchandí, (132) Rádhákántpur Khurd tappá, (133) Rái Nandlálpur, (134) Ráipur, (135) Ráipur

tappá, (136) Rájnagar, (137) Rámkrishnapur tappá, (138) Rámpur (139) Rámpur Nayábád, (140) Rámpur Syámpur, (141) Ranbháwá tappá, (142) Ranjáp, (143) Rasidpur, (144) Rasúlpur, (145) Rasúlpur tappá, (146) Rokandpur, (147) Safípur Khurd tappá, (148) Safíaddípur tappá, (149) Sáhibábád, (150) Sayyidpur, (151) Sájápur, (152) Sákhilí tappá, (153) Sáleswarí, (154) Salím Prataáp Sadrpur, (155) Saráil, (156) Satarakhand, (157) Sháhbandar, (158) Sháhfarídnagar tappá, (159) Sháhujiál, (160) Sháhzádpur tilli, (161) Shaistánagar tappá, (162) Sharífpur tappá, (163) Sibpur, (164) Sibpur Syámpur, (165) Sindurí, (166) Singáir, (167) Sinhdhá tappá, (168) Sonárgáon, (169) Srídharpur tappá, (170) Shujábád Kutabpur, (171) Shujánagar tappá, (172) Shujápur Sájápur, (173) Shujápur tappá, (174) Sultán Prataáp, (175) Sultánpur, (176) Syámpur, (177) Tailpur tappá, (178) Taibnagar tappá, (179) Tálibábád, (180) Telihátí, (181) Uttar Sháhpur, (182) Yárpur.

CLIMATE.—The following remarks are extracted from Taylor's "Topography of Dacca" (1839), p. 13 :—"The prevailing winds from April to October are from the east and south-east. In the latter month, when the strength of the monsoon becomes exhausted, the wind is variable, being occasionally either northerly or westerly, although still more frequently from the east and south-east; and towards the end of the month there is almost always a gale or track of stormy weather from the south or east. In April, May, June, and July there is generally a gentle breeze during the early part of the day and at night. The wind abounds with moisture from sweeping over the surface of the large rivers, and it thereby mitigates the heat, rendering the climate comparatively cool and pleasant at this season of the year. During these months a breeze from the east usually brings light showers, but if a gale occurs, it almost invariably sets in from the same quarter. The south and south-west winds generally bring heavy rain although they seldom blow violently. From November to March the wind is from the west, north, and north-west. The most disagreeable weather during the year is experienced in the months of September and October. At this season the wind is generally light and variable, and the atmosphere becomes loaded with moisture and exhalations. During the cold season the nights are generally damp and unpleasant, but at times the sky is clear and dry, on which occasion ice is formed on water exposed to the air in shallow earthen vessels. In connection with the subject of climate may be mentioned the occasional occurrence of earthquakes. In

general the shocks are slight, but at times they have been productive of great loss of life and property. The earthquake in April, 1762 proved very violent at this place, and along the eastern bank of the Meghná as far as Chittagong. At Dacca the rivers and marshes were agitated, and rose high above their usual level, leaving, when they receded, their banks strewed with dead fish. The shocks were accompanied by subterranean hollow noises, and were so severe that a number of houses were thrown down, by which it is said that five hundred persons lost their lives. In 1775 and 1812 there were also severe earthquakes. In the latter year violent shocks were experienced on the 10th April and 11th May, which injured a number of houses and several of the public buildings in the city and at Tezgáon." The average mean monthly temperature during 1866 was as follows:—January, 68·20°; February, 70·73°; March, 83·07°; April, 81·83°; May, 84·70°; June, 84·55°; July, 83·20°; August, 83·34°; September, 85·00°, October, 81·68°; November, 76·91°; December, 67·56°; mean average for the year, 79·23°. The average monthly rainfall between 1850 and 1865 is stated to be as follows:—January, 0·20 inches; February, 0·46 inches; March, 1·35 inches; April, 7·75 inches; May, 10·01 inches; June, 14·11 inches; July, 14·38 inches; August, 13·68 inches; September, 8·48 inches; October, 7·07 inches; November, 0·74 inches, and December, 0·12 inches; total average annual rainfall for the fifteen years, 78·35 inches. In 1866, the total rainfall was only 65·56 inches.

The Report of the Meteorological Department for the year 1871 gives the temperature for that year as follows:—January, highest max. 83·0°, lowest min. 48·5°; mean 67·3°. February, max. 92·0°, min. 54·9°; mean 75·0°. March, max. 96·0°, min. 57·6°; mean 78·5°. April, max. 93·5°, min. 65·4°; mean 81·1°. May, max. 95·4°, min. 65·8°; mean 81·9°. June, max. 91·2°, min. 71·9°; mean 82·7°. July, max. 89·9°, min. 72·4°; mean 82·6°. August, max. 92·8°, min. 73·7°; mean 83·5°. September, max. 91·0°, min. 74·4°; mean 83·4°. October, max. 92·0°, min. 66·9°; mean 81·6°. November, max. 88·0°, min. 57·2°; mean 75·1°. December, max. 82·6°, min. 50°; mean 68·4°. The monthly mean temperature for the four years from 1868 to 1871 is stated by the Meteorological Reporter to have been as follows:—January, 67·5°; February, 72·8°; March, 79·8°; April, 82°; May, 83·6°; June, 83·5°; July, 83·2°; August, 83·8°; September, 83·2°; October, 81·6°; November, 74·9°; and December, 68·5°. The rainfall in 1871 is returned as follows:—January and February, *nil;* March, 3·70

inches; April, 6·40 inches; May, 17·00 inches; June, 19·30 inches; July, 15·70 inches; August, 6·60 inches; September, 8·40 inches; October, 4·80 inches; November and December, *nil;* total rainfall for the year, 81·90 inches. Rain was measured on 105 days in the year. The year 1871 was an unusually wet one, the average rainfall for the previous ten years being 75·23 inches, or 6·67 inches less than that of 1871.

DISEASES.—In my "Statistical Account of Jessor," will be found a narrative of the great outbreak of cholera in 1817, and which, according to Dr Taylor, made its appearance in Dacca at the same time that it did in Jessor. No information exists as to the extent of its ravages. Cholera and small-pox both visit the District occasionally in an epidemic form. The principal endemic diseases common to the District are the following :—Intermittent fever prevails, especially about the commencement and on the cessation of the rains. Remittent fever is frequent in September and October, and throughout the cold season. Elephantiasis is common, particularly about the city and the Ariál swamp in Bikrampur Fiscal Division. Bronchocele is another prevalent disease. Enlargement of the spleen is attributed by the natives to the practice of drinking stagnant marsh water. Dysentery and diarrhœa are very prevalent during the rains and cold season. The other principal diseases are rheumatism, catarrh, hooping-cough, bronchitis, ophthalmia, cutaneous diseases, and intestinal worms. But little improvement seems to have taken place of late years in the health of the town and District from increased sanitary efforts. The following is an extract from a report by the late Civil Surgeon of the District on the subject, dated 6th April 1868, and addressed to the Sanitary Commissioners for Bengal: —"The sanitary condition of all the towns, and of the District generally, is most disgraceful. Each village is worse than its neighbour in proportion to its antiquity. A village newly settled on an open *char* or plain is as a rule salubrious. It may be more liable to epidemics of small-pox and cholera, but it escapes the constant enervating malarious poisoning which older settlements suffer from. Bengalis are so thoughtless and ignorant of sanitary laws, that with their new houses they prepare seeds of future disease. They raise their houses by digging irregular holes, which become the household privy, cesspool, and tank. To protect their females from the eye of the stranger and to provide shade, they surround their plot of land with hedges, which in the course of time become forest trees. These

trees generally bear fruit, become valuable, and are never thinned. As years roll on, the village becomes buried in vegetation, malaria abounds, the inhabitants are enfeebled and unable to cope with the forest around them, an epidemic fever breaks out, and the survivors migrate to new land, where similar habits are followed, and equally fatal epidemics recur. Such is the true chronicle of a Bengal village, and it is difficult to point to any inland town which has not passed through these successive stages. In the towns of the District, sanitary laws are as completely ignored as in the villages. Cesspools are found on the banks of tanks, or within a few feet of a well; the dead are buried in the midst of the living; the sewage is never removed; the rains convey it into the river, whence the only wholesome water is procurable. Vegetation is not eradicated. Tanks are never cleaned; and the drains which do exist are never flushed, and have rarely any outlet. Privies, if made at all, are constructed near a tank, into which the first rain carries the sewage. Such is an unexaggerated description of the condition of Dacca, and of all the large towns at the present time." Under such circumstances, malarious diseases are hardly to be wondered at. The want of sufficient Municipal funds is the great drawback to proper sanitary improvements, but a great deal has been done since the above report was written; and very recently Khwájá Abdul Ganí, C.S.I., made a handsome donation of £5000 towards carrying out further improvements.

INDIGENOUS VEGETABLE DRUGS.—The following list of the principal medicinal plants is abbreviated from Dr Taylor's "Topography of Dacca," to whose accuracy I have to trust:—(1) *Jayantí* (Æschynomene sesban); the juice of the leaves is an anthelmintic, administered in doses of two ounces. (2) *Sonálí* (Cassia fistula); the pulp, mixed with tamarinds, sugar, and rose water, is used as a laxative. (3) *Soná* (Bauhinia purpurea), purple mountain ebony, the wood being used as a remedy in fever. (4) *Kát karaniá* (Cæsalpinia bonducella); the seeds are used as a tonic, and a decoction of the leaves in cases of fever. (5) *Aparájitá* (Clitorea ternata). (6) *Rakta chandan* (Adenanthera pavonia); the seeds and wood are used in the form of a decoction, and as a liniment in pulmonary complaints; it is also used as an application to the eyelids in chronic ophthalmia. (7) *Khayer* (Acacia catechu); the wood is used in cases of chronic cutaneous disease. (8) *Masáni* (Glycine labialis); this plant is used in the composition of a liniment which is in much use in long-standing cutaneous complaints. (9) *Kála kálkásándá* (Cassia purpurea); and

ointment made of the bruised seeds and leaves of the plant, and mixed with sulphur, is used in itch and ringworm. (10) *Golancha* (Sinospora cordifolia); administered internally and externally in cases of leprosy. (11) *Chitá* (Plumbago zeylanica); the root is used in combination with *bistali* in cases of enlarged spleen, and as a tonic in dyspepsia. (12) *Bichuti* (Tragia involucrata); the root is the basis of an external application in cases of leprosy. (13) *Bákas*, or Arus (Justiia adhatoda), or Malabar nut; the juice of the leaves, mixed with juice of fresh ginger, is given as an expectorant in coughs. (14) *Muthá* (Cyperus rotundus); a common jungle grass, the roots of which are pounded with green ginger, and given in cases of dysentery. (15) *Syámlatá* (Ichnocarpus frutescens); the stalks and leaves given as a decoction in fever. (16) *Bhui Kumrá* (Trichosanthes cordata); the root powdered is given in doses of about ten grains in enlargements of the spleen, &c.; the fresh root, mixed with oil, is applied to leprous ulcers. (17) *Sanki* (Achyranthes aspera); boiled with *nim*, &c., to form a medicated vapour-bath in cases of rheumatism. (18) *Bálá* (Hibiscus tortuosus); an astringent and tonic administered in cases of dysentery. (19) *Nágkesar* (Mesuá ferrea); the flowers of this large tree mixed with oil are administered both externally and internally in cases of cough. (20) *Punar-nabá* (Boerhaavia procumbens); a diuretic prescribed in dropsy. (21) *Nishindá* (Vitex negundo); employed both as an internal and external remedy in rheumatism. (22) *Táraká* (Alpinia allughos); a common reed growing in the marshes, the juice of the root of which is prescribed in cases of hemorrhoids. (23) *Hárjorá* (Cissus quadrangularis); the stalks, mixed with ginger or mustard, are applied to bruises and contusions. (24) *Bágrá* (Eclipta prostrata); the juice used in jaundice and gonorrhœa. (25) *Jiriul* (Odina wodier); the juice is given as an emetic in cases of coma or insensibility produced by opium or narcotics. (26) *Tulsí* (Ocimum villosum), or sweet basil; the juice of the leaves, mixed with ginger and black pepper, is given during the cold stage of intermittent fever; it is also prescribed to allay vomiting arising from irritation produced by worms. (27) *Simul* (Bombax heptaphyllum), or cotton-tree; the flowers are given in hemorrhoids. (28) *Champá* (Michelia champaka); the flower, mixed with *til*-seed oil, is applied externally in cases of vertigo; the juice of the leaves being given in cases of colic. (29) *Nágphani* (Opuntia Dillenii); ten drops of the milky juice of the plant are given as a purgative. (30) *Sephálikā* (Nyctanthes arbor tristis), or Indian mourner; the leaves, boiled in sugar

and water, are given as a diaphoretic in fever. (31) *Jabá* (Hibiscus rosa sinensis); the flowers, infused in cold water, are prescribed in cases of menorrhagia. (32) *Pálitámándár* (Erythrina indica); two ounces of the juice of the green leaves are given as a vermifuge and cathartic. (33) *Akanda* (Calotropis gigantea); the root of the bark is commonly used in syphilis and leprosy. (34) *Sij* (Euphorbia nivulia); the milky juice forms a purgative. (35) *Ishánmúl* (Aristolochia indica); the juice of the roots is given in coughs and asthmas. (36) *Kadamba* (Nauclea cadumba); the bruised flowers, mixed with ginger, form a remedy for fistulous sores. (37) *Maturá* (Callicarpa incana); an infusion of the flowers is given in cases of menorrhagia. (38) *Bhikápurni* (Hydrocotyle Asiatica); the juice of the plant, mixed with ginger, is administered in dysentery. (39) *Jaistha madhu* (Glycirrhiza glabra); the root is prescribed to allay thirst in fevers. (40) *Bakul* (Mimusops elengi); the seeds are bruised and made into a paste, and given in cases of obstinate constipation. (41) *Jám takuri* (Sida Asiatica); a decoction of the leaves and branches of this plant is used as a fomentation in phagedenic sores. (42) *Sájiná* (Moringa pterygosperma); the bark of the fresh root, mixed with mustard-seed and green ginger, is used as an external application in rheumatism; it is also administered internally in enlargement of the spleen and in dyspepsia. (43) *Kunduri* (Coccinia Indica); the bark of the root, dried and powdered, is given as a cathartic in a dose of thirty grains. (44) *Patarchur* (Plectranthus secundus); two ounces of the juice of the leaves, mixed with sugar, is given morning and evening in cases of strangury. (45) *Rakta kambal* (Nymphœa lotus); the flowers and stalks of this species of lotus are reduced to powder, which is administered in cases of discharge of blood from the stomach; and (46) the *Sundhi* (Nymphœa stellata), or species with blue flowers, is used in diarrhœa. The other principal medicinal trees and plants that are found in the uncultivated parts of the District are (47) *Jamálgátá* (Croton tiglium); (48) *Kuchilá* (Strychnos nux vomica); (49) *Nim* (Melia azadiracta); (50) *Dhuturá* (Dhatura metel); and (51) *Bherándá* (Ricinus communis).

Cattle Disease.—The following account of cattle disease is extracted from Dr Taylor's valuable work (pp. 359, 360):—"In the hot weather, and especially in seasons of drought, the well-known eruptive disease called *mátá* appears among cattle, and is often very destructive. In the unusually hot and dry weather that occurred in the months of April, May, and June 1837, it occasioned great mor-

tality among the cattle of the District, especially in the northern division, and also in Maimansinh, where several thousands of bullocks perished from it. Cattle disease also prevailed extensively in 1870. A disease somewhat allied to it prevailed at the same time in the Company's depot of elephants at that station. This disease, in most of the cases, was preceded by the refusal of food and a discharge from the urinary passage, to which there succeeded swelling of the glands in several parts of the body, and paralysis of the hinder extremities; while in others it was sudden in its invásion, the elephant, after a fit of tremor or delirious excitement, suddenly dropping. It attacked males and females of different ages, and under different circumstances, with reference to the length of time they had been in the depot, and to their food, drink, and shelter. Twenty-five died in the course of two months, and of ten dissections that took place, all the bodies presented morbid appearances in the head and abdomen, consisting of a highly congested state of the vessels of the pia mater and effusion into the ventricles, and of inflammation of the mucous coat of the stomach and bowels. In many of the cases blood was found extravasated into the ventricles, and in all of them the cerebrum and medulla oblongata were highly vascular, presenting, when cut with the knife, innumerable points, the mouths of divided vessels. The inflammation of the lining membrane of the alimentary canal partook in some measure of an exanthematous character; it showed itself in circular spots of a livid colour, distinct, well defined, and of a character varying from that of a pea to the bulk of a rupee or shilling. The mesenteric glands were greatly enlarged and indurated with an infiltration of serum around them, and in most of the carcases that were opened the lymphatic glands in the regions corresponding to the axilla and inguen presented appearances of disease like that of the mesentery. Worms were found in all the subjects, and consisted of three kinds, viz., the common filaria and two species of distoma. Of the latter, one of the species was distinguished by a depressed disc situated upon its under surface, between the anterior and posterior pores, and covered with innumerable minute points, apparently the mouths of vessels. The only remedy which was likely to be of any use—namely, bloodletting, was tried in one case. A vein in the ear was opened, but as the quantity of blood (1½ lbs.) which was drawn off in this way was too small to be of any avail in arresting the progress of the disease, the experiment was not repeated." Hydrophobia is common among dogs and jackals during the hot weather.

FAIRS AND RELIGIOUS GATHERINGS.—The large trading fair held at Munshíganj in the month of Kártik has been already described. The first day is celebrated by a solemn bathing ceremony in the water of the river, but after this is concluded the subsequent proceedings have a commercial character. The fair usually lasts three weeks, and on a low computation is attended by about fifty thousand persons. Another fair, which is attended by considerable numbers, is held in March or April at Nángalband. The first day of the fair is devoted to bathing and religious ceremonials, after which shops are opened and a brisk trade is carried on for three or four days, when the attendance drops off and the fair closes. A third fair is held at Mánikganj in honour of Siva, and lasts about a week or ten days. The festival of the Janma Ashtami, in honour of the birth of Krishna, is held in the month of August, and attracts a large number of people into the city. Several other fairs or gatherings are held during the year, but the above are the most important. I have been unable to ascertain whether there is any connection between these assemblies and epidemic attacks.

CHARITABLE INSTITUTIONS.—The Lunatic Asylum is situated at the west end of the town, and was built in 1819. It contains five large wards, seven cells capable of containing four inmates each, and thirty-two solitary cells. According to the scale allowance for jails, the Dacca Asylum is only capable of containing 126 lunatics, but on the 1st July 1867 there were 166 males and 36 females in the building, which was considerably over-crowded; and a new ward has recently been added to meet its requirements. The Districts which send their lunatics to the Dacca asylum are:—Dacca, Maimansinh, Silhet, Káchár, Tipperah, Chittagong, Noákhálí, Bákarganj, Faridpur, Pabná, Bográ, Kuch Behar, and the Province of Assam. The inmates who are tractable and willing to work are employed in keeping the hospital garden in order, carrying water, carpentry, making cane stools, baking, cane-cutting, &c. On an average 73 male patients were thus employed in 1867, besides 35 who were told off for domestic duties. About 26 female patients were employed in cooking, grinding flour, and cleaning the female wards. The remainder were the intractable and idiotic, who do nothing. The establishment consisted of 1 overseer, 1 native doctor, 4 warders (*jamádárs*), 1 female warder, 22 guards, 3 female under-warders, 2 barbers, 1 cook, 10 sweepers, 1 gardener, 2 washermen, and 1 carpenter. The Civil Surgeon of the District is also superintendent of the asylum, and it is inspected by regularly appointed visitors every month. The

average annual number of admissions from 1857 to 1866 was 95, of whom the large majority were afflicted with chronic mania, generally brought on by the smoking of *ganjá* (hemp). The average annual mortality during the ten years ending 1866 was 8·93 per cent.

The Mitford Hospital was founded by a bequest of the late Mr Mitford of the Bengal Civil Service, and was opened on the 1st May 1858. The hospital stands within its own grounds by the river side; the buildings are well planned; the wards roomy, lofty, and well ventilated; the beds arranged at convenient intervals. Excepting in Calcutta and its suburbs, this hospital was said in 1867 to be the best in Lower Bengal. It is managed by a Committee of Visitors consisting of the Covenanted English Officers, and four of the most influential native residents of Dácca. It derives its support from the interest of £16,600 left by the founder, and from a monthly grant from Government. In 1871 the daily average of outdoor patients was 57·42, and of indoor, 58·29. The establishment consisted in 1867 of 1 sub-assistant surgeon, 1 native doctor, 1 compounder, 4 dressers, 1 female dresser, 2 cooks, 2 coolies, 4 sweepers, 1 door-keeper, and 1 gardener. The whole is under the general superintendence of the Civil Surgeon.

The Langar Kháná, or Almshouse, was founded by Khwájá Abdul Ganí; opened April 1866. In 1867 it contained 20 males, 16 females, and 6 children, the majority of whom were blind or lame. A native doctor attends them, and each inmate is provided with food, clothes, and a room. The only condition that a person has to make on admission is that he will become a permanent inmate. After admission he is forbidden to beg. There are no outdoor recipients of this charity.

There are five charitable dispensaries in the District—one at Jaidebpur in Bháwál, established and maintained by the liberality of Bábu Kálí Náráyan Chaudhrí, Rái Bahádur; the second at Jaunsár in Bikrampur Fiscal Division, founded and partly supported by a native gentleman, the Small Cause Court Judge at Dacca, the native doctor's salary being paid by Government; a third at the Sub-divisional town of Mánikganj, the salary of the native doctor attached to it being paid by Government, and the other expenses met by monthly subscriptions. The Bhágákul Dispensary was opened in 1868, and Kálípárá Dispensary in May 1870; at both, the Government contributes the salary of the native doctor in charge, and also a small supply of European medicines free of cost. The following table illustrates the Medical Charities of Dacca, and the amount expended in the relief of the sick in 1871.

STATISTICS OF THE MEDICAL CHARITIES IN THE DACCA DISTRICT FOR 1871.

Dispensaries.	Year in which established.	Indoor patients.						Outdoor patients.		Operations.		Total income.	Cost to Government for salaries, &c.	Cost to Government on account of European medicines.	Income from subscriptions and other local sources.	Expenditure, excluding European medicines supplied by Government free of charge.
		Total treated.	Relieved or recovered.	Died.	Remaining at the end of the year.	Percentage of deaths to treated.	Daily average number of sick.	Total treated.	Average daily attendance.	Capital.	Minor.					
												£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.
1. Dacca Mitford Hospital, . .	1858	1076	865	178	33	16·54	58·29	11,711	57·42	71	12	1278 16 7	542 19 4	...	735 17 3	1421 18 2
2. Jaidebpur Branch Dispensary, . .	...	13	11	2	...	15·38	·01	1,107	5·97	...	65	96 0 0	48 0 0	3 11 7	48 0 0	86 15 6
3. Jaunsár Branch Dispensary, . .	1866	...	...	...	...	...	...	2,221	16·56	2	163	88 18 10	48 0 0	8 0 10	40 18 0	87 7 4
4. Bhágákul Branch Dispensary, . .	1868	3	3	...	...	...	·91	1,876	11·01	8	101	96 0 0	48 0 0	6 7 5	48 0 0	85 19 5
5. Mánikganj Branch Dispensary, . .	1864	...	...	...	...	...	...	2,362	30·54	...	...	27 7 11	6 12 8	3 6 4	20 15 3	28 11 9
6. Kálípárá Branch Dispensary, . .	1870	...	...	...	...	...	...	1,455	15·90	...	...	56 7 1	21 15 9	6 0 6	34 11 3	50 13 8
		1092	879	180	33	16·48	...	20,732	...	81	341	1643 9 5	715 7 9	27 6 8	928 1 9	1761 5 10

The following paragraphs illustrate more in detail the amount of medical relief afforded by the charitable institutions quoted in the foregoing table. The information is taken from the Reports on the "Charitable Dispensaries under the Government of Bengal," for the years 1871 and 1872.

THE MITFORD HOSPITAL is the largest and most important of the medical institutions in Eastern Bengal, and the arrangements for treating the sick, dieting and nursing, are excellent. In 1871 the total number of indoor patients treated in the hospital amounted to 1076, of whom 865 recovered or were relieved, 178 died, and 33 remained at the end of the year; average daily number of sick, 58·29. The outdoor patients receiving treatment in the same year amounted to 11,711, the average daily attendance being 57·42. In the following year (1872), the figures of relief were as follows:—Indoor patients, 1052; relieved or recovered, 795; not improved, 24; died, 176; remaining in hospital at end of the year, 57; average daily number of sick, 47·02. The outdoor patients numbered 12,817 in 1872, the average daily attendance being 58·45. The mortality among the indoor patients of the hospital has always been considerable, amounting to 16·54 per cent. of the total patients treated in 1871, and to 16·73 per cent. in 1872. This, however, is, to a large extent, owing to the fact that all pauper moribund cases picked up in the streets are entered. A municipal pauper hospital for the reception of such cases is a work urgently needed. Within the last few years an attempt has been made to introduce trained native *dhais* (midwives) among the people of Bengal; and in 1870 the Mitford Hospital was one of the institutions selected for the purpose of giving obstetric instruction to females. Three native midwives were accordingly attached to the hospital under the orders of Government, and received a course of training; but the lower classes could not overcome their prejudices so as to permit their females to be treated by skilled midwives educated on English principles, and the experiment proved a failure.

JAIDEBPUR DISPENSARY was established in 1866. It is situated in Bháwál Fiscal Division, in the immediate vicinity of the residence of the *zamíndár*, who takes great interest in the welfare of the institution. There are no villages of any size in the neighbourhood, and the attendance is not large; but *rayats* and others who come to Jaidebpur often make their visit an occasion for bringing with them their sick relatives and neighbours. The hospital subscriptions are

regularly paid, and at the end of 1872 there was a surplus of £32 in hand. The building is kept in good order, with accommodation for indoor patients. In 1871 the indoor patients numbered 13, of whom 11 recovered or were relieved, and 2 died. The outdoor patients receiving treatment in the same year amounted to 1107, the average daily attendance being 5·97. The figures for 1872 are as follow:—Indoor patients, 19, of whom 16 were discharged cured and 3 relieved. Outdoor patients treated, 1093; average daily attendance, 4·16. The prevailing diseases in 1872 were ague, rheumatic affections, constipation, boils, and ulcers.

JAUNSAR BRANCH DISPENSARY was established in 1866. It is situated in a populous part of Bikrámpur Fiscal Division, and is resorted to by patients from long distances. The Civil Surgeon, however, states that this is the only Dispensary in the District that languishes, owing to non-punctuality of payment by the subscribers, most of whom are non-resident. A corner of the Dispensary is screened off to afford accommodation for one indoor patient, but further hospital accommodation is urgently required. In 1871, 2221 persons received outdoor treatment, the average daily attendance being 16·56. In 1872, 2 indoor and 2416 outdoor patients were treated; average daily attendance, 20·15. The prevailing diseases are fevers, rheumatisms, coughs, and bowel complaints. Of late years cholera has been almost unknown in the neighbourhood of Jaunsar; and throughout Bikrámpur Fiscal Division the people assert that the disease has been less frequent since 1868 than they ever recollect it to have been.

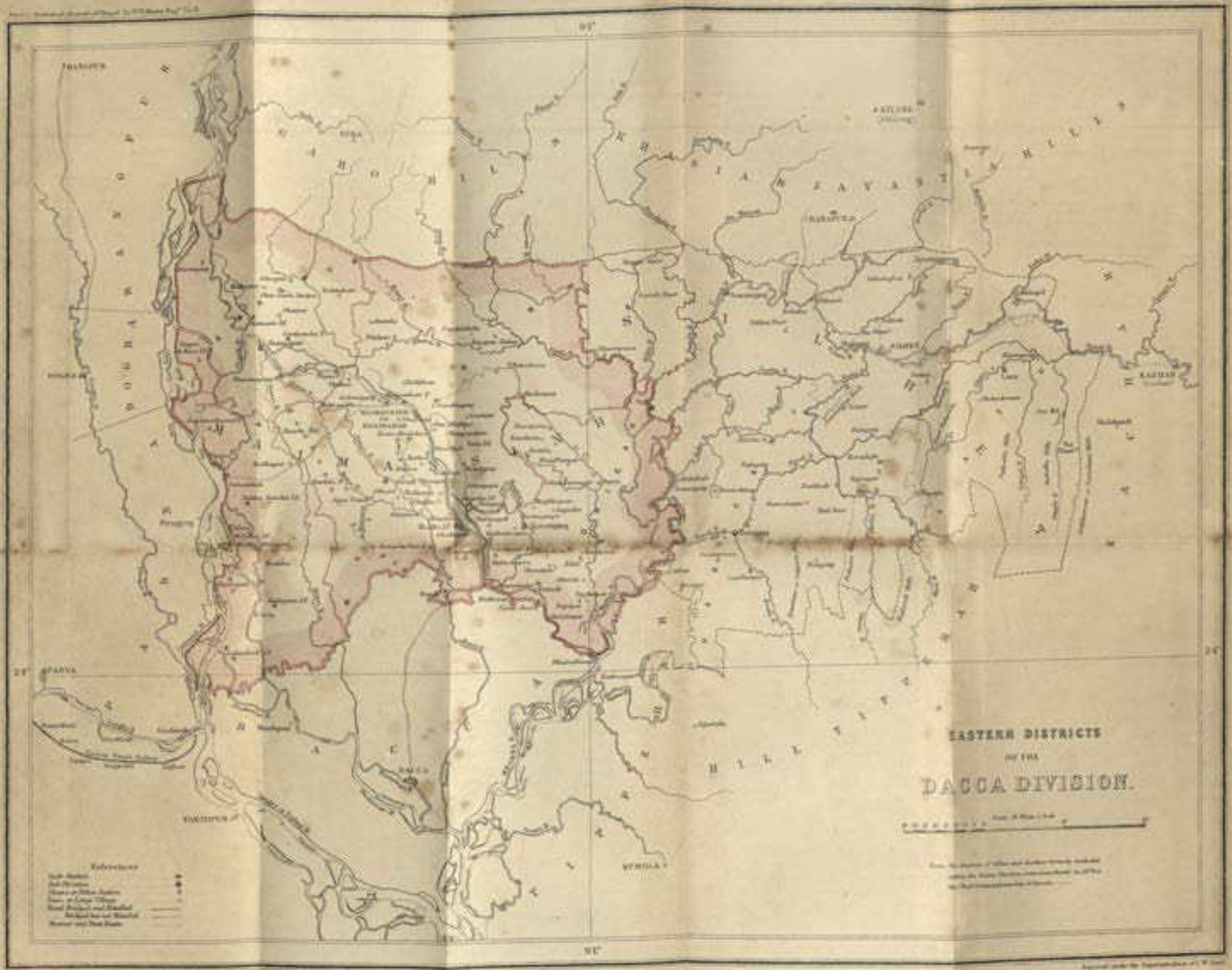
BHÁGÁKUL BRANCH DISPENSARY, established in 1868 in an unhealthy locality in the neighbourhood of large marshes (*jhíls*), and in the midst of a large tract which is inundated for four months every year. The diseases are those generally met with in a damp, unhealthy tract; fevers and spleen diseases are the most common complaints, next to which come diarrhœa and dysentery. There is no separate accommodation at the Dispensary for in-patients, but in an emergency a portion of the verandah is partitioned off and the sick person lodged. In 1871, 1876 persons received outdoor treatment; average daily attendance, 11·01. In 1872, 1 indoor and 2456 outdoor patients were treated, the average daily attendance being 12·16. The financial condition of the Dispensary is said to be good, and the subscriptions regularly paid.

MÁNIKGANJ BRANCH DISPENSARY, established in 1864. The Dis-

pensary is situated in a very inaccessible part of the District, and consequently not very attractive to the people, although the attendance has considerably increased of late years. The surrounding villages, too, are small, and the population generally healthy. Besides, the Dispensary has to compete with two *kabirajs* of great reputation who reside in the immediate neighbourhood, and distribute medicines among the poor gratis. In 1871, 2362 persons received outdoor treatment at the Dispensary, the average daily attendance being 30·54. In the following year the number of out-patients increased to 3348, and the average daily attendance to 35. Want of funds has hitherto precluded the erection of a hospital ward for indoor patients, but it is hoped that this will shortly be supplied.

KÁLIPÁRÁ BRANCH DISPENSARY, established in May 1870, temporarily closed in April 1871, and re-opened in August 1871. With regard to this institution, the Civil Surgeon states as follows:—"The native doctor has many difficulties to contend with in making the institution popular. The large majority of the inhabitants are Kulin Bráhmans, who resent any innovation, and who prefer being treated by the *kabiraj* instead of by the native doctor. Native physicians, with or without education, are numerous, and they secure most of the practice. Allowing for these difficulties, the attendance is good. The country round Kálipárá is, if possible, more insalubrious than Bhágákul. It has one great advantage, however, in being situated on the banks of the Pudda river, which during the rains is eight miles broad. Fevers, rheumatism, and disorders of the digestive system are the most prevalent diseases." In 1871, 1455 outdoor patients were treated, the average daily attendance being 15·90. In 1872, 1 indoor and 2060 outdoor patients received treatment; average daily attendance, 14·19.

MÁLUCHÁ BRANCH DISPENSARY, established in December 1872 out of the bequest of a native gentleman belonging to the village, who left property to the value of £500 to cover the expense of constructing the Dispensary and a road from it to the village. The Dispensary building is of brick, and consists of three rooms—one in the centre for the Dispensary stores and reception of out-patients, and the two side rooms for male and female in-patients respectively. This institution will supply medical aid to a portion of the country which was formerly without any; and during December 1872, the first month it was opened, no less than 1073 patients were treated, the average daily attendance being 103·9.


EASTERN DISTRICTS
OF THE
DACCA DIVISION.

STATISTICAL ACCOUNT

OF THE

DISTRICT OF BÁKARGANJ.

of Dacca and Faridpur, from which it is separated by the Padmá and Mainákátíkhál rivers; on the east by the Meghná and Sháhbázpur rivers and by the Bay of Bengal, which separates it from Noákhálí and Tipperah; on the south by the Bay of Bengal; and on the west by Faridpur District and by the Baleswar or Haringhátá river, which separates it from Jessor and partly from Faridpur.

JURISDICTION.—Previous to 1817 Bákarganj formed part of the Dacca Collectorate, but was under a Judge and Magistrate of its own, whose Headquarters were first at the town of Bákarganj, near the junction of the Krishnakátí and the Khairábád rivers, in N. latitude 22° 32′ 45″, and longitude 90° 23′ 10″ E. This station is now in ruins, and all that remains is a side wall of what was once the Magistrate's Court, and one which probably belonged to the jail. In 1801 the Headquarters were transferred to Barisál, their present seat. The jurisdiction of the Judge and Magistrate, according to a letter of the Collector dated 26th September 1800, comprised the following ten police circles (*thánás*):—Banphal, Khelá Khálí or Kan Khálí, Angariá, Tugrá, Chandiá or Sandwíp, Bokáinagar, Nalchirá Kachuá, Khalsá Khálí, and Baraikaran. The early records show that the criminal jurisdiction of the District was extremely irregular. In 1861 the Baleswar or Haringhátá river was made the western boundary, the whole of the police circle (*tháná*) of Kachuá was transferred to Jessor, and the villages east of the Madhumatí, a local name for the Baleswar or Haringhátá river in the upper portion of its course in the District, were transferred to Bákarganj. On the 1st April 1869, in accordance with the Government notification dated the 16th January previous, and in compliance with the request of the inhabitants, the large island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur and the adjacent sandbanks (*chars*) and islands, of which Mánpurá island is the chief, and which had previously been subject only to the civil jurisdiction of the District, were transferred from Noákhálí. Even at the present day there are several discrepancies between the limits of the magisterial, revenue, and civil jurisdictions. In the northern part of the District some villages of the Subdivision of Mádárípur lie within the criminal jurisdiction of Faridpur, and the civil and revenue jurisdiction of Bákarganj.

THE GENERAL ASPECT OF THE DISTRICT is that of a flat even country dotted with clusters of bamboos and betel-nut trees, and intersected by a perfect network of dark-coloured sluggish streams. There is not a hill or hillock in the whole District, but its scenery

derives a beauty from the wide expanse of cultivation and the greenness and freshness of the vegetation. This is especially conspicuous in the rains, but at no time of the year does the District present the burnt-up appearance of inner India. The villages, which are always walled round by groves of bamboos and betel-nut palms, have a very picturesque appearance; and Bákarganj has many beauties of detail which strike a traveller in passing through it. The level of the country is generally very low, and the rivers, streams, and watercourses are so numerous that it is difficult to get about except by boat at any season of the year. Probably the highest part of the District is the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, situated in the estuary of the Meghná; and at all events, it is easier to travel there on foot during the rains than in almost any other part of the District. Every natural hollow is full of water, around the margin of which long grasses, reeds, and other aquatic plants grow in the greatest profusion, often making it difficult to say where the land ends and where the water begins. Towards the north-west, near Faridpur, and within the jurisdiction of the Kotwálípárá police circle, the country is very marshy; and nothing is to be seen for miles but tracts of unreclaimed swamps and rice lands, with a few huts scattered here and there, and raised on mounds of earth. In the south of the District, along the sea face of the Bay of Bengal, are the Sundarbans. There is a good deal of tree jungle in Srámpur and Uttar Sháhbázpur, but with these exceptions jungle or low forest is seldom met with; and, except in the marshes of Kotwálípárá, there is not much waste land. Speaking generally, the District is a very fertile one, producing immense quantities of rice. The general slope of the country is from north to south, but it is very slight.

RIVER SYSTEM.—One peculiarity of the rivers of Bákarganj is, that, with one or two exceptions, they seldom retain the same name for many miles, and generally take a new one whenever they come to an important town or village. The principal rivers are the Meghná, the Ariál Khán, and the Baleswar, but the offshots from them are almost innumerable. (1) The Meghná touches the District on its north-east corner, near the point where it is joined on its east bank by the Padmá (which flows into it from the north-west, and is considered to be the main channel of the Ganges). The united stream then flows in a southerly direction for about a hundred miles, and empties itself into the Bay of Bengal. During the latter part of its course, this

noble river expands into a large estuary, containing the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur and the other islands which were recently transferred to the District. The estuary has various names, and in different parts of its course is called the Sátbáriá, the Bokáinagar, the Ilsá, the Tetuliá, and the Sháhbázpur river. (2) The Ariál Khán is a branch of the great river Padmá, or Ganges, from which it diverges near the town of Faridpur. It enters this District in the north at Mádárípur, and flows generally in a south-easterly direction till it empties itself into the channel of the Meghná at Mirzáganj, and contributes considerably to the formation of the Meghná estuary. The main channel of the Ariál Khán is about 1700 yards wide in the dry season, and from 2000 to 3000 yards in the rains. It is navigable throughout the year for native craft of large size. It receives a number of tributaries, and sends out several offshoots during its course. (3) The Baleswar or Haringhátá river is also a distributary of the Ganges. It leaves the parent stream at Kushtiá, where it is called the Garai, but lower down it becomes the Madhumatí or Barásiá, which changes to Baleswar lower down where it enters Bákarganj, and to Haringhátá when it approaches the sea. It enters Bákarganj near the north-west corner of the District, at a place called Gopálganj, from whence it forms the western boundary of the District, and runs south, but with great windings in its upper reaches, till it crosses the Sundarbans, and finally falls into the Bay of Bengal as a large and deep estuary, capable of receiving merchant ships of considerable burden. In the whole of its course throughout the District, the river is navigable by native boats of large tonnage, and by sea-going ships as high up as Morrellganj, in the neighbouring District of Jessor. A full description of this river and of its capabilities for navigation will be found in my "Statistical Account of Jessor District." Among its many tributaries in Bákarganj the most important is the Kachá, itself a considerable stream, navigable by large boats all the year round, and flowing in a southerly direction from Kewárí, where it branches off from another stream, for about twenty miles, when it falls into the Baleswar.

The Barisál river is an offshoot from the Ariál Khán, flowing in a southerly direction, but with a very winding course, past the town of Barisál, soon after which it loses its name, and is called the Bíshkhálí, and runs to the south-west, falling into the sea near the Haringhátá. A branch of the Barisál river, called the Nalchití river, flows from a little below the town of Barisál westwards to Jhálakátí, a dis-

tance of fourteen miles, where it turns to the south and takes another name. Another branch leaves the Barisál opposite Nalchití, and flows eastwards till it falls into the Ariál Khán, at its junction with the Meghná. The Khairábád river flows south from the Barisál at Ránihát, passing by Bákarganj and Patuákhálí to Angariáhát, a distance of twenty-two miles, whence it continues as the Nahaliá river by a tortuous course, sometimes running south-east and sometimes south-west, for fourteen miles as far as Patuákhálí; after which it is called the Galáchipá or Rábnábád river, and flows a course of twenty miles, generally from north to south, till it falls into the Bay of Bengal just north of the Rábnábád islands. A branch of this river, called the Patuákhálí, flows west and south-west to Gilábonā for ten miles; then it turns to the south, under the name of the Beghái, for another twelve miles; and then to the south-west through the Sundarbans, under the name of the Buríswar, for twenty-two miles, till it falls into the sea near the Bíshkhálí mouth. The Ghágar rises in the Kotwálípárá marshes, and flows south into the Madhumatí or Baleswar; it is called the Sildaha river in the lower part of its course. The Kumár river forms a portion of the northern boundary of the District, and flows eastwards into the Ariál Khán at Mádárípur.

The foregoing are all large rivers, navigable throughout the year by boats of large tonnage. The confusion arising from the frequent change of name in different parts of each river's course is very great, and makes it almost impossible to give a correct list of all the streams in such a way as to clearly explain the river system of the District. With regard to the frequent change of name of the same river, Colonel Gastrell, in his "Geographical and Statistical Report of the Districts of Jessor, Faridpur, and Bákarganj," page 43, states that "one general name for a river, no matter of what size, is seldom if ever found. The names change continually, and in many parts the villagers on one bank, if asked the name of the stream, give it one designation, whilst those on the opposite side give it a totally different one. Again, entering a *khál* at one end and inquiring the name, it is common to hear the name of the nearest market given to it; but enter from the other end, and ask the same question, and then supposing more markets than one be established along the *khál*, the villagers will give the name of the one nearest their end."

The frequent change of name of the same river is strikingly exemplified in the following list, extracted from Colonel Gastrell's "Geographical and Statistical Report of the Districts of Jessor,

Farídpur, and Báka
to the local name it
by the Survey Autl
(1.) The Kumá
the District, runnir
extending from the
during the dry sea
(2.) Srírkol Do
the Agarpur Nádí,
average width duri
(3.) Amtalá Gá
runs north and so
season, 100 yards.
(4.) Ariál Khá
takes a course fro
average width, abo
2000 to 3000 yard
(5.) Nayárhán
to the Meghná rive
of 22 miles; aver
1000 to 1200 yard
(6.) Bhairá riv
Umedpur Márchá
15½ miles; averag
yards in the rains.
(7.) Meghná r
from north to sou
and 8000 yards in
(8.) Agarpur N
Gáng, following a
age width in the d
(9.) Phultalá
to the Raphiádí
width, 300 yards i
(10.) Kedárpu
Phultalá Gáng, an
average width, 300
(11.) Páncási
nects the Ariál K
the dry season, 40

(12.) KALKINI R
Pángásí Nadí, runn
average width, 100
rains.

(13.) TARKÍ NA
a distance of 4½ m
dry season, 80 yard

(14.) PHÁSÁTALÍ
Khán river to the
width, 60 yards in

(15.) GAJARIÁ R
Khán river to the
width, 60 yards in

(16.) RAPHIÁDÍ
south from Phultalá
at the mouth of th
from 600 to 700 ya

(17.) NALCHITÍ
of 14 miles east and

(18.) BOKÁINAGA
runs a course of 1
dry season, from 2

(19.) CHARÁMUR
course of 12 miles
200 yards in the d

(20.) DÁMODAR
and west for a dist
season, from 80 to

(21.) KÁLÍJIRA
north-west to sout
season, from 100 t

(22.) JANGALIÁ,
Kaukhálí Hát to
to east; average w

(23.) DHANSIDI
Gábkhái river, a
width in the dry se

(24.) GUJALIÁ R
Hát, 16 miles from
yards.

(25.) KÁLIGANG
Hát, 14 miles from
yards.

(26.) KRISHNÁK
a distance of 12 m
dry season, 30 yard

(27.) SHIKÁRPUR
about 12 miles in l
south-west; averag

(28.) JHÁLAKÁTI
a direction from ea
yards in the dry se

(29.) MENDIGAN
west from Lálganj
from 500 to 600 y

(30.) LATÁGÁNG
west of 8 miles fro
to 500 yards in the

(31.) HAILFÁ N
of 8 miles from n
200 yards.

(32.) MOSHKÁT
Madanganj Hát, n
average width in t

(33.) KALINGÁ R
mí char, running a
width, 1800 yards

(34.) ILSÁ RIVE
mí char, running a
width, 2500 yards

(35.) TETULIÁ
Khán river to the
miles; average wi
in the rains.

(36.) BALESWAR
to the sea, runnin
to 3000 yards in t

(37.) BÍSHKHÁL
and running a co
average width in t

(38.) KACHUA ç
north and south fro
in the dry season, 8

(39.) KHAIRÁBÁ
river to Angariá F
average width in th

(40.) PÁNDAB RI
Hát, a course of 2
width in the dry sea

(41.) RÁJGANJ RI
of 15 miles from no
in the dry season.

(42.) ANGARIÁ R
a course of 3 miles
the dry season, 300

(43.) NAHAQÁ R
khálf, a course of
east and south-west

(44.) MURÁDIÁ
course of 8 miles f
the dry season, 100

(45.) PATUÁKHÁ
a course of 10 mil
season, 300 yards.

(46.) BIGHÁI RIV
a course of 12 mil
season from 800 to

(47.) BHÁDURÁ
course of 12 miles f
from 800 to 1000 y

(48.) BURÍSWAR
course of 22 miles
the dry season, 170

(49.) AILÁ RIVE
a course of 14 mil
season, 1700 yards.

(50.) KHÁG DON
course of 14 miles
the dry season, and

(51.) GALÁCHIPÁ

course of 20 mile
season from 700 t
(52.) ANDHÁRM
sea, a course of 2
dry season from 4
(53.) AMUÁ DO
14 miles from eas
yards.
(54.) TAGRÁ D
course of 3 miles f
from 60 to 70 yard
(55.) SAPLÁJÁ D
a course of 12 mi
season, 80 yards.
(56.) HALTÁ D
darbans, a course
the dry season, 10
(57.) CHARKHÁ
Angariá, a course
the dry season, 50
(58.) KRISHNA
Mirzáganj, a cour
average width in t
(59.) BÍSHKHÁL
a course of 14 mil
the dry season fro
(60.) DHULIÁ
course of 6 miles
the dry season, 20
(61.) ALGÍ GHA
uárá Hát to the T
south ; average wi
The whole of t
out the year by na
TIDES.—All the
from two sources ;
of Bengal on the s
at high tide for co
narrow for large b
are too shallow at

able in the estuary of the Meghná, and many of the channels and creeks in the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, which are almost dry at ebb tide, contain eighteen or nineteen feet of water at the flood. It is impossible to give even a rough estimate of the number of rivers navigable by native boats of two tons burden during the rains, but the Collector thinks that there is not a single watercourse in the whole District which is not navigable by boats of this size at high water during the rainy season. In the rains nearly the whole country is under water, and the same often occurs in many places during a high spring tide. Almost every peasant has his boat, which he uses once or twice every week to take him to market.

THE BORE.—There is a very strong "*bore*" at spring tides in the estuary of the Meghná, and at that season the boatmen will hardly venture out into the big river. The Collector of the District states that he was once detained for two or three days from this cause on the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, and forced to patiently contemplate from the shore the great wave rushing up the estuary in a mass of fourteen or fifteen feet high. There are in fact two bores, one called by the natives the Chittagong bore, and the other the Daliá bore. The first passes up the channel between Sandwíp and the mainland, turns westward round the north of that island, and then flows to the south along the east side of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, where it is met about half way down by the Daliá bore, which turns it back again. The Daliá bore rushes up the east side of Dakshín Sháhbázpur between it and Háthiá island, and is an hour or so in advance of the Chittagong tide. This bore, on its way up the coast of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, enters all the watercourses or creeks in the island, and is very perceptibly felt at Daulat Khán some distance in the interior. According to the natives, loud noises like thunder are often heard far out at sea at about the time the bore comes in. The bore is dangerous to boats in shallow water, and the Collector conjectures that the difference in the levels of the estuary may be a main cause of its occurrence; as wherever the water is shallow, the bore rises up like a wall and sweeps everything before it, while in deep water it is not very perceptible.

ALLUVION AND DILUVION are constantly taking place, especially towards the east, where the District is washed by the great stream of the Meghná. On the north and east of the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur the land is being rapidly cut away; and every year many homesteads, with their groves of betel-nut and cocoa-nut

palms, fall into the river. The north-east of the island presents a very desolate appearance from this cause; all along the shore are seen deserted homesteads, fruit trees fallen down and half submerged, and the broken sides of tanks which have become useless from the entrance of the salt water. On the other hand, large alluvial accretions are being formed in the estuary, and about the mouth of the river, the names of many of which, such as Alexander char, Falcon char, Brown char, Drummond char, Victoria char, Lord Hardinge's char, &c., indicate their recent origin.

CHANGES OF RIVER COURSES, &c.—The river Nayábhángí (literary, newly broken), also called the Harináthápur river, which connects the Ariál Khán and Meghná rivers, is, as its name implies, a new channel, said to have been formed by the Meghná in a single night in the year 1794. This channel is now silting up. The river Padmá or Ganges formerly flowed through this District before the sudden opening out of the Kirtinásá, and its old bed is still visible in the north-east of the District, within the jurisdiction of the Police outpost of Burirhát. Beyond these instances, no precise information exists of any sudden change in the course of a river. The banks of the rivers are generally low and flat, and more like the banks of canals than of rivers. They have seldom much slope, but in some cases the bank is high and abrupt, while on the other side it is low. Several large islands are formed by the estuary of the Meghná, of which the most important within the jurisdiction of Bákarganj are Dakshín Sháhbázpur, Mánpurá, Bhádurá, and Rábnábád islands. None of the larger rivers are fordable at any season of the year, but the small creeks and water-courses are often fordable at low tide. However, as there are hardly any roads, and everybody has his own boat, the absence of fords is not of much consequence.

LAKES, MARSHES, &c.—There are no lakes in Bákarganj, in the sense of large clear sheets of fresh water, but there are numerous marshes or *bils* in the north-western tracts, as well as in other parts of the District. Such *bils* are often of great size and depth, abounding in fish, and, during the rainy season, widely overspread the land. The following is a list of the principal of these marshes, with their estimated ordinary area:—(1) Adampurá, area 2·51 square miles; (2) Ashkár, 5·60 square miles; (3) Bághiá, 30·39 square miles; (4) Balbárídaluá, 39·45 square miles; (5) Baldiá, 18·90 square miles; (6) Bámá, 8·22 square miles; (7) Dupurá, 6·90 square

miles; (8) Daumrá, 3·25 square miles; (9) Dharindi, 1·42 square miles; (10) Hartá, 9·45 square miles; (11) Janjharia, 8·25 square miles; (12) Kaláreja, 5·65 square miles; (13) Rámsil, 21·61 square miles; (14) Rámpur Chihariá, 19·4 square miles; (15) Sálti, 24·71 square miles; and (16) Sujá, 2·21 square miles. A peculiar circumstance with regard to some of these marshes is thus described in Colonel Gastrell's Report:—"In some of the swamps, especially in those of Bákarganj, the surface growth of aquatic plants, mixed with drift weeds, grasses, and rice stalks, increase annually, and in process of time a crust is formed capable of supporting human beings, and on which rice is cultivated. Small floating patches are thus formed, and the natives assert that in very strong winds these are sometimes carried from one side of the swamp to the other, and are a cause of great dispute. This story was corroborated by a Government official, whose duties often took him into these swamps. He mentioned also, that the first time he found himself on ground of this kind, and being totally unaware of its nature, he was greatly alarmed at feeling, as he thought, the earth moving beneath him; and still more astonished when, on seeking information from the inhabitants, he was told 'it was only the tide coming in.' It is not uncommon for the owners of these floating fields to make holes through them, and catch the fish which may be in the neighbourhood, and which are immediately attracted by the light."

CANALS, &c.—The following is a list of the principal artificial watercourses in the District:—(1) Mánik Mudí Khál, in Idalpur Fiscal Division, and to the east of the town of Barisál. It is about five miles in length, and runs from north to south, connecting the Durgápur and Nehálganj rivers, one end being at Jidalun village and the other at Nehálganj. This khál, which is silting up, and now only navigable in the rains, was cut by one Mánik Mudí, the founder of the present family of the landholders of Madhabpasá. (2) The Lákhutiá Khál, running from Barisál northwards to Lákhutiá, about six miles in length, was cut by Ráj Chandra Rái of Lákhutiá. It is only navigable in the rainy season. (3) A very important watercourse has recently been constructed in the Kotwálípárá police circle, within the subdivision of Mádáripur, at the expense of the Narál landholders of the neighbouring District of Jessor. It is nine or ten miles in length, and runs from the Bághá *bil* through Digháliá in a southerly direction, falling into the Ghágar river near the Kotwálípárá police station. It was constructed partly for navigation, and partly as

a means of draining the swamps. It is not navigable during the dry season. (4) Besides the above, an attempt was made some years ago to connect the Daulat Khán Khál and Bholá Khál in the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, but the project was not completed; the channel is only navigable in the rains, and then only by small boats. The Canals Act has been introduced into Bákarganj, and four toll-stations have been established, from which a considerable revenue is derived, but nothing has yet been done by Government towards excavating or deepening any of the channels. In the year 1869, 655 deaths from drowning were reported to the Police authorities, but it is very doubtful whether the figures represent the total loss of life from this cause. The most frequent cause of drowning is the falling of children into the deep moats which surround nearly every house.

River Traffic.—The towns and villages are all situated on the banks of a river or stream, but the only large town in the District is Barisál. The principal places inhabited by a large community living by river traffic are the following:—(1) Nalchití, on the river of the same name; the principal imports being salt, tobacco, oil, and sugar; and the chief exports rice and betel-nuts. (2) Mahárájganj, or Jhálakátí, on the Jhálakátí Khál; the imports and exports are the same as those at Nalchití, with the addition that it is a large market for the sale of timber, especially *Sundrí* wood. (3) Mádárípur, on the Kumár, principally exports jute; its imports are tobacco and oil. (4) Sáhibganj, on the river of the same name, principally exports rice, molasses, and *Sundrí* wood, and imports salt, oil, tobacco, and pulses. (5) Daulat Khán, in the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, principally exports betel-nuts. The staples of Bákarganj District, which are the principal support of the river traffic, are rice, cocoa-nuts, and betel-nuts, among the exports; the chief import is salt. The sole use to which the rivers are put is for the purposes of navigation. Irrigation is scarcely known, but a small watercourse is occasionally dammed up for this purpose. The water of the rivers is nowhere utilised as a motive power for turning machinery, although the Collector reports that in the rains they have a strong enough current to admit of their being used in this way.

Fisheries.—There are no regular fishing towns or villages in the District, but most villages contain one or two fishermen's houses. The Collector, in 1871, stated that the number of professional fishermen in the District is not very great, but nearly every man fishes on his own account, either by net or rod, whenever he has leisure,

and this contributes a good deal to his maintenance. The Census Report of 1872 returns the number of fishing and boating castes in Bákarganj District at 20,628, or ·87 per cent. of the population. This, however, is exclusive of Muhammadan fishermen, and as the Musalmáns outnumber the Hindus by nearly two to one, there is a serious element of error in these figures. The principal Government fishery in the District is in the Kotwálípárá marshes; it was farmed out in 1869 for £248. Most of the fisheries in the District were taken possession of by Government some years ago, but afterwards relinquished. Fish are caught with nets, hooks, traps, and snares of numerous sorts. The local names for the principal sorts of nets (the mesh varying in size from less than a quarter of an inch upwards), are as follow:—*ber jál, jháki jal, nánglá jál, uther jál, bisál jál, poná jál, sande jál, mai jál, khorá jál.* The principal traps or snares used are the following:—*chaí, hochá, pola, koch, tetá,* and *jhop.*

MARSH RECLAMATION AND CULTIVATION.—Little has been done towards embanking rivers and marshes with a view to their reclamation and the extension of cultivation. The most important step that has been recently taken in this direction was the cutting of the canal before alluded to, by the Narál landholders—a work which will have the effect of reclaiming much of the Kotwálípárá marshes. The banks of the rivers and the marshes produce large quantities of reeds, which are used in making mats. Long-stemmed rice is extensively cultivated in the swamps and marshy lands. These marshes usually dry up in March or April, at which time the land is ploughed. When the rain sets in, the paddy stem shoots up with the rise of the water. Any sudden rise of water to such a height that the growth of the plant is unable to keep pace with it, destroys the crop. Long-stemmed rice can be cultivated in water to the depth of eighteen or twenty feet, but the seed must be sown when the marshes are dry, or nearly so, before the rains set in. Colonel Gastrell speaks of a stem of this variety of rice which he himself saw, and which was upwards of thirty feet long. No increase to the length of the stem of this variety of rice appears to have been effected by improved cultivation. The names of the various kinds of long-stemmed rice grown in the District are as follow:—Pakshiráj, Kálámánik, Lakshmíbilás, Ráendá, Botar, Káchkalam, Pittaráj, Lepá, Khaiámugrí, Nethpásá, Bhojánkarpur, Dalkachu, Chináisá, Báirákálá,

Kálámaná, Káláurá, Betak, Nepurkáni, Hansámat, Nalaj, Sítábhog, Chhatrabhog, Mátichául, Kumrágair, Dudhkalam, and Ghrita Sáil.

LINES OF DRAINAGE.—Although the District is widely overspread with swamps, the water finds numerous exits in the shape of watercourses and channels. With regard to this subject, the following paragraphs are extracted from a paper on the "Physical Characteristics of Bákarganj," which appeared in vol. xxxix. No. 78, of the *Calcutta Review*:—"Although in a District so essentially flat, a complete system of natural drainage would scarcely be looked for, we find that, in fact, the whole District, except where the great Meghná and Arial Khán rivers have obliterated the old features of the country by recent deposits over its northern and eastern portions, may be divided into distinct drainage districts, each of them containing corresponding features. In undulating tracts of country, the drainage ordinarily radiates from elevated centres towards the circumjacent coast-line. In alluvial formations, on the contrary, owing to the excess of deposit on the edges, the water flows inwards from an elevated surrounding and enclosing ridge to a central basin, from whence it is conducted to the exterior, along watercourses piercing through this surrounding ridge, And this order is followed, not merely in tidal Districts like Bákarganj, but in all alluvial formations, however elevated, as, for example, in Silhet.

"Each of the drainage circles or districts of Bákarganj possesses its central basin or reservoir of swamp, towards which the surface slopes in every direction from the exterior. On the exterior edge of the area, where it abuts on the large tidal rivers (which everywhere divide one drainage circle from another), the land is well raised and covered with villages. The intermediate space is covered with rice cultivation, and the centre is a lake or *bil*, varying in size and depth with the season of the year. From points not very far from the centre of this *bil* or marsh, and quite submerged in the rains, numerous little watercourses proceed in every direction towards the edge. These can only be recognised by the fact that a current flows along them, and by the narrow submerged rims of deposited earth which enclose them on either side, and partially separate them from the *bil* proper. Beginning almost in nothing, many combine to form others, which, though still within the *bil*, and with banks concealed by its waters, present more defined features. At last, by the coalescence of many, a watercourse is formed, with banks which, though but a few feet wide, and sloping rapidly towards the *bil* water, rise in

the cold weather above the swamp's surface. After further convergence of such channels, we find ourselves in a *khál* of moderate dimensions, with banks which are not submerged except in the height of the rains; but we are still many stages from the great rivers whose banks are permanently above the water, and which are some hundreds of yards in width. It is useless to particularise further. The numerous *khálś* which originate in the depths of the central reservoir terminate in some two or three considerable channels, which open into the main watercourse. Between this latter and the *bil* there is no water communication, except through these two or three channels and their ramifications. Even if a short cut were artificially made direct into the *bil*, it would, in a few rainy seasons, by sucking in at the ebb tide the water from all directions, create for itself a branched system of terminations under water, which, in the dry weather, would be exposed to view. The whole system depends on the principle that inundating waters, if in a position to lay down deposits, do so chiefly upon their actual banks, and thus tend to shut themselves off from the tract of submerged country beyond. As the banks rise, the rush of water over them at ebb and flood is intensified, and at length bursts open channels of communication. These throw up enclosing banks in their turn, which process gives birth to new connecting channels piercing these new banks, and the process is repeated till the communicating channels become so small as scarcely to be noticed.

"It is obvious that in this manner the drainage of flat surfaces is performed in the most effectual manner. In undulating or mountainous countries, the drainage derives sufficient force from gravity to maintain the channels open, but in alluvial flats the slow passage of the water would scarcely suffice. If in a tidal District the drainage channels merely flowed from the interior of each patch of land towards the circumference, they would soon fill with sediment brought in by the tide, which would ebb and flow in them with but slight velocity; but where these channels are the only means of communication between two considerable bodies of water constantly differing from each other in level, an adequate rate of speed is maintained. In the rainy season, the drainage reservoirs are connected much more directly with the exterior than during the remainder of the year. The water from various causes stands at an average at least six feet higher than in the dry season, and completely submerges all the interior articulations of the system of relieving channels. Only

the larger and more external have their banks above the water; the smaller feeders are supplied both from their extremities and over their own banks. The greater volume of water which then requires passage is thus amply provided for; whilst in the dry weather, when the drainage volume is weak, the water is unable on account of the fall in its level to leave the reservoir except through the extreme ends of very small channels. The banks of the different classes or grades of channels, each in turn, begin to fulfil their proper functions as the level decreases, and in this manner the water-way is always exactly proportioned to the volume to which it is required to give passage. In Districts of alluvium raised above tidal influence, the rise and fall of the rivers during the rainy season produces similar effects. The water in the swamps being only connected with these by narrow channels piercing the banks of the rivers, is always, unless the river remains very long at exactly the same level, either above or below that level, and the channels are incessantly occupied in restoring the balance.

"The swamps, or drainage reservoirs, are themselves an interesting feature in the physical geography of Bákarganj. They vary greatly in size, in accordance with the area of the tract they drain, and the amount of *filling up* which they have undergone. In the eastern portion of the District, the alluvium from the Meghná has completely obliterated the natural drainage organisation, which has become enveloped in one uniform mound sloping towards the west, and forming the right bank of this immense watercourse. In the west of the District, where the system of natural drainage prevails which we have endeavoured to describe, the swamps during the rainy season fill up the whole of each drainage tract, except its extreme margin, and the banks of the primary channels which penetrate that margin. In the dry weather they are reduced till they form only the nucleus or central portion from which the relieving channels take their rise. . . . From the *bil* on every side the country rises with considerable slope, the first firm ground being generally found in the watercourses. The drainage towards the *bil* is along successive terraces of rice fields, each a few inches lower than the next above it. The water is retained in the higher ground for cultivation by means of the little *hirás* or banks (here constructed of straw as well as earth), common throughout Bengal. It may be repeated that all the surface drainage of the tract surrounding each *bil* flows towards it, and never into the penetrating channels, whose banks are invariably

higher than the ground outside, and always slope away from the channel."

MINERALS, &c., &c.—There are no mineral products, with the exception of salt. This can be extracted very easily from the soil in most parts of the District, and is a frequent cause of breaches of the Salt Laws. In some of the islands in the Meghná estuary, the ground is quite white in the dry season from salt efflorescence. The only natural phenomenon in the District is a meteorological one, and is called the "Barisál Guns." It is a singular loud sound, resembling the distant discharge of artillery, which is heard in the south of the District, and especially during the rains. A paper was read on the subject by Bábu Gaur Dás Basákh before the Asiatic Society some years ago, and more recently the Society's attention was again called to the matter by a correspondent in the *Englishman;* but no one has yet come forward with a satisfactory explanation of the cause of this curious phenomenon. The statement that it is caused by the action of the waves on the sea-shore seems hardly tenable, as the sound is heard far inland, at such a distance from the coast as would preclude the possibility of this explanation; sometimes indeed as far north as Faríd pur. No caverns or hot springs are situated in Bákarganj.

JUNGLE PRODUCTS.—The only forests in the District are situated in the southern tracts. They produce many varieties of timber and an abundant supply of firewood. The following are the principal varieties, and the use to which the timber is put. The list and Latin names are taken on the authority of Colonel Gastrell's Report:—(1) Gáb (Diospyros embryopteris); an extract from its fruit is applied as a covering for native boats as a preservative against decay and sea-worms. (2) Haritaki (Terminalia chebula), the gall-nut tree; the fruit and galls are much used by dyers; with a mixture of alum and galls they obtain a yellow, and with ferruginous mud, an excellent black. (3) Sundrí (Heritiera minor); a strong wood used for a variety of purposes; large quantities are exported to the Calcutta market as firewood. (4) Pasur; used for the manufacture of native furniture. (5) Keorá (Sonneratia apetala); used for platforms, making boxes, &c. (6) Kirpá (Lumnitzera racemosa); used for making small boats, for posts, rafters, &c., of houses, and in Calcutta as firewood. (7) Bairi (Zizyphus jujuba). (8) Karái; used for posts, &c. (9) Aunsir; used for making posts, &c. (10) Garán (Ceriops Roxburghianus); the timber is used for making posts, and

the bark for tanning. (11) Sonálí; the timber is used for making posts, and the bark for tanning purposes. (12) Jin; firewood. (13) Lohákhairá; firewood. (14) Phulsi; firewood. (15) Singiá; firewood. (16) Cháilá; firewood. (17) Kánkrá (Bruguiera rheedii); firewood; a hard and durable wood. (18) Náringá; used for making the handles of billhooks, axes, and spades or mattocks. (19) Bali; firewood; the inner bark also yields a strong fibre. (20) Urián; used for making small boats, platforms, &c. (21) Gámbhár; used for native drums, picture-frames, &c. In addition to the above are the following small trees and shrubs:—(22) Archaká (Sonneratia acida); a good firewood. (23) Bhorá (Rhizophora mucronata); a durable wood of a dark red colour. (24) Jádupáling (Salicornia Indica); a shrub from which the natives obtain barilla for soap. (25) Boáli; used for the same purpose as the above. (26) Hentál (Phœnix paludosa); the young trees are used for making walking-sticks, the older trees being made up into rafters for huts; the leaves are used for thatching. (27) Karanjá; the wood is used as fuel, and for making charcoal; the oil of the fruit is used for medicinal purposes. I have had to trust to Colonel Gastrell's Report for the Latin names. The woodcutters have a prescriptive right to the timber of these forests, and the late Commissioner of the Sundarbans reported that although they have no right to cut forest trees, they have always been permitted the privilege of doing so, and the timber is cut by woodcutters without a license. No forest conservancy exists in the Sundarbans, nor is any deemed necessary. Among the wild vegetable productions of marketable value in the District, the most important is the *hoglá* reed, which is extensively used for making mats. Thatching grass grows wild, but is never cultivated; a fence is simply put round it to keep out cattle. The fine Sítalpátí mats are manufactured from the bark of a reed called *partiá*; the chief seat of the manufacture is at Rangsrí village, within the Bákarganj police circle. In the southern forests bordering on the Sundarbans an annual revenue of about £11 is realised as license for the right of collecting honey and wax. The new *chars*, especially the Falcon *char* and Alexander *char*, are used as pasturage grounds. Many estates in Dakshín Sháhbázpur are let out on what is called a *gorkáti* settlement, and are used as grazing tracts for cattle and buffaloes.

FERÆ NATURÆ.—The principal wild animals of the District are tigers, leopards, buffaloes, and wild hogs. The rewards paid for the

destruction of wild animals are £1 per head for tigers, and 10s. per head for leopards. Formerly the rewards paid for this purpose were half of those paid now; and the Collector states that even the amount paid at present is insufficient to reimburse the huntsmen for the risk and expense, as the bringing in the body of the animal must often run away with a good portion of the reward. Crocodiles are numerous in the rivers towards the south and west of the District, and annually kill a great number of people and cattle, but no reward is given for their destruction. In the hot weather, when they become specially troublesome, it is not safe to bathe in, or take water from, the streams, except at places specially protected by palisades of bamboos or wooden stakes. Colonel Gastrell states that "even this precaution fails at times; instances have been frequently known of crocodiles entering within the palisades from the land side during the night, and in the morning the first notice of the hidden danger has been the struggles and shrieks of some unfortunate being seized and dragged under water by the huge reptile." The average number of deaths reported during the five years ending 1870 was 225 per annum from snake-bites and 14 from wild beasts. The Collector is of opinion, however, that these figures are considerably below the mark. No rewards have ever been given for snake-killing. The rivers and swamps of the District abound with fish. The following is a list of the principal fishes found in this District and throughout the Dacca Division:—Korál (coius), bhektí or bhetkí (vacti), hilsá or ilsá (ilasa), tapsí (polynemus), dháin, rohit or rui (rohita), kátal or kátlá (cyprinus), chital (notopterus chitala), kálíbáus (labeo calbasu), báns (one of the siluridæ), gáng, mágur, ghená, áir or árí, bágh áir, pángás (pangasius Buchanani), boál (Wallago attu), silang or siland, rithá, báin or eel, cháplá or chápilá, bhángá or bhángan (mugil cephalotus, also Rasbora elanga), bhol, nándail báchá, pauá or poá, gánglá, káuliá, tul dándi, kájali, piplá saul, khorsolá, ándari, máhsir or mahásaul, golsá, tengrá (macrones tengara), gáng tengrá, chándá (equula ruconius), tek chándá, káchki, subarna khariká, báilá or bele, bhedá, bátásí, phali (notopterus kapirat), tátkiná, pábdá (Callichrous pabda), kákilá, mirgá or mirgel, dánkoná, chelá, rám chelá or gáng chelá, gajál, mágur, jial or singi (saccobranchus fossilis), kai, khalisá (trichogaster), puti, and malandi or malundá. Game birds are very numerous. Numbers of waterfowl are caught annually, chiefly

for the sake of their plumage, which is sent to the Calcutta market. The birds most sought for this purpose are the marabouts, kingfishers, flamingoes, cranes, pelicans, and wild geese.

POPULATION.—A rough census was made at the time of the Survey by the civil officers of the demarcation establishment. The method adopted was to count the number of houses as nearly as possible, and by multiplying the result by five, an approximate return of the population was arrived at. This rough census returned the number of houses at 166,549, and the population at 832,745. An experimental census of two towns and two rural tracts was made in 1869, the two former being taken by the police and villagers, and the latter by the police and the landholders; each of these agencies working independently of the other. The result, however, was not very successful, and the Magistrate states that marvellous obtuseness was manifested by all agencies in attempting to comprehend the meaning of the different headings, and that the work was laborious and tedious. Although the returns were sent back for revision, the information was still supposed to be inaccurate. The results of the census were reported as follow :—Town of Barisál, area 1791 acres; number of houses, 2286; population, males 4020, females 2360, total 6380; average number of souls to a house, 2·78. Town of Mádárípur, number of houses, 699; population, males 1146, females 936, total 2082; average number of inmates per house 2·98. Block of villages (*mauzá*) called Hátáliá Pasurbaniá, in Salímábád Fiscal Division; area 2841 acres; number of houses, 972; population, males 2113, females 2051, total 4164; average number of souls per house, 4·28; average number of souls per acre, 1·46. Mauzá Bandarkhálí Halká, in Bozargomedpur Fiscal Division; area 3033 acres; number of houses 523; population, males 1170, females 1188, total 2358; average number of souls per house, 4·5; average number of souls per acre, ·77. The reason why the average number of inmates to a house is higher in the country than in the town, is that town life is disliked by the people, and those classes who carry on their business in towns keep the families in the country.

A more exact census of the whole District was taken by authority of Government in January 1872. Arrangements were carefully organised in order to secure a correct enumeration; and Mr Beveridge, the Collector, thus describes the various agencies he made use of, and some of the measures taken to overcome the peculiar difficulties experienced in his District :—

"The fullest possible advantage was taken of all available aids in effecting the Census. The schoolmasters, the excise establishments and boats, the police patrol-boats, and the police generally; the toll-collectors, the pound-keepers, and the village *chaukídárs*, &c., were all pressed into the service. There are no Government *patwáris* (village accountants) in this District, and very few estates under Government (*khás*) management; but in the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur valuable aid was obtained from the *tahsíldár* (revenue collector) of Jainagar, which is the only considerable estate under direct Government management. The subdivisional system has been carried out to some extent in this District, and great use was made of it in the work of the Census. The four subdivisional officers all did their best, and two of them whose head-quarters are not centrically situated were out in the interior of their Subdivisions on the night of the Census. The Patuákhálí Subdivision, which is of very recent creation, was of material service in counting the inhabitants of the south of the District, and the District Superintendent of Police did good service in this quarter.

"In order to make the services of the village teachers fully available, the sanction of the inspector was obtained to the schools being closed for fifteen days, and with a similar object the Accountant-General's permission was obtained to the closing of the District and subdivisional treasuries for three days—viz., from the 13th to the 16th of January. The public also were warned beforehand that it would be difficult to attend to their cases during the census work, and the *mukhtárs* and others connected with our courts assisted us by keeping back complaints until the Magistrate should have time to attend to them. So also the police were instructed not to send up cases during the census work, if the doing so could be avoided. I ought not to omit to mention two preliminary orders to the police which I believe were of some service. One was the excusing of village *chaukídárs* from attendance at the *thánd* during the month of January unless they had to report crime, and the other was an announcement to the public through the *chaukídárs* that they should cut the jungle near their houses and see that the bamboo bridges over the *kháls* or canals were in good order, so that the enumerators might go about easily. . . . .

"So far I have spoken only of official assistance, and I have much pleasure in testifying that it was most willingly and efficiently rendered, and that I do not think any official or quasi-official

resource was overlooked or not used to the utmost. The weak point of the Census was of course the counting of the floating population, but we did our best to overcome the defect. Here it was that our boat establishments, such as they were, proved serviceable; and by calling out the excise boats, the police patrol and station boats, and the toll collectors' and toll overseers' boats, and by allowing boat-hire to Government officials (as far as our funds would allow), we sought to make this part of our test as far as possible a success. As regards aid from the public, I have to say that the landholders and their agents co-operated most heartily with the officials, and that some of them put themselves to considerable expense and trouble thereby."

In another communication Mr Beveridge writes as follows:—"I had always been afraid of the Census in Patuákhálí not being properly carried out, both because the Deputy was new to this District, and because of the difficult nature of the country. I was also much afraid that the census of the Maghs and woodcutters would not be properly taken. However, by the Police Superintendent undertaking the southern parts of the Subdivision, these fears were removed, and I believe that the census has been taken as accurately in Patuákhálí as in any other part of the District."

After mentioning the names of certain *zamíndárs* and others who had assisted in the work, the Collector proceeds:—"Although the gentlemen whom I have above named were from their position enabled to give us much help, I need hardly say that the real stress of the work fell upon the village enumerators. These men put themselves to great personal inconvenience, and even occasional personal danger from snakes and tigers, in taking the census, and they also in many cases incurred expenses for boat-hire, which, I am sorry to say, could not always be reimbursed to them. Many of them I understand spent Rs. 3 to Rs. 5 and even more, on boat-hire, and all they could get was Rs. 1-8-0 or Rs. 2-8-0, out of which they had also in some cases to supply themselves with lights and paper. They have, it is true, all received letters of thanks, but they deserved some substantial reward, and I regret that the small funds at my disposal did not allow of this being given." One of the enumerators gave vent to his feelings in Bengali verse, in which he somewhat graphically portrayed his sufferings on the night in question, expressing a hope that they would not be overlooked by a beneficent and grateful government.

"As the enumerators were, so to speak, the backbone of the affair, so was the selection of enumerators the most important and difficult work of the officials. It was a task which required great knowledge of the Mufassal as well as patience and tact, and it could not be accomplished without a good deal of physical fatigue. In many cases, especially in the south of the District, it was impossible to get local enumerators who could read and write, but every effort was made, and I believe that the list of enumerators, when finally revised, was about as good as could be made."

With regard to the accuracy of the results obtained, Mr Beveridge records his belief that the Census of Bákarganj was taken "with as near an approach to accuracy as was compatible with the limited amount of money placed at our disposal." Mr Testro, the Assistant Magistrate and Collector, who supervised the operations in a portion of the District, states:—"I myself visited four circles, and in addition to the house registers of those circles I personally tested the registers at four other places. These places were selected at random, and from what I saw I can say that I really believe the work to have been done with a very close approach to exactness. I found every house numbered and properly entered, and if only the people in each house were counted correctly (and I see no reason why they should not have been), the results obtained may be accepted as really representing the actual state of things. Considerations of averages may point to incorrectness in carrying out some of the orders, but inaccuracy as to the totals does not necessarily follow." The Subdivisional officers also reported to the same effect. The total cost of the Census throughout the District amounted to £278, 17s., spread over an area of 4935 square miles, for the enumeration of a population numbering 2,377,433 souls.

The following paragraph, extracted from page 106 of the Census Report, illustrates the comparative density of the population in various parts of the District:—"The land to the north-east, which adjoins the southern *thánás* of Faridpur, is marshy, with a comparatively scanty population; but the central strip of the District is particularly fertile even for Bengal, and very densely peopled. The *thánás* bordering on Deorá have about 800 persons to the square mile. Jhálakatí, Nalchití, and Bákarganj, which all contain large rice marts, have about 1000 persons to the square mile. In the south, however, the population is thinner, there being still large tracts of uncleared Sundarbans bordering on the estuary of the

Haringhátá. The three southern *thánás* of Mathbárí, Gulsákhálí, and Khálsákhálí, with an aggregate area of 1216 square miles, have only a population of a little over a quarter of a million, giving an average of only about 200 persons to the square mile. In the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur the number of persons to the square mile is 271."

The general results of the Census disclosed a total population of 2,377,433 souls, inhabiting 321,657 houses, the average density of population being 482 per square mile. The following table illustrates the area and population of each Police Circle and Subdivision in the District, as returned in the Census Report, from which it is quoted *verbatim*. A redistribution of the *thánd* areas, however, is in contemplation, as also the separation of the Mádárípur Subdivision from Bákarganj, and its annexation to the neighbouring District of Faridpur. These figures must therefore be accepted subject to alteration in consequence of the proposed changes.

The Census area includes 667 square miles of Sundarbans, chiefly lying within the Police Circle of Khálsákhálí. This tract is the thinnest populated in the whole District, and contains an average of only 122 inhabitants per square mile.

POPULATION CLASSIFIED ACCORDING TO SEX, RELIGION, AND AGE.—The total population of Bákarganj District amounts to 2,377,433, viz., 1,204,237 males, and 1,173,196 females; the proportion of males to the total population is 50·7 per cent., and the average density of the population 482 per square mile. Classified according to age, the Census gives the following results:—Hindus, under twelve years of age, males 144,122, females 119,377; above twelve years of age, males 269,747, females 294,147. Muhammadans, under twelve years, males 320,162, females 262,963; above twelve years, males 465,607, females 492,233. Buddhists, under twelve years, males 927, females 842; above twelve years, males 1213, females 1067. Christians, under twelve years, males 1001, females 870; above twelve years, males 1436, females 1545. Other denominations not classified separately, under twelve years, males 6, females 10; above twelve years, males 16, females 142. Total of all classes, under twelve years, males 466,218, females 384,062; above twelve years, males 738,019, females 789,134. The cause of the small proportion of girls to boys, and the excessive proportion of adult females to adult males, is owing to the fact that in Bengal girls attain woman-

[*Sentence continued after the Table.*]

Area, Population, &c., of each Police Circle (Thánd) in Bákarganj District.

Subdivision.	Police Circle. (Thánd.)	Area in square miles.	Number of villages, mauzás, or townships.	Number of houses.	Total population.	Averages calculated by the Census Officers.				
						Persons per square mile.	Villages, mauzás, or townships per square mile.	Persons per village, mauzá, or township.	Houses per square mile.	Persons per house.
Headquarters Subdivision,	Barisál,	260	164	20,134	153,222	589	'63	934	77	7'6
	Jhálakáti,	129	316	16,464	137,430	1,065	2'45	435	128	8'3
	Nálchiti,	90	143	11,492	89,464	994	1'59	626	128	7'8
	Bákarganj,	201	301	23,599	192,388	957	1'50	639	117	8'2
	Mendiganj,	284	308	17,541	138,676	488	1'08	450	62	7'9

POPULA

[*Sentence continued from the page before the Table.*]

hood at an earlier age than boys reach manhood; and many of them are returned as women, while males of the same age continue to be classed as boys. The number and proportion of all ages of males and females may be taken as correct, the proportion of males in the total population being returned at 50·7 per cent. The number of insanes in the District is given at 703, or ·0296 per cent. of the total population; idiots at 86, or ·0036 per cent. of the total population; deaf and dumb at 579, or ·0244 per cent. of the total population; blind at 1375, or ·0578 per cent. of the total population; and lepers at 439, or ·0185 per cent. of the total population. Total of all infirmities 3182, or ·1338 per cent. of the total population. It is a curious circumstance that of the total number of persons afflicted with the foregoing infirmities less than one-fourth, or only 768, were females. The proportion of male infirms to the total male population is ·2004 per cent., and of female infirms to the total female population ·0654 per cent.

POPULATION ACCORDING TO OCCUPATION.—The following paragraphs, showing the occupations of the people, are compiled from the tabular statements appended to the Census Report. The figures, however, must be taken as a rough approximation only, and the classification seems in many respects, perhaps unavoidably, imperfect. Upon this point Mr Beverley, in the concluding paragraphs of his Bengal Census Report, makes the following remarks:—

"These tables have been drawn up according to the elaborate classification prescribed by Colonel Strachey. The labour which their compilation involved has been enormous, and is very inadequately represented by the few pages of tabular matter appended to this report. Neither can I regard the result as altogether satisfactory. Even were it possible so thoroughly to train several large establishments located in different places in the principles of classification upon which the statement is intended to be based, that blunders on their part should be the exception instead of the rule, practical difficulties arise at every step from the indefiniteness of the information afforded by the returns themselves. To take, as an instance, the first class—Government servants—the figures under this head will probably be found very wide of the truth. A man who describes himself merely as an engineer, a *karáni*, or a *piyádá*, may or may not be a Government servant, and it is left to the discretion of the compiler to include or omit him from the class. The

same difficulty presents itself in regard to every other class. A weaver may weave silk, cotton, or jute; but unless information on the point is afforded, it is impossible to acquire a satisfactory idea of those various trades. Even were it practicable for the head of the office to go through the millions of returns himself, the result, considering the nature of the material, could not be other than unsatisfactory. As it is, his exertions are far from cheered by the conviction that will continually force itself upon him, that, after all, the statistics exhibited in this voluminous statement must be but a sorry equivalent for the immense labour and expense which its preparation involves.

"It is important, however, that I should state how the information in these tables has been obtained. In the form of return the occupation of male adults only was intended to be recorded. In cases, however, where there was no male adult householder, the occupation entered has been assumed to be that of the women shown against it. The statement, therefore, as regards women is altogether incomplete. The occupation of those women who have husbands or fathers is not shown, while that shown is often the occupation rather of the woman's absent or deceased husband than her own. It was not uncommon, for instance, to find women describing themselves as pursuing the avocation of blacksmiths or braziers. A strictly accurate return of the occupation of women can, of course, only be compiled when each individual woman is separately specified in the returns."

Occupations of Males.—Class I.—Persons employed under Government, Municipal, or other local authorities:—Government Police, 423; Rural Police, 5187; Covenanted Civil servants, 7; subordinate judicial officers, 5; subordinate executive officers, 3; Educational officers, 5; Public Works officials, 7; Post-office, 45; Excise, 31; clerks, 46; messengers (*piyádás*), 75; others, 5; total of Class I., 5839.

Class II.—Professional persons, divided into professors of religion, education, literature, law, medicine, fine arts, surveying, and engineering:—Hindu Priests (*purohits*), 9450; spiritual guides (*gurus*), 523; astrologers and astronomers (*áchárjyas*), 185; Muhammadan priests (*mullás*), 5; pilgrim guides, 4; temple attendants, 5; *khundkars*, 90; schoolmasters, 1130; teachers of Sanskrit (*pandits*), 76; Muhammadan clerks and interpreters (*munshis*), 46; Muhammadan law-doctors (*maulvís*), 94; students and scholars, 1759; pleaders,

71; law-agents (*mukhtárs*), 261; stamp vendors, 56; doctors, 140; Hindu medical practitioners, 3713; vaccinators, 10; cow-doctors (*gobaidyas*), 32; men-midwives, 314; compounders, 1; musicians, 2475; singers, 158; actors, 4; jugglers, 14; painters, 51; snake-charmers, 22; surveyors (*ámins*), 2; total of Class II., 20,691.

Class III.—Persons in service or performing personal offices:—Personal servants, 8958; cooks, 94; barbers, 9747; washermen (*dhobás*), 7694; sweepers (*mihtars*), 520; water carrier (*bhistí*), 1; doorkeepers (*darwáns*), 149; gardeners (*málís*), 44; marriage registrars (*ghataks*), 334; innkeeper, 1; unspecified, 635; total of Class III., 28,177.

Class IV.—Persons engaged in agriculture and with animals:—Superior landlords (*zamíndárs*), 1963; large leaseholders (*ijárádárs*), 18; holders of rent-free tenures (*lákhirájdárs*), 26; subordinate landlords (*tálukdárs*), 10,308; small leaseholders (*patnídárs*), 378; small permanent tenure-holders (*jotdárs*), 4; ordinary cultivators, 473,477; *hawáládárs*, 8403; land stewards (*gumáshtás*), 662; rent collectors (*tahsíldárs*), 1239; village accountants (*patwárís*), 268; holders of lands on military service tenures, or as servants of the *zamíndárs* (*páiks*), 1629; village headmen (*mandals*), 1; rent collector in charge of estates (*náib*), 1; managers of estates, 9; shepherds, 3; cowherds, 214; elephant drivers (*máhuts*), 7; grooms, 41; farriers and shoeing smiths (*nálbands*), 2; hunters (*shikárís*), 37; total of Class IV., 498,690.

Class V.—Persons engaged in commerce and trade, as in the conveyance of money and goods, in keeping and lending money, and in the sale of goods:—Cabmen, 5; carters, 2; palanquin bearers, 1437; boatmen, 27,662; farmers of ferries, 102; lascars, 11; warehousemen (*áratdárs*), 77; weighmen, 260; bankers and *mahájans*, 1219; pawnbrokers and money-changers (*poddárs*), 70; cashiers, 7; money-lenders, 8700; merchants, 542; *saudágars*, 14; petty dealers (*bepárís*), 2947; shopkeepers, 23,241; hawkers, 10; brokers (*dalál*s), 40; clerks, 58; outdoor clerks (*sarkárs*), 96; shopmen, 12; vernacular clerks (*muharrirs*), 12,783; managers, 6; total of Class V., 79,301.

Class VI.—Persons employed in mechanical arts, manufactures, and engineering operations, and in the sale of goods manufactured or prepared for consumption:—Glassmakers, 25; masons (*rájmistrís*), 476; bricklayers, 8; sawyers, 61; carpenters, 38; thatchers, 853; painters, 2; boat-builders, 132; blacksmiths, 1518; dealers in hard-

ware, 5; coppersm
tinmen, 5; goldsm
3177; lime vend
mat-makers, 677;
10; garland-maker
cotton spinners, 3
makers, 398; clot
bag makers, 543;
makers, 91; oil sel
bakers, 68; grain
26; sellers of mol
milkmen, 1123; s
keepers, 6; tobac
19; *pán* sellers, 2
dealers in charco
320; skinners an
60,468.

CLASS VII.—M
Pensioners, 157;
unemployed, 2433
511,071; grand tot

OCCUPATIONS o
prefixed to the para
with special force t

CLASS I.—*Nil.*

CLASS II.—Pro
spiritual guides (*g*
hammadan female
doctors (*gobaidyas*),
238.

CLASS III.—Fem
Personal servants,
barbers, 46; washe
prostitutes, 1189;

CLASS IV.—Fem
Female landlords (
56; female subor
vators with rights
8378; total of Clas

CLASS V.—Fem

warehouse-keepers, 3; female money-lenders, 347; female shop-keepers, 1075; female petty dealers (*bepáris*), 21; total of Class V., 1446.

Class VI.—Females employed in manufactures, or in the sale of goods manufactured or prepared for consumption:—Dealers in hardware, 2; dealers in pottery, 59; dealers in lime, 4; basket-makers, 30; mat-makers, 85; garland sellers, 41; spinners, 1277; weavers, 228; tailoresses, 15; net-makers, 131; female shoemakers, 6; rice dealers, 210; oil dealers, 54; grain parchers, 24; grain huskers, 2971; fishwomen, 336; milk sellers, 27; *pán* sellers, 103; dealers in firewood, 127; total of Class VI., 5730.

Class VII.—Miscellaneous females not classed otherwise:—Female pensioners, 35; female beggars and paupers, 1908; female labourers, 1113; unemployed females, 766,861; female children, 384,315; total of Class VII., 1,154,232. Grand total of females of all classes, 1,173,196.

Ethnical Division of the People.—The Census Report of 1872 thus classifies the population of Bákarganj District:—Non-Asiatics, 27; Eurasians, 127; aboriginal tribes, 3023; Semi-Hinduised aborigines, 342,583; Hindu castes, 476,145; persons of Hindu origin not recognising caste, 10,497; Muhammadans, 1,540,965; Maghs, 4066; grand total, 2,377,433.

Immigrant Races.—The situation of the District laid it open in olden times to predatory incursions by the Maghs or Arákánese, who made regular raids up the rivers in fleets of armed boats, and to such an extent were their ravages carried on, that in Rennel's map a considerable tract is marked as "depopulated by the Maghs." Many of them have now, however, permanently settled in the District, and are described as a quiet and peaceable community. In olden times the feeling about caste in the District was so sensitive, that the fact of a Magh passing through a house was considered to pollute it and its owner. The Maghs are, properly speaking, Buddhists by religion, but from long residence in a District where Buddhism is unknown, nearly all traces of their religion have become obliterated. Thus, in 1867 it is said that there was not a single Buddhist priest for the whole of the Magh colonies settled in the southern part of the District. Many Maghs have now embraced Hinduism, and are divided into the same castes as their co-religionists of Bengal proper. There are Magh Bráhmans, Baidyas, Káyasths, &c., but they are despised by the general Hindu community,

and indeed they themselves consider that they are scarcely admissible into it. Although looked down upon from a religious point of view, the Maghs from their straightforwardness and peaceable disposition have won for themselves the respect of the Bengalis, who address them by the title of Chaudhrís, or headmen. The following account of their settlement in Bákarganj District is extracted from the Report of the Collector, quoted at page 140 of the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division":—"The Maghs first settled in the Sundarbans some seventy years ago, when they fled from their homes during the war between the Pegu and Arákán Rájás, which ended in the conquest of Arákán by Pegu. At Kháprábhángá, near Choplí I met several old Magh women who must have been at least seventy years old, and who said they came over to settle there when they were quite girls. The Maghs have a great love for their old homes, to which they make occasional visits. They generally wait for the fair weather in the cold season, and cross to Chittagong and Cox's Bázár in ordinary boats, and thence go home. They adhere to their own mode of living, and only intermarry among themselves. Their dwellings are built on the same model as the Burmese houses. It is interesting to see the Magh settlements dotted all about the Sundarbans, and one might almost fancy he was travelling through Burmese villages while among the Bákarganj Maghs. It has been said that the Maghs or Arákánese are a very indolent race. They may be so in their own country, but they are certainly not so in the Sundarbans. None but Maghs could have cleared the sea-board jungles so well. Whatever they may be in their own country, they are a most industrious, energetic race in the Sundarbans. But they must have their own way to set about it. Thus, I have not unfrequently heard that the Maghs are bad clearers for the Sundarbans, because they only stay a year or two at a place where the jungle grows, and sow and reap the crops, and then go away. This is perfectly true in one sense. They do not like clearing jungle lands for others. Wherever they have had a grant of land in their own hands, as at Kháprábhángá, which is near Choplí, and at other neighbouring places, they settle down with their families, and clear the land in the most wonderful manner. This partly arises from their fear of the Bengali *gumáshtá* or *náibs* (revenue agents), of whom they have a most wholesome horror, and from their fear of foreigners generally. Among the Maghs settled in this District there are some leading families who have amassed great wealth. Besides those settled down in the south of Bákarganj, a large

number of them come every year to Nalchití to buy betel-nut, rice, &c." The Census Report of 1872 returned the number of Maghs in Bákarganj District at 4066. The Bunás are immigrants, but number very few in Bákarganj, and cannot say from what part of the country they originally came. They are chiefly employed as woodcutters, and numbered 173 in the District according to the Census of 1872.

IMMIGRATION AND EMIGRATION does not take place to any extent in Bákarganj at the present day. At harvest-time, about December, a number of reapers come from Dacca and Faríd pur, but they all return to their homes after the crops are cut. The large traders and merchants generally have places of business in other Districts, and for the most part are not natives of Bákarganj. The professional classes also are chiefly recruited from the neighbouring Districts of Dacca and Faríd pur.

CASTES.—There are three classes of Bráhmans in the District, the Rárhi, Bárendra, and Vaidik; the Rárhi and Bárendra being comparatively few in number, while the Vaidiks are more numerous. Some classes of Bráhmans have become degraded by their serving as priests to the despised classes, that is, to those from whose hands a pure Bráhman will not take water. These lapsed Bráhmans are not admitted to intercourse with the pure Bráhmans, and are called by the name of the caste they have attached themselves to, such as Sháhá Bráhman, Kaibartta Bráhman, Subarna Banik Bráhman, &c. The ordinary Bráhmans of Bákarganj are either employed in religious pursuits, in Government service, or as lawyers; many are also landed proprietors. They are fairly numerous in the District, and are highly esteemed. Although the majority of the Bráhmans are poor, many are comfortably off, and a few are rich men. Their number, as returned by the Census of 1872, was 65,254. (2) The Kshattriyas formed the second or warrior caste in the ancient Sanskrit fourfold social classification, but it is believed that there are now no pure Kshattriyas in Bengal. The Census Report classifies them as a trading caste, and returns their number at 112. (3) Rájputs, a tribe of the North-Western Provinces, who claim to belong to the Kshattriya caste, and are generally employed in military service; number in Bákarganj District, 952. (4) Baidya; their caste occupation is that of hereditary physicians, but within recent years many of them have abandoned their ancient occupation, and are now landed proprietors or Government clerks. They rank high in social esteem, and although the majority are said to be in rather poor circumstances,

many of them are well off, and a few are really wealthy men. The Census Report of 1872 returns their number at 12,960. (5) Káyasth; this caste is divided into two sects in Bákarganj, called respectively Banga and Dakshín Rárhi. The latter is insignificant in point of numbers, but the former is very numerous, and indeed outnumbers all the other respectable castes in the District. The Census Report returns the Káyasths of Bákarganj at 125,164. Among them are many men of high rank, and in wealthy circumstances. All Banga Káyasths throughout Bengal would think it an honour to marry into any of the following Bákarganj families:—The Thákurtá (family name Guhá) at Bánarípárá; the Dastidár (Ghosh) family at Gabhá; the Ror (Ghosh) family at Narottampur; and the Ror (Basu) family at Nathulibágh. The Káyasths are employed in a variety of respectable occupations, as Government servants, writers, clerks, &c., and are held in high social esteem. In worldly circumstances they are generally well off. (6) Márwári and Agarwálá, up-country trading castes, who claim to be Kshattriyas; number in Bákarganj District, 76. (7) Barna Bipra, a class of Bráhmans who are considered to have become degraded in consequence of their officiating as priests to the low castes. They are said to be numerous in Bákarganj, but are not returned as a separate caste in the Census Return, the numbers being probably included in the general total of Bráhmans given above. (8) Daibajna or Áchárjya, fortune-tellers and astrologers. They are reckoned as degraded Bráhmans, from their practice of indiscriminately taking gifts from the low castes. The caste is not shown separately in the Census Report, their numbers being probably included with the other Bráhmans. (9) Agradání, a lapsed class of Bráhmans, who have become degraded from their practice of receiving gifts at funeral obsequies (*sráddhas*); not given separately in the Census Return.

The Súdra castes come next. The following list is arranged as far as possible in the order in which each caste is ranked in local public esteem; the numbers being derived from the Census Report of 1872:—(10) Nápit, barbers; number in 1872, 40,044. (11) Kámár, blacksmiths; number, 11,408. (12) Kumár or Kumbhár, potters; number, 13,748. (13) Tilí or Telí, originally oil pressers and sellers by caste occupation, but within recent years many of them have abandoned their hereditary employments, and set up as traders, grain-dealers, &c.; some of them are now wealthy men. By their numbers and general prosperity, they have now succeeded in pushing them-

selves forward into a higher social rank than is accorded to the oil-selling caste, and claim to be one of the *nabasáks*, or the nine pure Súdra castes from whose hands a Bráhmán can receive water without defilement. Number in Bákarganj District in 1872, 12,020. (14) Támlí or Ṭámbulí, originally betel sellers by caste occupation, but many of them have forsaken their ancient employment, and betaken themselves to trade and agriculture. The caste is not a strong one in Bákarganj District, and the Census Report returns them at only 68. (15) Sadgop, the highest of the cultivating castes; number in 1872, 186. (16) Málí, gardeners and flower sellers; 2204 in number. (17) Gandhbaṇik, grocers and spice sellers by caste; many are also wealthy traders; 3290 in number. (18) Bárui, *pán* gardeners and sellers of betel leaf; 14,453 in number. (19) Sánkhárí, makers of shell bracelets; 1157 in number. (20) Kánsárí, braziers and coppersmiths; 547 in number. (21) Súdra, domestic servants, boatmen, and agriculturists; 8989 in number. (22) Goálá, milkmen and cowkeepers; 6738 in number. (23) Sháhá, traders and merchants. These originally belonged to the Surí, or despised wine-selling caste, but they have abandoned their hereditary occupation, and by their wealth and importance have pushed themselves forward into a higher social rank. Not given as a separate caste in the Census Return. (24) Kaibartta or Háluá Dás, cultivators and fishermen; 29,341 in number. (25) Madak or Mayrá, sweatmeat makers; 1450 in number. (26) Gánrár, sellers of parched rice and other preparations; 2 in number. (27) Kurmí, a class of up-country cultivators; number in Bákarganj District, 20. (28) Vaishnav, followers of Chaitanya. This is rather a sect of Hindus than a caste, and indeed the principle inculcated by Chaitanya, the founder of the sect, was the equality of man. At the present day, however, they are regarded as a caste, and caste prejudices are said to be gradually creeping in among them. A full account of this sect will be found in my Statistical Accounts of Dacca and the 24 Parganás. The Census Report returned the number of Vaishnavs in Bákarganj District in 1872 at 5799. (29) Chásá Dhopá, cultivators; 7 in number. (30) Tántí, weavers; 1875 in number. (31) Sekerá or Swarnakár, goldsmiths and jewellers; 455. (32) Subarnabaṇik, merchants, bankers, and dealers in gold and precious stones; 2144 in number. (33) Sutradhar or Chhutár, carpenters; 2081 in number. (34) Kurí, confectioners; not given in the Census Report. (35) Koerí, cultivators and agricultural labourers; 436 in number. (36) Dhanuk

domestic servants; 213 in number. (37) Dhobá, washermen; 27,395 in number. (38) Kalu, oil pressers and sellers; 164 in number. (39) Jogí and Patuá, weavers; 28,198 in number. (40) Chandál, fishermen, cultivators, day-labourers, &c.; 326,775 in number. (41) Kapálí, cotton weavers; 8378 in number. (42) Chunárí, lime-burners; 303 in number. (43) Káthurá, lime-burners; not given as a separate caste in the Census Report. (44) Beldár, labourers and cultivators; 98 in number. (45) Rawáni Káhár, an up-country caste, principally employed as domestic servants, water-carriers, and palanquin bearers; 557 in number. (46) Surí, spirit manufacturers and sellers; 26,160 in number. (47) Kacháru, manufacturers of lac bracelets. They are not mentioned as a separate caste in the Census Report, but the Collector states that they are very few in number in the District. (48) Jáliá or Jhál, fishermen; 12,602 in number. (49) Málá, fishermen and boatmen; 1705 in number. (50) Mánjhí, not so much a caste as a designation of their occupation as boat-steerers; 46 in number. (51) Pod, fishermen; 314 in number. (52) Tior, fishermen and boatmen; 696 in number. (53) Patiál, labourers; 1015 in number. (54) Behárá, palanquin bearers; 577 in number. (55) Bágdí, cultivators, fishermen, labourers, &c.; 76 in number. (56) Bharanpál, cultivators; not given as a separate caste in the Census Return. (57) Loáit, turtle catchers; not mentioned in the Census Report. (58) Báití, mat-makers and also musicians; 331 in number. (59) Nar, musicians; not classified in the Census Report. (60) Patitá, makers of fine mats; not mentioned in the Census Return. (61) Pátuní, fishermen and ferrymen; 4518 in number. (62) Báheliá, labourers and cultivators; 1 in number. (63) Chámár, and Muchí, or Rishi, shoemakers and leather dealers; 3991 in number. (64) Dom, fishermen and basketmakers; 1088 in number. (65) Buná, aboriginal labourers from Western Bengal; ·173 in number. (66) Dosadh, labourers, cultivators, &c.; 13 in number. (67) Karangá, labourers, cultivators, &c.; 248 in number. (68) Khen, labourers, cultivators, &c.; 10 in number. (69) Koch, cultivators and fishermen; 498 in number. (70) Pálí, cultivators, labourers, &c.; 64 in number. (71) Mál, snake charmers; 2945 in number. (72) Pásí, toddy-makers from date juice; 66 in number. (73) Bhuimálí, sweepers and street scavengers; 38 in number. (74) Pán, labourers; 41 in number. (75) Hárí, swineherds and sweepers; 309 in number. (76) Káorá, swine-keepers; 58 in number. (77) Mihtar, sweepers; 6039 in number. (78) Bediyá, a class of wander-

ing gypsy-like people, half Hindus and half Muhammadans in religion, earning a living by juggling, hunting, begging, &c., and when these means fail, by petty thefts; 71 in number.

No distinct hereditary class of criminals is found in the district, but a wandering gypsy tribe, called Bebájiás, are rather numerous. They profess Muhammadanism, but form a distinct class from the rest of their co-religionists, with whom they do not socially intermingle. They principally live in boats, travelling from place to place, but have their fixed headquarters where their chief men reside, and to whom all disputes among themselves are referred. They gain their subsistence chiefly by wood-cutting in the Sundarban tracts of the District, also by fishing, practising as physicians, fortune-telling, and as river-pedlars, traders in small wares, such as fish-hooks, lines, looking-glasses, cloth, &c. The Bebájiás, unlike similar wandering tribes in other parts of the country, are a peaceful and industrious class, orderly in their habits, and requiring no special supervision or watching. They very seldom come before the courts, and as they hold no lands of their own, are never embroiled in affrays and riots.

Religious Division of the People.—Bákarganj District contains Muhammadans, Hindus, Bráhma Samáj followers, Buddhists, and Christians, the Musalmáns forming the largest section of the population. As already stated, the total population of Bákarganj amounts to 2,377,433; namely, 1,204,237 males, and 1,173,196 females. Of these, 1,540,965, or 785,769 males and 755,196 females, are Muhammadans; the proportion of Musalmáns to the total population being 64·8 per cent., and of Muhammadan males to the total Muhammadan population 51 per cent. The Hindus number 827,393, namely, 413,869 males, and 413,524 females; the proportion of Hindus to the total population being 34·8 per cent., and of males to total Hindu population 50 per cent. The Buddhists number 4049, namely, 2140 males, and 1909 females; proportion of Buddhists to total population, ·2 per cent; proportion of Buddhist males to Buddhist population 52·9 per cent. The Christian population amounts to 4852 souls, namely, 2437 males and 2415 females; proportion of Christians to total population, ·2 per cent; proportion of Christian males to Christian population, 50·2 per cent. The remainder of the population are not separately classified according to religion, but are entered in the Census Report under the heading of "others." They consist of 174 souls; namely, 22 males and 152 females, the proportion of males to total "others" being 12·6 per cent.

THE MUHAMMADANS, as above stated, form the majority of the population, and especially predominate in the southern parts of the District, where nearly all the inhabitants are Musalmáns. The number of Muhammadans amounts to 785,769 males and 755,196 females, making a total of 1,540,965, or 64·8 per cent. of the total population. In the towns and larger villages, however, it is said that the Hindus outnumber the Muhammadans, and for the town of Barisál, the Census Report returns a population of 4694 Hindus as against 2821 Muhammadans. The caste system does not prevail among the Musalmáns, although nine classes exist among them, strongly demarcated from the rest of the population. These are (1) Nikáris, fishermen and boatmen; (2) Náiyá, fish sellers; (3) Jolá, cloth manufacturers; (4) Láhurí, ornament makers; (5) Ostá, circumcisers; (6) Nagarchi, musicians; (7) Mír Shikárí, fowlers; (8) Garálí, harpooners of crocodiles; and (9) Matiál, makers of oil-pots. The Census Report, however, gives no return of the numbers belonging to each of these classes. The Bákarganj Musalmáns are reported by the Collector as much addicted to litigation. The Faráizís, or Puritan sect of Muhammadans, are very numerous, especially in the southern parts of the District. A late Collector of Bákarganj, in his Report on the District, in the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division," states that a Faráizí may be distinguished from any other Musalmán by the following external characteristic. He dresses differently from other Muhammadans, and wraps his *dhutí* or waistcloth round his body without crossing it between his legs, from his aversion to anything like a Christian's trousers. A brief account of the founding and rise of the Faráizís, under Hájí Sharitullá, and their growth under his son Dudú Miyán, will be found in my "Statistical Account of Faridpur District," the original home of the sect. Upon the death of Dudú Miyán in 1862, his three sons, together with his nephew, set themselves to continue the propagation of the new creed, and the Collector in 1871 reported that they were still maintaining themselves by that profession. A considerable landed property, which was acquired by Dudú Miyán and his father from their disciples in the early days of the sect, has now been sold for debts. Another sect of Muhammadans follow the teachings of Maulví Karámat Alí, a learned Musalmán law-doctor, much respected by his co-religionists. He came to Calcutta as a disciple of Sayyid Ahmad, the Wahábí preacher,

who acquired great notoriety by stirring up the tribes beyond the North-Western frontier to a religious crusade against us. After Sayyid Ahmad's departure for Mecca about 1822, Maulví Karámat Alí arrived at Bákarganj with the object of teaching the Muhammadan faith. He established a school, and soon made converts to the tenets which he promulgated. The new sect rapidly increased in Bákarganj and the neighbouring districts of Farídpur, Dacca, Noákhálí, Chittagong, and Tipperah. After the death of Dudú Miyán, many of the latter's followers joined the party of Karámat Alí, and at the present day the sect outnumbers that of Dudú Miyán, whose sons and successors are too weak to keep their followers and disciples under their spiritual control. The form of Wahábiism preached by Maulvi Karámat Alí was a protest against the abuses which had been allowed to creep into the Muhammadan worship, and did not involve disloyalty to the ruling power or hostility to other forms of faith. There is a family of Muhammadans in Bákarganj, the Miyáns of Srírámpur, who were originally Bráhmans. Their old kinsmen, the Majumdárs of Marádiá, have no caste, as they became degraded by their adoption of the practice of marrying their first cousins, a custom strictly prohibited by Hindu law. The family have now no Bráhman priests, and have thrown away their sacred thread, as they can obtain no recognised status in Hindu society.

The Hindu population of Bákarganj numbers 827,393; namely, 413,869 males, and 413,524 females; the proportion of Hindus to the total population of the District being 34·8 per cent. The only peculiarity requiring special mention among the religious ceremonies of the Hindus of Bákarganj is the special reverence they pay to Manasá, the Goddess of Snakes, who is always represented among the family idols. The extensive worship of this deity in the District has been ascribed to terror on account of the number of deaths from snake-bite, but the Collector thinks it more probably a relic of the old serpent-worship. The cult is not confined to Bákarganj District, and is reported to be exceedingly prevalent in Kuch Behar, although snakes are not very numerous or particularly deadly in that part of the country. One of the religious ceremonies which, although performed generally throughout Bengal, is celebrated with more pomp and expense in Bákarganj than elsewhere, is the Nabánna, or the first eating of the new rice after it has been offered to the gods. Even the Muhammadans, the

higher classes excepted, join in it, although they do not perform all the religious rites. The ceremony takes place on a particular day in the month of Agraháyan (November–December), just after the harvest has been gathered in; and for the proper performance of the rite, all the members of the family assemble together for the purpose of partaking together of the new rice. One of the ceremonies observed on the occasion is an offering consisting of a plantain and some rice mixed with molasses and ground cocoa-nut, made to the crows, before the party sits down to the feast. If a crow does not consume the offering, the people look upon it as an ill-omen, and live in great anxiety lest any danger should befall them during the year. Caste-disputes occur among the Hindu population from very slight causes, and make themselves felt throughout the entire District. Thus, the Collector in 1871 reported that some Hindu schoolboys on their way from Calcutta ate some pulse cooked by Muhammadan boatmen. One of the boys who had not partaken of the food reported the fact. This gave rise to social disputes and to the institution of several criminal charges. The whole central division of the District was arrayed into two factions, one in favour of excommunicating the unfortunate lads from their caste, and the more liberal-minded in favour of less stringent measures. The disputes thus raised took a long time to subside.

THE BRÁHMA SAMÁJ, or Theistic Religious Society of the Hindus, was first established in Bákarganj in 1861, the meetings being held in the house of one or other of the members. Serious difficulties were at first experienced by the Samáj, the members of which were principally young men, from the opposition of their parents and guardians, who in nearly every instance belonged to the more orthodox section of Hindus. In 1864, however, they succeeded in erecting a place of worship of their own, which after a time was attended by the ladies belonging to the families of the members of the Samáj. A school was also established for the education of the Bráhma ladies in both secular and religious instruction. As in other parts of Bengal, the Bráhmas of Bákarganj are divided into two sects—one generally called the progressive Bráhmas, and the other the Conservative or old Bráhmas. The former are said to predominate in Bákarganj, the latter being but an insignificant party, and with very little influence in the management of the affairs of the Samáj. The two sects of Bráhmas are distinguished here, as elsewhere, by the progressive section renouncing all distinctions of caste,

and the social rules observed by the Hindu community; while the conservative party observe all the outward customs and ceremonies of the Hindus, and are Bráhmas only in faith and religious belief. These latter do not lose caste, and are freely admitted into orthodox Hindu society. The progressive Bráhmas, however, have formed a separate and distinct community among themselves, and are reported by the Magistrate to be as much detested by the Hindus as Musalmáns or Christians. In 1871 they numbered twenty-two families in the District, most of them belonging to the higher classes of native society, and many of them well educated, and holding good positions. The operations of the Samáj are at present principally confined to the town of Barisál, and with the exception of the village of Lákhutiá, the headmen of which have joined the reformed faith, very few members of the sect are found among the rural population. It is impossible to give accurate statistics of the number of Bráhmas in Bákarganj District. They are not mentioned separately in the Census Report for 1872, but are classed with ordinary Hindus.

BUDDHISM is not making any way in the District, and indeed, with regard to the Buddhist or Magh Settlements in the Sundarban tracts, it is said that long residence among people of strange faiths has almost obliterated all traces of this ancient religion. Some of the Maghs have embraced Hinduism, and, as stated on a previous page, divide themselves into castes such as Bráhmans, Baidyas, Káyasths, &c. The Census Report returns the number of Buddhists in Bákarganj District as follows:—Males, 2140; females, 1909; total, 4049; proportion of Buddhists to total population, ·2 per cent.

CHRISTIANITY.—There is a large native Christian community in Bákarganj. At the close of 1869, the Baptist Missionary Society had under its care 3336 people, including women and children, of whom 824 had been baptized, and a large number were receiving special instruction preparatory to their admission to Church fellowship. At the close of 1869, the Mission supported eleven village schools, at which about 300 children were in daily attendance, nearly one-fourth of the pupils being girls. Besides these village schools, there is also a special class at the town of Barisál for some of the more promising boys. This Christian community owes its origin to the efforts of the Serampur Baptist Missionaries, Messrs Carey, Marshman, and Ward. The Mission is at present under the care of the Rev. J. Sale. Among the converts are several men of high

caste, and a few of Musalmán extraction, but the great majority belong to the low caste Chandáls or Kapálís, and subsist by cultivation. Some, however, are engaged in the fishing trade, and considerable quantities of fish are taken by them to Calcutta as well as to large markets nearer home. They include a number of sawyers, village carpenters, and boat-builders. It cannot be said of the community that they are well off, but many have managed to raise themselves above the lowest rank, and a very small proportion has attained to something like a well-to-do position. It is said that many of the lower class of converts, although devoid of all distinction of caste, still observe some of the class distinctions of the Hindu community. For instance, a Christian of the Kotwálípárá *bil*, belonging to the Chandál caste, although perhaps converted many years ago, still objects to eat fowls, or food cooked by converts from Muhammadanism. Another Protestant Mission is attached to the Church of England, and numbers about 600 persons, under the care of Mr Barerio. The headquarters of this community is at Dhándaha. A Roman Catholic Mission in connection with the Goa Church is established at Sibpur, and another was established directly by the Church of Rome at Barisál. At one time considerable differences sprang up and long rankled between the Goa and the Calcutta priests, but these disagreements have now been settled by a concordat between the Pope and the King of Portugal. The number of persons attached to the Sibpur Catholic Mission is about a thousand, besides three other small village settlements numbering a hundred and fifty souls. The Christians attached to the Sibpur Church mostly support themselves by cultivation, but many are employed as domestic servants at Calcutta or elsewhere, and others support themselves as fowlers or *shikárís*. As a general rule, the native converts are honest and trustworthy, and much attached to their homes. The total Christian population of Bákarganj is returned by the Census of 1872 at 4852 souls. Deducting 154 as representing the European and Eurasian inhabitants, there remains a balance of 4698 native Christians. The town of Barisál contains a Protestant Church, which is attended by most of the European residents of the Station, the average attendance being 14. A Minister of the Additional Clergy Society officiates. There is also a Baptist Chapel at Barisál, where the service is in English. It is attended by several of the European residents.

Towns.—Bákarganj is a purely agricultural District; the people

evince no tendency to gather into towns or towards city life; and the Census Report of 1872 only returns one town as containing a population exceeding 5000 souls. This is the Civil Station of Barisál, which in 1872 contained 7684 inhabitants, classified as follows:—Hindus, males 3753, females 941, total 4694. Muhammadans, males 1967, females 854, total 2821. Christians, males 75, females 85, total 160. Others, males 4, females 5, total 9. Total of all denominations, males 5799, females 1885, grand total 7684. Education seems to have made rapid progress in the town. Statistics collected by the Census show that out of a total male Hindu population of 3753, 2045 could either read and write, or were under instruction; out of 1967 male Muhammadans, 405 have received or are receiving elementary instruction; and out of 75 male Christians, 32 are able to read and write. Thus out of a total male population of 5799 souls, 2482 or 43 per cent. have either received or are receiving elementary instruction. Female education, however, is in a very backward state, only 28 Hindu females out of 941, and 7 Musalmán females out of 854, having received any instruction. With the Christians, the Mission Schools have undertaken the task of education, and out of 85 Christian females of all classes, 77 are able to read and write, or are under instruction. Barisál has been created a Municipality under the provisions of Act XX. of 1850. In the year 1869–70, the municipal revenue amounted to £376, 9s. 4d., and the expenditure to £358, 18s. 6d. For the year 1871–72, the gross municipal income amounted to £1019, 16s., and the gross municipal expenditure to £1006, 2s., the rate of municipal taxation being 2s. 7¾d. per head of the population. Barisál town is situated on the west bank of the river of the same name, in 22° 41′ 40″ north latitude, and 90° 24′ 30″ east longitude.

The three other municipal towns, or rather large villages, for none of them contain a population of five thousand souls, are as follow:—(1) Nalchití, situated on the south bank of the river of the same name, in 22° 37′ 55″ north latitude, and 90° 19′ 10″ east longitude. It is a large trading village, the principal exports being rice and paddy, and the chief imports, salt, tobacco, oil, and sugar. The municipal income in 1869–70 amounted to £165, 13s. 2d., and the expenditure to £60, 19s. 9d. (2) Jhálakátí or Maháráj ganj, situated at the junction of the Jhálakátí and Nalchití rivers, in 22° 37′ 45″ north latitude, and 90° 14′ 25″ east longitude. Jhálakátí is one of the largest timber markets in Eastern Bengal, especially for the sale of *sundrí*

wood, which is largely exported to Calcutta and elsewhere as fuel. A considerable export trade is also carried on in rice and paddy, the principal import being salt. The municipal receipts in 1869–70 amounted to £169, 15s., and the expenditure to £60, 9s. 8d. (3) Daulat Khán, the principal village in the island of Dakshín Shábázpur, and the headquarters of that Subdivision, situated in 22° 37′ 30″ north latitude, and 90° 50′ 25″ east longitude. Principal article of export, betel-nuts. Municipal income in 1869–70, £240, 17s. 3d.; expenditure, £126, 1s. 10d.

Besides the foregoing, there are several other trading villages, of which the following are the most important:—Mádárípur, the headquarters of the Subdivision of the same name, situated in the north of the District on the Kumár river, in 23° 11′ 10″ north latitude, and 90° 14′ 25″ east longitude; principal exports, jute; imports, tobacco and oil. Sáhibganj, situated on the river of the same name; principal exports, rice, paddy, molasses, and *sundrí* wood; imports, salt, oil, tobacco, cloth, and pulses. Angariá, situated on the river of the same name; principal export, rice; no imports of consequence. Sayyidpur, situated on the river of the same name; principal export, rice; import, salt. Jabar Amlá, situated on the river Kachuá; principal exports, rice and molasses; no imports of consequence. The following villages also carry on an export trade in rice:—Kálíganj, situated on the river of the same name; Jhilná, on the river of the same name; Farídpur, on the river of the same name; Bauphal, on the river Daspárá; Nayámáti, on the river Bíshkhálí; Bhandáriá, on the river of the same name; Kaukhálí, on the Kaukhálí Don; Káliá, on the river of the same name; Rámpur, on the river of the same name; Shubidkhálí, on the river Mirzáganj; Gulsákhálí, on the river of the same name; Auliápur, on the river of the same name; Dhalkisor, on the river of the same name; Patuákhálí, on the river of the same name; and Kochábaniá, Khairábad, Kánudáskátí, and Mathbáriá, all called after the rivers on which they are respectively situated.

Annual trading fairs are held at Kálísurí, Kulsokátí, Lákhutiá, Bánarípárá, Nalchirá, Pirozpur, Bhandáriá, and Jhálakátí; average attendance, from three to twelve thousand persons. A further account of the religious-trading gatherings will be given on a subsequent page.

THE MATERIAL CONDITION OF THE PEOPLE is good. With scarcely a single exception, every man, including even the domestic servants

whose homes are in the District, is a small landholder, and cultivates sufficient rice and other necessaries for the support of his family. Owing to this cause, hired labour is very scarce, and during the harvest season, when the few available labourers are eagerly bid for by the landholders, the price of labour rises to a shilling per diem. The diet of the natives consists principally of rice, fish, and vegetables; but the Muhammadans, whenever rich enough to do so, indulge in animal food, particularly fowls and goats. It is estimated that the average cost of living to a labouring man amounts to about 6s. per month. Except in the larger villages, the dwellings of the people are very isolated, and this is especially the case in the southern part of the District. The inhabitants seldom congregate together in villages, but each man builds his homestead on his own land, generally on the highest spot in his holding, without any reference to his neighbours. The consequence is that the homesteads are far apart from each other, with dense plantations of cocoa-nut and betel-nut trees surrounding each. Accordingly, families have little communication with each other, and neighbourly visits are seldom exchanged. The District Superintendent of Police, from whose Report I have gleaned the above, believes that this isolation is a great cause of the hasty and violent temper of the men, owing to their being free from anything like social restraint.

AGRICULTURAL.—Rice is the only cereal grown to any extent in the District, and is divided into three crops—the *áman*, or winter rice; *áus*, or autumn crop; and *boro*, or spring rice. The *áman* yields the finest grain, and is the staple crop of the District. It is sown on the setting in of the rains in April or May, transplanted from the beginning of June to the middle of August, and reaped in November and December. This crop requires to be carefully protected; and in a low-lying District like Bákarganj, covered with a complicated network of rivers and watercourses, its cultivation is attended with some risk, as the crop will not grow unless the ears of corn can keep well above the water. *Áman* rice may be divided into two sorts, namely, coarse (*motá*) and fine (*chikan*), but there are many minor varieties, as the following list will show:—(1) *Ghunsí;* (2) *char baleswar;* (3) *dal kachu;* (4) *pákar kání;* (5) *máti chál;* (6) *káládemá;* (7) *báspáir;* (8) *bhog lashkar;* (9) *manteswar;* (10) *brindí;* (11) *hugli;* (12) *bhringal;* (13) *burápágalni;* (14) *gerá marddan;* (15) *bándarjatá;* (16) *sibjatá;* (17) *bauári;* (18) *manápáthálí;* (19) *dighalí;* (20) *ijalí;* (21) *dudh luchí;* (22) *guá chulí;*

(23) *latámanar*; (24) *phulbeki*; (25) *páriját*; (26) *mahish kándi*; (27) *kewá mau*; (28) *ghrita sáil*; (29) *tulá sáil*; (30) *lakshmí bilás*; (31) *Sitá bhog*; (32) *maidal*; (33) *silát*; (34) *naldog*; (35) *kárlik jál*; (36) *rupesá pairi*; (37) *dudh manar*; (38) *dudh ráj*; (39) *shakkar khorá*; (40) *gillá*; (41) *kálámánik*; (42) *dhalámánik*; (43) *dingá mánik*; (44) *rájá sáil*; (45) *ghigaj*; (46) *básbir*; (47) *kumrágair*; (48) *gashrá*; (49) *rúpsá*; (50) *saphrí*; (51) *chápláish*; (52) *san muktá*; (53) *bájráil*; (54) *net pásá*; (55) *lothá*; (56) *khaiá mugrí*; (57) *gilá máir*; (58) *airáj*; (59) *chengái*; (60) *gáburá*; (61) *botar gáburá*; (62) *cháprásh*; (63) *tepu sáil*; (64) *jabrá*; (65) *chittaráj*; (66) *játdighá*; (67) *ráendá*; (68) *maisar*; (69) *manar*; (70) *mahish dal*; (71) *pengarí*; (72) *betláj*; (73) *guá chor*; (74) *syám magar*; (75) *sudi*; (76) *katuápátak*; (77) *rudra bhog*; (78) *máti chák*; (79) *áskal*; (80) *saiba kálí*; (81) *áchrá*; (82) *baeleji*; (83) *kerángal*; (84) *jám burá*; (85) *baichárí*; (86) *lohágará*; (87) *gandiánárí*; (88) *piprá lej*; (89) *dugdha kalam*; and (90) *kátí kshamá*.

The *áus* crop is sown in spring and early part of the hot weather, and reaped in August. In many parts of the District it is transplanted like the *áman* rice, but in the northern portion it is simply sown broadcast. Its twenty-one principal varieties are:—(1) *Binnáphul*; (2) *salai*; (3) *dhali mátiá*; (4) *maisar*; (5) *kálá mátiá*; (6) *jalai*; (7) *gareswar*; (8) *piprí*; (9) *sonár-gái*; (10) *baulán*; (11) *kálá sháitá*; (12) *ráimánik*; (13) *tiná chángrí*; (14) *hailek*; (15) *sháitá*; (16) *súrjyamani*; (17) *bháidá*; (18) *Lakshmí dighá*; (19) *súrjya mukhí*; (20) *bánspát*; (21) *aswiní*. The *áus* rice is not much used by those who can afford to buy *áman*, as it is supposed to cause diarrhœa.

The third rice crop, the *boro*, although not equal in importance to the *áman* or *áus* crops, is cultivated to a considerable extent on the alluvial river accretions, and on other low-lying grounds. It is generally sown broadcast in December, and is reaped in April or May, but is sometimes transplanted. It yields an abundant crop of a very coarse and hard rice, chiefly consumed by the poorer classes, who value it because it comes in at a season of the year when no other rice is ready. It is a quick-growing grain, and one variety of it gets the name of *shátiá*, the period from seed-time to harvest being only sixty days. No improvement appears to have taken place of late years in the quality of the rice grown in Bákarganj. The names of rice in the various stages of its growth are as follow:—the seed is called *bíj*; the young seedling, *chárá*; the full-grown plant, *gáchh*; the ear, *chharí*; unhusked rice, *dhán*; cleaned rice,

chául. The preparations made from rice are *chirá*, paddy steeped in water and afterwards fried and husked; *khai*, paddy parched and then husked; and *muri*, paddy boiled, husked, and afterwards parched; besides other varieties.

OTHER CROPS.—The principal green crops are *khesárí* (Lathyrus sativus), and *musurí* (Cicer lens), which are sown in the cold weather and cut in the spring. Among oil seeds, mustard, or *sarishá* (Sinapis dichotoma), is extensively cultivated in the Mádárípur Subdivision. The seed is sown in October after the land has been ploughed five or six times, and the crops gathered in the following February. *Til* (Sesamum orientale), and linseed, are also reared, but not to any great extent. (For the botanical names I trust to Sir G. Haughton.) The only fibre grown plentifully in the District is jute (*koshtá*), and this is almost entirely confined to the northern part. The principal miscellaneous crops are betel-nuts (*supárí*), cocoa-nuts (*nárikel*), sugar-cane (*ákh* or *ikshu*), and *pán*. The first two are very important in the south of the District and in the island of Dakshín Shábázpur, while the two last are principally cultivated in the Subdivision of Mádárípur. Safflower is also cultivated in the northern and higher parts of Bákarganj.

AREA; OUT-TURN AND VALUE OF CROPS, &c.—The total area of the District, as returned by the Surveyor-General in 1871, is 4939·13 square miles, of which, according to the Collector, nearly three-fourths, or 3439 square miles, is under cultivation. No information exists from which an estimate can be attempted of the comparative acreage under the principal corps. Inferior rice lands yield an out-turn of from eleven to thirteen hundredweights of unhusked rice per acre; good average lands from seventeen and a half to twenty-two hundredweights per acre; and very fine lands from thirty-three to forty-three hundredweights per acre. The price of paddy varies, but it is seldom worth to the cultivator more than 2s. 8d. a hundredweight. The Collector is of opinion, speaking generally, that a husbandman would be glad if he could sell his paddy on the ground at 2s. a hundredweight, and in many places the price is as low as 1s. 6d. or 1s. 8d. a hundredweight. In the low-lying *áman* lands, no second crop is obtained, but in *áus* land, and on the higher levels, a second or cold-weather crop is frequently grown. This crop, however, forms a comparatively unimportant one in the District. The above figures indicate the difficulty of fixing any exact sum as the value of the rice

crop per acre. But a fair calculation is as follows :—Taking the low average of a little over 8 *maunds* of paddy per *bighá*, or 18 cwts. per acre, and assuming the moderate average price of twelve *ánás* per *maund*, or 2s. per hundredweight of unhusked rice, the net yield to the husbandman would be £1, 16s. per acre. Straw is of little value in Bákarganj, and chiefly used for household purposes, such as thatching, and for the cattle. Deducting all expenses of rent and cost of cultivation, and allowing for second crops, straw, &c., the Collector estimates the ordinary net profit per acre to be £1, 10s. The ordinary class of husbandmen, with four acres of land, would therefore have an annual profit of £6. But it should be remembered that this is over and above the cost of cultivation, which includes an allowance for the labour of the husbandman himself.

CONDITION OF THE PEASANTRY.—Bákarganj is essentially a District of small husbandmen, where nearly every man has his own plot of ground, on which he grows sufficient for the wants of his family. Very few peasants cultivate as much as seventeen acres. A fair-sized holding would be from five to seven acres in extent, and the Collector reports that the average size of these little farms is as low as four acres. Anything below two-thirds of an acre would be considered as an exceptionally small holding, but the Collector states that a great many petty farms average from an acre to one and two-thirds. A single pair of oxen is able to cultivate five or five and a half acres of land, but not more. A farm of five acres in extent would not render a cultivator so well off as a respectable retail shopkeeper, but for the purpose of feeding a family, it would be better than a money wage of 16s. a month. The peasant class are often in debt, but they do not appear to be in the power of the village merchants and traders for advances to enable them to cultivate their fields. The general impression made upon the mind of the Collector during his annual tour through the District in 1871–72, was that the people were generally removed from poverty : the harvest that year had been an excellent one, and the lands appeared to be becoming more valuable every year. Most of the cultivators are believed to have obtained rights of occupancy, or at all events, the superior landlords seldom think of ousting them. The Collector is not aware of any cultivating proprietors in the District who pay rent direct to Government.

DOMESTIC ANIMALS.—The animals used in agriculture are oxen and buffaloes; goats, ducks, and fowls are reared as articles of

food. The only other domestic animals in the District are a few horses and ponies, dogs and cats. Large herds of buffaloes, representing a considerable amount of capital, are pastured in the uncultivated parts of the District for the sake of their milk. It is common for several owners to club together and establish a *báthán*, or grazing farm, where they tend the herd by turns, spending their time at their several homes when off duty. The value of an average cow is about £1, 10s.; of an average pair of oxen, £3; of a pair of buffaloes, £9; of a score of kids six months old, £3. Sheep are not reared in the District, but are worth about £4, 10s. a score when imported.

THE AGRICULTURAL IMPLEMENTS in use are nearly the same as in the other Districts of the Division, viz.—(1) the plough (*hál*); (2) the *mai*, consisting of a log or plank, which is dragged over the soil by bullocks, to level the ground after ploughing; (3) the harrow (*áchrá*), used in the same manner as the above on dry soil; (4) a clod-breaker (*itá mugrí*), used by the hand; (5) a *niráni*, or weeder; (6) a *kánchí*, or sickle; (7) a heavy spade (*khantá*) for digging holes, ditching, embanking, &c.; (8) a hoe (*kodálí*); (9) an axe (*kurálí*); and (10) a billhook (*dáo*). The last two are not strictly agricultural implements, but are used for a variety of domestic and other purposes. A pair of oxen or buffaloes, with the agricultural implements mentioned above, excepting the four last, would be necessary for the cultivation of what is technically known as "one plough" of ground, which is equal to about five English acres. The cattle and implements would represent a capital of about £4.

WAGES AND PRICES have considerably increased of late, the price of labour having doubled itself within the last few years. Ordinary Coolie labour is very scarce, and sometimes cannot be procured. Such men are generally paid at the rate of sixpence a day, but in former years the rate was just one half. Agricultural day-labourers get sixpence, eightpence, and even a shilling a day, or about double what they were paid a few years ago. Reapers receive a share of the crop in return for their labour. Smiths, bricklayers, and carpenters are generally paid by the job; but where this is not the case, they receive from £1, 10s. to £2 per month. Articles of food have not risen in price in the same proportion, as a comparison of the following rates, which prevailed in 1859 and in 1871, will show. The best cleaned rice was worth 3s. 9d. a hundredweight in 1859; in 1871 it was worth from 4s. 9d. to 5s. 5d. a hundredweight. Com-

mon husked rice was selling at 3s. 5d. a hundredweight in 1859, and at from 4s. to 4s. 9d. a hundredweight in 1871. Best unshelled rice (paddy) rose from 1s. 8d. a hundredweight in 1859, to from 2s. to 2s. 8d. in 1871; and common unhusked rice, which sold at 1s. 6d. in the former year, rose to from 1s. 8d. to 2s. 4d. a hundredweight in 1871. Molasses sold at 13s. 7d. a hundredweight in 1859, and at from 13s. 7d. to 16s. 4d. a hundredweight in 1871. The highest price to which rice rose during the famine of 1866 was 17s. 1d. a hundredweight for the best quality of cleaned rice, and 8s. 10d. a hundredweight for unhusked rice. At that time the difference in price between the superior and inferior quality of grain was merely nominal. No barley, Indian corn, or indigo is grown in the District. The following were the average prices ruling for miscellaneous articles of produce in 1867, according to the Report of the then Collector, given at page 191 of the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division": —*Átá*, 11s. 3d. per hundredweight; barley, 5s. 8d.; betel-nut, 17s. 5d.; chilies, 21s.; cocoa-nuts, 1s. 3d. per score; coriander seed, 3s. 5d. per hundredweight; cotton, £3, 12s. 6d. per hundredweight; *dál* (pulses of various kinds), from 5s. 4d. to 15s. 1½d. per hundredweight; eggs, 3s. 2d. per hundred; firewood, 8s. 2d. a ton; flour, £1, 0s. 6d. a hundredweight; garlic, 7s. 4d. a hundredweight; *ghi* (clarified butter), from 8½d. to 10½d. per pound, for *ghi* made from buffalo's and cow's milk respectively; *gur* or molasses, made from sugar-cane, 10s. a hundredweight; ditto, made from date juice, 12s. 7½d. a hundredweight; gram, 10s. 11d. a hundredweight; grass (dry), 2s. per 20 sheaves; jute, 8s. per hundredweight; mustard seed, 6s. 8d. per hundredweight; oil (cocoa-nut), £2, 8s. 6d. per hundredweight; oil (linseed), £2, 3s. 5d. per hundredweight; oil (mustard), £1, 10s. per hundredweight; onions, 3s. 7½d. per hundredweight; potatoes, 10s. 11d. per hundredweight; salt, from 12s. 2d. to 17s. per hundredweight; *suji* (coarse rice flour), £1, 8s. 11d. per hundredweight; sugar-cane, 1s. 4d. per twenty sticks; sugar (date), 16s. per hundredweight; straw, 1s. 4d. per 20 bundles; *til*-seed, 8s. per hundredweight; tobacco, £1 per hundredweight; turmeric, 17s. per hundredweight; and wheat, 11s. 3d. per hundredweight.

WEIGHTS AND MEASURES.—In addition to the standard bázár *man* or *maund* of 80 *tolás* to the *ser*, equivalent to 2 pounds, 0 ounces, 14 drams avoirdupois, and the *kánchi* or shorter *man* of 60 *tolás* to the *ser* = 1 pound, 8 ounces, 11 drams, the following local measures of weight are reported:—The Bákarganj *man* of 96 *tolás* to

the *ser* = 98 pounds, 11 ounces, 14 drams; the Alamganj *man* of $82\frac{5}{8}$ *tolás* = 84 pounds, 15 ounces, 12 drams; the *káni* of 72 *tolás* to the *ser* = 74 pounds, 0 ounces, 14 drams; and the *káni* of 64 *tolás* = 65 pounds, 13 ounces, 3 drams. The subdivisions of the *ser* are the same in Bákarganj as elsewhere. Long distances are generally measured by the time occupied in performing a journey; for shorter distances the *háth* or cubit of 18 inches is used. The *nal* is the standard of square measure, and varies in size in the various Fiscal Divisions from 7 feet 3 inches to 17 feet 3 inches. The day from sunrise to sunset is divided into four watches or *prahars*, and the night from sunset to sunrise into the same number; each *prahar* is divided into $7\frac{1}{2}$ *dands*, a *dand* being on an average equivalent to about 24 minutes of English time, but varies according to the seasons of the year.

Landless Labouring Classes.—In a District of peasant proprietors such as Bákarganj, where nearly every man cultivates his own patch of ground, there is no tendency towards the growth of a distinct class of day-labourers, neither owning nor cultivating fields on their own account. Some of the poorer of the petty proprietors engage themselves as hired labourers for the cultivation of their wealthier neighbours' holdings, and are generally paid at the rate of sixpence per diem, or double that amount if they use their own ploughs and bullocks. At harvest-time the District is annually invaded by immense numbers of reapers from Faridpur, who are paid by a share of the crop, generally one-fifth. Land is often cultivated on the *bargá* system, by which the cultivator uses his own cattle and implements, and receives a share of one-half of the crop, but these men can scarcely be classed in the category of hired labourers. Women are never employed in the fields, except in the case of poor Hindu widows, who are sometimes compelled to reap their own share of the family crops. Children are largely employed as cowherds, and in various sorts of light labour.

Varieties of Land Tenure.—There is not much spare land in the District, except in the forests of the Sundarban tracts. Land tenures of a favourable nature to the cultivators, and indicating the existence of surplus lands, are not common, nor are they known by any special names. In olden times, however, previous to the District being marked out in Fiscal Divisions, a tenure prevailed called *angal buri*, for the cultivation of jungle and waste lands. Many

persons undertook to cultivate such tracts, and these newly reclaimed lands were constituted *táluks*, and included in the rent roll of the nearest *zamíndár*. If the *tálukdár* died leaving heirs, the latter obtained possession of the lands; but if without heirs, the *zamíndár* managed the land on behoof of Government. The various intermediate tenures between the superior landlord and the actual cultivators are as follow :—*táluk, ausat táluk, ním ausat táluk, hawlá, ním hawlá, ausat ním hawlá, mirásh karshá*, and *káimí karshá*. The word *ním*, when used in naming a tenure, generally indicates that it is a subdivision of the parent tenure, *i.e.*, that the rights of sub-tenant do not extend to the whole, but only to a portion of the land included within the parent tenure; the word *ausat* simply means subordinate, and signifies a dependent tenure; *mirásh karshá* and *káimí karhsá* are hereditary cultivator's tenures held at a fixed rent, and practically these two represent the same thing. To this list must be added the *ijárá*, or ordinary farming lease and its sub-tenure *dar ijárá*, and which may be attached to any of the foregoing tenures. Most of the land in the District has passed from the hands of the superior landlords into those of intermediate holders, and in fact there is no District in Bengal in which the sub-division of tenures has been carried to a greater extent. Except in the case of newly formed alluvial lands, it is rare to find an instance in which there are not two or three middlemen between the proprietor of the soil and the actual cultivator. Act X. of 1859, although extensively worked, has not caused a general enhancement of rents throughout the District, but it has tended to render them uniform, and to enhance lands held on terms unduly favourable to the cultivator. An account of the working of this Act will be found on a subsequent page; also a separate chapter on Tenures.

RATES OF RENT.—Rice land rents at from 3s. to 18s. per acre, according to quality and situation; newly formed alluvial lands on which *boro* rice is grown in the cold season fetches 1s. 6d. an acre; sugar-cane and *pán* plantations, £1, 4s. an acre; high land, on which cotton, garden crops, and thatching grass are grown, from 9s. to 15s. an acre according to quality; homestead lands surrounding the dwelling, on which betel-nut, cocoa-nut, and fruit trees are cultivated, at from 9s. to 30s. an acre, according to quality and the number of trees growing upon it; land occupied by buildings pays 9s. an acre.

The above rates were returned by the Collector in February 1871,

and refer to the District in general. The rate, however, varies considerably in different parts of the country. I shall now give in detail the exact figures showing the rates paid by actual cultivators for the ordinary descriptions of crops in each subdivision. I have condensed them from a return submitted to the Government of Bengal in August 1872.

HEADQUARTERS SUBDIVISION.—Tháná Kotwálí; rate for first-class rice land, from 7s. 6¾d. to 10s. 7¼d. an acre; second-class rice land from 3s. 9¼d. to 7s. 6¾d. an acre; third-class rice land from 2s. 3¼d. to 6s. 0¾d. an acre. Some rice lands in the Headquarters Subdivision rent at 12s. an acre, but this is exceptional, the ordinary rate being about 6s. an acre. New land, and land in the neighbourhood of jungle, &c., is let as low as 2s. 3d. an acre.

MÁDÁRÍPUR SUBDIVISION.—(1) Mádáripur Police Circle; ordinary rate of rent for rice, jute, and mustard land, from 6s. 0¾d. to 7s. 6¾d. an acre. (2) Mulfatganj Police Circle; ordinary rate for rice, jute, and mustard land, from 4s. 6½d. to 6s. 0¾d. per acre; rates for sugar-cane land, from 8s. 4d. to 9s. 1d. per acre. (3) Gaurnadí Police Circle; rates of rent for high land producing *áman* or winter rice, from 8s. 4d. to 9s. 1d. per acre; rate for low lands growing *áus* rice and jute, from 6s. 0¾d. to 6s. 9¾d. per acre. (4) Kotwálípárá Police Circle; rates for land producing rice and jute, from 3s. 9¾d. to 5s. 3¾d. an acre. The Mádáripur Subdivision comprises the northern part of Bákarganj, and, with the exception of the marshy tracts in Kotwálípárá, is the highest and most civilised part of the District.

PIROZPUR SUBDIVISION.—Pirozpur Police Circle; rates for rice land, from 5s. 10½d to 11s. 9d. an acre; rates for cocoa-nut and betel-nut lands, from 11s. 9d. to 17s. 7¼d. per acre. Very little jute or sugar-cane is grown in this Subdivision, rice being the staple crop. Much of the land is very low, and the rates vary a great deal. In the large Government estate of Tuskhálí, in the Mathbáriá Police Circle, the prevailing rate is 7s. 6d., but the rates in the neighbourhood are 9s. and 10s. 6d. an acre. In *chars* and near large rivers the rates are lower, and range from 3s. to 6s. an acre.

DAKSHÍN SHÁHBÁZPUR SUBDIVISION.—Rates for first-class high rice land, from 6s. 3¾d. to 9s. 5½d. an acre; rates for second-class low rice land, from 4s. 8¼d. to 6s. 3¾d. an acre. The land in Dakshín Sháhbázpur is generally high, but there is a good deal of *char* and waste land towards the south. The staple crop of the island is rice. Jute and cotton are likewise grown, the rate of rent being the

same as for rice. The island also produces abundance of betel-nuts and cocoa-nuts, and for such land the rate is higher, namely, at the rent of homestead land.

PATUÁKHÁLÍ SUBDIVISON.—(1) Aurangpur; *áman* rice land, from 4s. 2d. to 18s. 2d. an acre; *áus* rice land, from 1s, 6d. to 15s. 5½d. an acre. (2) Bozargomedpur; both *áman* and *áus* rice land, from 9s. 1d. to 13s. 7½d. an acre. (3) Ratandí Kálikápur Fiscal Division; both *áman* and *áus* rice land, from 4s. 6½d. to 9s. 1d. an acre. (4) Chandradwíp Fiscal Division; *áman* land, from 4s. 6½d. to 15s. 10¾d. an acre; *áus* land, from 4s. 6½d. to 6s. 0¼d. an acre. (5) Jafarábád Rafiánagar Fiscal Division; both *áman* and *áus* land, from 9s. 1d. to 10s. 7¼d. an acre. (6 and 7) Khaniá Bahádurnagar, and Tappá Azímpur Fiscal Divisions; rates for both *áman* and *áus* lands, from 10s. 7¼d. to 12s. 1½d. per acre. These are the seven principal Fiscal Divisions in Patuákhálí Subdivision. There are, however, several estates south of these, situated in the Sundarbans, the rates of which vary from 4s. 6½d. to 6s. 0½d. per acre on estates situated in the proximity of the sea-shore; while for the same description of land situated further inland, the rates are from 6s. 0¾d. to 9s. 1d. per acre. The lands of these estates are assessed as one class, under the general name of paddy land, notwithstanding that other crops may be cultivated on it. A very slight difference in the rate is made, according to the nature of the soil, high lands paying a little more than low-lying fields.

No records exist in the District showing the prevailing rates of rent before or at the time of the Permanent Settlement, as the papers relating to Bákarganj before its separation from the District of Dacca Jalálpur early in the century were left in the Dacca Collectorate. Instances may be pointed out in which the rent of particular cultivators have been doubled, and many other instances in which they have been increased by one-half, but such enhancements do not appear to have been uniformly extended over any entire Fiscal Division or village.

MANURE is not used except on *pán* plantations, in which oil-cake is employed for the purpose; the cost of the manure is stated to be about 12s. an acre. Irrigation is not practised. Rotation of crops is almost unknown, and *pán* and sugar-cane are the only ones which cannot be grown year after year on the same land. In the case of these crops, it is necessary in every alternate year either to allow the field to lie fallow, or to grow some other and lighter crop upon it.

NATURAL CALAMITIES.—The District is subject to blights and floods. Droughts are unknown, and no safeguards against them seem necessary. There are two kinds of insects which occasionally injure the rice crops. The first is called *Pámaripoká*, and is a small black fly, which makes its appearance from July to September, and feeds upon the tender leaves of the newly transplanted rice, injuring, but seldom totally destroying, the crop. The other is called *Ledápoká* or *Chhánápoká*. It generally makes its appearance in the cold season when there are several consecutive cloudy days without rain, but it disappears again as soon as rain falls. It is a crawling insect, with a light-coloured body and black head, concealing itself during the day, and eating the ears of the ripening rice crop by night. It frequently does a considerable amount of mischief, and is stated, in 1851, to have materially affected the prosperity of the agricultural classes.

FLOODS are generally caused by the rising of the rivers before they enter the District, and not by excessive rainfall upon the low-lying tracts within it; but another cause of inundation consists of the incursion of sea-water in consequence of cyclones or unusually high tides. Such a flood not only causes an immediate loss of crop, but does lasting injury to the lands lying near the sea-coast, by impregnating them with salt water. The *áman* or cold-weather rice is the principal crop of Bákarganj. Although liable to considerable injury by inundation, and the consequent destruction of the seedlings on the newly-transplanted shoots, necessitating a second sowing or transplanting at unseasonable times, it never suffers total destruction. The *áus* or autumn rice, on the other hand, is a very precarious crop, and is often wholly or partially destroyed, as was the case in 1870, by inundation. In 1822 a flood occurred, which seriously affected the general prosperity of the District. In that year, the price of rice in the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, which suffered most severely, rose to the highest rate which has been known to prevail in the present century. The Magistrate of the District distributed gratuitously about 125 tons of grain, and reported that the loss of life was computed at 39,960, the loss of cattle 98,830, besides a loss of miscellaneous property valued at £132,669. It was in this inundation that the valuable records of the Collectorate were swept away and totally destroyed. Destructive floods also occurred in the years 1825, 1832, 1855, 1867, 1869, and 1870, but no general distress appears to have resulted. There are no important embankments or other protective

works against inundation in the District, and the Collector reports that the construction of such works would be impossible except at gigantic cost.

COMPENSATING INFLUENCES OF FLOODS.—In seasons when the rainfall is unusually heavy, some increase takes place in the fertility of the uplands, and it becomes profitable to cultivate exhausted lands which otherwise would not yield a profit. But the injury caused by floods to the low lands greatly exceeds the increased fertility to the higher levels. It may be set down as a general rule in Bákarganj, that the lower the water-level during the height of the rains, the better are the crops.

FAMINE WARNINGS.—The Collector states that he has been unable to ascertain the highest prices of staple grains caused by natural calamities prior to 1865, but in the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division," at the Section relating to Bákarganj, page 149, it is stated that during the famine caused by the inundation of 1822 the price of rice rose to 14s. 11d. per hundredweight. During the famine of 1866, the maximum price of paddy was 8s. 10½d. a hundredweight, and of husked rice 17s. 1d. a hundredweight. These high prices were caused, not by any failure of the crop within the District, but by the great demand from other parts of the country. Prices still range somewhat higher than they did before the famine of 1866, and it is doubtful whether they will ever again resume their former level. It is impossible to state definitely what prices for food grains might be taken as indicative of impending famine. Not only is Bákarganj a rice-exporting District, but it differs materially from other localities as regards its liability to climatic influences, inasmuch as a drought which would seriously diminish the crop elsewhere, might in this District prove rather beneficial than otherwise. If the rates for rice were as high as 17s. 1d. and for paddy 8s. 10½d. a hundredweight in January or February, or soon after the harvest had been gathered in, and if these enhanced rates were known to arise from failure of the crop within the District, the Collector states that this might safely be regarded as a warning of famine later in the year. If these rates were further increased by fifty per cent., the Collector is of opinion that relief operations on the part of Government would become necessary. It must be borne in mind, however, that the mere fact of prices doubling or trebling themselves would not necessarily indicate the existence of famine; it might merely show that the agricultural classes were profiting by the misfortunes of other Districts, as

was the case in 1866. The proportion of the population which does not directly share in the produce of the soil is so small that the increased difficulty which they would experience in supplying themselves with food at such a time need scarcely be taken into consideration. The only fact which could be taken as certainly indicating impending famine in Bákarganj, would be a total or nearly total failure of the *áman* crop, upon which the District mainly depends. The *áus* crop at the best only suffices to support, during about three months in the year, those few husbandmen who grow it; and throughout the greater part of Bákarganj the crop is not cultivated at all. The *áus* harvest could not possibly suffice for the support of the population in case of the failure of the *áman* crop. In the event of a serious famine requiring Government intervention and relief, the network of navigable rivers with which the District is covered would afford ample means of importation from neighbouring Districts and from the sea.

Foreign and Absentee Landlords.—There are several Greek, Portuguese, and Armenian landholders in the District, whose families have been settled in the country for many generations past, but the only European proprietors strictly so called, are the Messrs Morrell, and their holdings in Bákarganj are not large. Of Muhammadan landowners, 773 are registered as the proprietors of 462 estates, bearing an aggregate land assessment of £12,834, 10s. The greater part of Bákarganj is owned by absentee landlords; in fact, hardly any owners of large estates live in the District. The largest and most wealthy of these absentee proprietors is Rájá Satyánand Ghoshál, of Calcutta.

Roads.—In a District like Bákarganj, where there are so many large rivers which serve as a means of communication throughout its entire length and breadth, there is no need for many roads, and, indeed, there is not one Imperial line of road maintained by the Public Works Department. The following are five short roads within the Barisál subdivision, and which are all under local management:—(1) Road from Barisál to Jhálakátí, ten miles; average expense of maintenance during the three years ending 1870, £144. (2) Road from Rúpátalí, on the Jhálakátí road, to Nalchití, six miles; average annual cost, £71, 4s. (3) Road from Barisál to Mádhabpásá, five miles; average annual cost, £11, 6s. (4) Road from Amánatganj, a suburb of Barisál, to Táltalí, two miles; average annual expense, £38, 16s. (5) Road from Barisál to Lákhutiá, six

miles; average annual cost, *nil*, for the three years ending 1870. There are also several roads in the town of Barisál which are under the management of the Municipal Committee. In the Subdivision of Dakshín Sháhbázpur there are a few roads which have been neglected for a long period, and which it is now proposed to repair. The principal is from Daulat Khán, the chief mart in the island, to Bholá, a distance of twelve miles; and another from Bholá to Gházípurá, six miles; these roads, however, are merely foot and bridle paths, and are not adapted for wheeled traffic. There are no roads within the Subdivisions of Pirozpur and Mádárípur. No large markets have lately sprung up on the routes of traffic.

MANUFACTURES.—The only local manufactures are those of pottery, coarse cloth, oil, and *gur* or molasses. Earthenware is made in large quantities; and at Nalchití, its principal seat of manufacture, the potters show great taste in their wares. Ordinary country cloth is manufactured after the usual manner of the weavers in other parts of Bengal. The finest kind of mat is the *sítal páti*, made from the stem of the *páthirá* reed (Phrynium dichotornium). Common mats are manufactured from the *hoglá*, or large bulrush (Typha elephantinum), and from the stem of the *nal* reed (Arendo tepalis). The processes of manufacture are of the usual kind, and Bákarganj has no industrial specialty whatever. The condition of the manufacturing classes is fairly prosperous. Manufactures are carried on by the people in their own houses and on their own account; the employment of hired labour for such purposes is rare.

COMMERCE AND TRADE.—A list of the principal towns and seats of commerce has been given on a previous page. The trade of Nalchití is said to be decaying, in consequence of the silting up of the river on which it is situated. Besides these fixed marts, there are several religious fairs or *melás* held annually, at which a considerable trade is carried on. The following is a list of the most important of these gatherings:—(1) Kálísurí fair, held every year in the month of November. There is a large banian-tree here, which is held sacred among the Musalmáns of the District, and at which pilgrims come and offer up cattle in sacrifice. The fair is said to be attended by about twelve thousand persons. (2) Kulsokátí fair, is held in the month of November every year, and lasts for a week. This fair was first started about fifteen years ago, and is attended by about eight thousand persons. (3) Lákutiá fair, also held in November, lasts for seven days, being attended by about

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ten thousand persons. (4) Nalchirá fair, held in April for seven days, and attended by about three thousand persons. This fair is celebrated for the horse-racing which takes place. (5) Pirozpur fair is held in March on the occasion of the *Doljátrá* festival, and continues for a week, being visited by about five thousand persons. (6) Bhandáriá fair is held every year in the month of April, at the time of the Asok Ashtami Snán, and lasts for seven days. About 4000 persons gather at this fair, and the people enter keenly into horse-racing and other sports. (7 and 8) Jhálakátí and Bánaripárá fairs, both held in November at the *Diwálí* festival, and each attended by about eight thousand persons. None of these fairs, however, are of more than local importance. The trade of the District is principally carried on at the permanent markets, to which these fairs are subsidiary. Rice, areca-nuts, cocoa-nuts, and *sundrí* timber are exported to a very large extent. There is also considerable export trade in jute and *pán* leaves from the Mádárípur Subdivision. None of the manufactures of the District are exported, with the exception of pottery. The principal articles of import are salt, tobacco, oil, oil-seeds, pulses of various kinds, hardware, cloth, shoes, &c. The exports far exceed the imports in value, but the District does not seem to derive the full benefit of this activity of its exportations and rice-trade, as the Collector states that probably the greater part of the excess value of the exports over the imports goes into the pockets of non-resident landholders and heads of commercial firms, as well as of the non-resident class of traders and professional men who temporarily carry on business in the District, but whose families live elsewhere.

Capital and Interest.—Coin is sometimes hoarded, but accumulations are more commonly employed in trade, in the purchase of land, or in usury. In small loan transactions, where the borrower pawns some article equal in value to the amount of the money lent, the rate of interest is at the rate of from seven pence halfpenny to fifteen pence in the pound sterling per mensem, or from 37½ to 75 per cent. per annum. The rate in large transactions, when a mortgage is given, varies from one to two per cent. per month. If a husbandman is compelled to borrow money in order to cultivate his land, the usual arrangement is for the borrower to repay the loan at harvest-time by the delivery of paddy to the value of half as much again as the amount of the loan, the calculation being made according to the rate at which grain

was selling at the time of borrowing. That is, if a man borrows a rupee in June when paddy was selling at a hundredweight and a half per rupee, he would have to give at harvest-time two and a quarter hundredweights of paddy, whatever might be the price at that time. Grain, however, is always much cheaper after the harvest than it is in the middle of the year. The usual selling price of land is reported at twelve years' purchase, in which case the money invested would yield 8⅓ per cent. Native banking establishments are carried on at the towns of Barisál, Jhálakátí, Sáhibganj, and Nalchití, but loans are conducted by all classes of the community, whether agricultural or commercial, who have spare money at their disposal.

IMPORTED CAPITAL.—No trade or manufacture is at present conducted in Bákarganj either with European capital or by European agency. Several indigo factories formerly existed, but the manufacture has long since ceased.

NEWSPAPERS.—One newspaper is published in the District, but is printed in Calcutta, under the title of the *Barisál Bárttábaha*, a monthly newspaper in the Bengali character, and with a circulation of about 150 subscribers.

INCOME-TAX.—The Collector estimates the total value of incomes of the District, as assessed for the purposes of the Income-Tax Act of 1870—that is, the total amount of all incomes over £50 a year—at between £500,000 and £600,000. But the net amount of income-tax realised in 1870–71 amounted only to £12,415, 10s., the rate of assessment being 3⅛ per cent.

REVENUE AND EXPENDITURE.—Like all the other Districts of Eastern Bengal, Bákarganj has steadily advanced in prosperity since its administration came into the hands of English officers, and especially of late years, since 1858, when the government passed to the Crown. From the time of the acquisition of Bengal by the British, up to the end of 1817, Bákarganj formed a part of the Dacca Collectorate. It was then formed into a separate Collectorship, with the principal object of encouraging enterprising persons to cultivate the immense tracts of waste lands which formed parts of, or were adjacent to, the District. In 1818, the first year after its separation from Dacca, the net revenue of the District amounted to £96,438, 10s., and the net civil expenditure to £13,647, 14s. Two years later, in 1820, the net District revenue had slightly decreased to £95,709, 2s., while the net expenditure on

civil administration
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and in 1860–61 t
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In 1870–71 the
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Bákarganj District
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BALANCE-SHEET

	REVENU
1.	Land Revenue .
2.	Stamp Duties .
3.	Profit and Loss .
4.	Post-Office Receipts
5.	Revenue from Mis-cellaneous Taxes (*sayer*), Excise and Opium . .
	Total

BALANCE-SHEET OF

REVENU

1.	Land Revenue	£
2.	Stamp Duties,	
3.	Excise Duties	
4.	Post-Office Receipts	
5.	Salt	
6.	Profit and Loss	
7.	Law Charges	
8.	Committee of Records	
9.	Fees of Native Revenue Collector (*Tahsildárs*)	

Total

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£22,699, 4s. Salt
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BALANCE-SHEET OF BÁKARGANJ DISTRICT FOR THE YEAR 1870–71.

REVENUE.				EXPENDITURE.			
1. Land Revenue (current demand)	£142,232	6	0	1. Salary of Gazetted Officers	£5,497	14	9
2. Forests	122	14	0	2. Collector's and Magistrate's Establishment, Travelling Allowances, Contingencies, &c.	4,205	13	0
3. Sale of Government Estates, Fees, &c.	2,836	2	0	3. Khás Mahal Expenses	105	13	3
4. Peon's Fee (revenue)	897	2	0	4. Excise	696	18	0
5. Excise	6,381	2	0	5. Income-Tax	689	9	1
6. Income-Tax	12,352	18	4	6. Law and Justice	9,947	17	3
7. Stamps	21,515	9	4	7. Medical	1,152	2	4
8. Civil Courts	3,220	4	4	8. Jail (exclusive of Police Guard)	1,497	2	0
9. Criminal Courts	1,326	4	0	9. Regular Police	10,755	16	0
10. Jail Manufactures and Convict Labour	259	13	3	10. Municipal Police	306	0	0
11. Miscellaneous Receipts	1,099	8	0	11. Town Fund	1,360	14	9
12. Town Fund (Act VI. of 1868)	312	0	5	12. Chaukidárí Fund	481	1	2
13. Chaukidárí Fund (Act XX. of 1856)	362	19	1	13. Pound Fund	217	19	7
14. Ferry Fund	211	1	0	14. Circuit-House Fund	19	19	6
15. Pound Fund	306	7	10	15. Zamíndárí Dák Fund	1,380	8	11
16. Circuit-House Fund	21	0	0	16. Amalgamated District Road Fund	693	12	0
17. Zamíndárí Dák Fund	2,190	4	6	17. Fund for Improvement of Government Estates	694	2	9
18. Road Cess Fund	299	15	6	18. Canal Tolls	403	3	0
19. Fund for Improvement of Government Estates	830	0	0	19. Post-Office	1,200	13	0
20. Sheriff's Fees, and Pleaders' Examination Fees	38	8	0	20. Education	3,416	7	7
21. Canal Tolls	2,632	3	0	21. Ecclesiastical	180	0	0
22. Post-Office	1,803	8	0				
23. Education (Schooling Fees and Subscriptions, &c.)	2,194	10	5				
Total	£203,445	1	0	Total	£44,902	7	11

LAND SETTLEMENTS.—The following paragraphs with regard to the land revenue of the District under the Mughuls, and the early days of our rule, are condensed from Mr Sutherland's Report on

Bákarganj, pp. 150–154 of the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division." I have to trust to him for their accuracy.

In treating of the early settlement of this District and its revenue system, it may not be out of place to refer briefly to the four historical Settlements of Bengal in the pre-British period, for the details of which I am indebted to Mr J. Grant's "Analysis of the Revenue of Bengal." The first is the well-known Settlement in the time of Akbar under his eminent Finance Minister Rájá Todar Mall. This Settlement was made in 1582. The Khálsá, or State lands, were divided into 19 *Sarkárs*, which included 682 *Parganás*. Bákarganj was, no doubt, included in the *Sarkár* of Sonárgáon, which comprised 52 *Parganás*, and was assessed at £25,828. The next Settlement of Bengal was made in 1658 by Prince Shujá, the son of Sháh Jahán and Viceroy of Bengal, during his short-lived supremacy, after he had conspired to depose his father, and previous to his complete defeat by his brother Aurangzeb, and his flight to Arákán, and his obscure ending. This Settlement shows 34 *Sarkárs*, which included 1350 *Parganás*, whose rental was assessed at £1,311,590. His readjustment is of importance, as it includes, for the first time, the Sundarbans under the name of Murádkháná. The next Settlement of Bengal was made by Nawáb Jafar Khán, Viceroy of Bengal, in A.D. 1721, in the reign of Muhammad Sháh. A few years before this, *i.e.*, in 1707, the seat of Government was removed from Dacca, then known as Jahángírnagar, to Murshidábád. This Settlement re-constituted the whole province of Bengal into 13 *Chaklás*, subdivided into 1600 *Parganás*. Bákarganj and the Sundarbans were included in Chaklá Jahángírnagar, which composed 236 *Parganás*, at a rental of £192,829. The last Settlement was made by Nawáb Kásim Alí Khán, better known as Mír Kásim, two years before our acquisition of the Díwání in 1765 A.D. The Permanent Settlement in Bengal is supposed to be based on this Settlement, so far as could be gathered from the papers furnished to Government at that time. The Settlement of Mír Kásim in 1763 left the previous Settlement of 1721 untouched, so far as the Government lands were concerned, but went more exactly into details regarding the unappropriated or *jágír* lands. Under orders of the Board of Revenue, dated 29th December 1790, a Novennial Settlement came into operation from the 20th May 1791, and Mr Massie, the Collector, complains bitterly of the *benámí* system which prevailed at that time. He observes in his letter dated 24th March 1801:—"Sufficient regard

was not paid in this District at the conclusion of the Decennial Settlement to the ascertaining and recording the names of the actual proprietors of rent-paying lands for the time being, in consequence of which the Government not unfrequently suffers losses in its revenue, &c." The Decennial Settlement began in 1791 (some time later than in other parts of Bengal, and hence sometimes called here the Novennial Settlement). The revenue jurisdiction of Bákarganj at present (1873) comprises fifty-four Fiscal Divisions, or *Parganás*, the total land revenue realised in 1871–72 being £143,156. A list of the Fiscal Divisions, showing the number of estates comprised in each, together with the area and amount of land revenue, &c., will be found on a subsequent page. But the Government records disclose special points of interest in the history of five of the Fiscal Divisions, namely, Bozargomedpur, Chandradwíp, Salímábád, Idalpur, and Kotwálípárá.

PARGANÁ BOZARGOMEDPUR.—Of the five, the most interesting is Bozargomedpur Fiscal Division, from its early history in connection with Rájá Rájballabh, the Finance Minister, and afterwards Governor of Dacca, under the Nawáb Názim of Bengal; from its numerous subordinate tenures; and from the trouble which it gave to the Collector at the time of the Permanent Settlement, and for some few years after it. In the Settlement of 1721 A.D. by Nawáb Jafar Khán, the rental of Parganá Bozargomedpur was entered at £465. In 1867 it was returned at £34,059. Bozargomedpur, with the Fiscal Divisions of Rájnagar and Kártikpur, Shujábád, formed the *zamíndárí* of Rájá Rájballabh, into whose possession the property came in 1761 A.D. The assessment (*jamábandí*) of the estate, formed after a careful measurement made the previous year, amounted to £20,903. Previously to Rájá Rájballabh's death, he subdivided his estate by creating Bozargomedpur and Rájnagar into a *zamíndárí* in the name of the god Lakshmí-Náráyan, and Shujábád Fiscal Division into a separate estate in the name of the goddess Durgá. Rájballabh's death opened the way to intrigues and frauds not unknown in the present day. One of his grandsons, Pítámbar Sen, claimed a five-sixteenths share of the property; and on the latter's death, his widow, Sonámukhí, revived the claim on the ground of Rájá Rájballabh's loyalty to the East India Company,—a loyalty which cost him his life at the hands of the Nawáb Kásim Alí Khán.

Bozargomedpur comprised 594 *táluks*, or *shikmí* tenures as they

are locally called. The papers of Mr G. P. Thompson, Head Assistant to the Collector of Dacca, show that the gross Government revenue (*sadr jamá*), about 1760, was *Bárí* Rs. 2,39,653, from which Rs. 5798 were deducted for deserted lands. Mr Massie, the Collector, in his letter dated 22d December 1801, states that "the deserted lands had been brought, either wholly or in part, into cultivation since Mr Thompson's time, and had been re-annexed to the rent-roll of the *Jamá*, so that the net *mufassal jamá* is now what the gross Fiscal Division was before, viz., *Bárí* Rs. 2,39,653-15-0, from which deducting báttá at the rate of 3 per cent., viz., Rs. 7118-1-5-1, the amount of the mufassal *jamá* in the *sikká* specie is Rs. 2,32,534-14-9-3." A Parganá which included a great many independent subordinate tenures naturally gave constant trouble to the Collector in the collection of the Government revenue. The early records are full of the steps taken at different times to realise Government arrears. In 1801 A.D., the Fiscal Division was bought in by Government for arrears of revenue; and after having been held during many years under *khás* management, it was finally settled in 1857. Some time ago the right of Government to resume several *shikmí táluks* was duly confirmed by the Civil Court. The proprietary rights of Government in very many of the estates have been sold under the Board's rules.

PARGANÁ SALÍMÁBÁD.—The assessment of this Fiscal Division under the Muhammadan Government, by the Settlement of 1721, was £4316, 12s. In 1867 it was returned at £12,119. A large portion of this Fiscal Division belongs to the Ghoshál family. The old records show that a five-sixteenths share belonged to Gokul Chandra Ghoshál, whilst Kálísankar Ghoshál bought a three-sixteenths share at a public sale for £2600. The share of Gokul Chandra Ghoshál had previously belonged to Bhawání Charan Rái, and had thence passed into the hands of Kásináth Rái, and lastly became the property of Gokul Chandra Ghoshál, an ancestor of the family which was ennobled by Lord Ellenborough during the Sindh war, when the title of Rájá was conferred on Kálí Sankar Ghoshál for having bought up a large amount of Government securities at a time when public credit was very low. The Ghoshál family had long held the half share of Salímábád. The late Rájá Satya Charan Ghoshál was a very liberal-minded man, and did a great deal of good in this District. He spent much money on a road to Jhálakátí, the headquarters of his estate, where he had built an imposing

mansion, and laid out gardens. Jhálakátí, or, as it is now called, Mahárájganj, has become a *bandar* or mart of great importance in the Eastern Districts. A petition presented by Mr Domingo de Silva to the Judge on 20th March 1805, and sent by him to Government, whence it was forwarded to the Collector for report through the Board, throws considerable light on the early history of the Fiscal Division. From this petition it would appear that Salímábád first composed ten Parganás, viz., Tappá Havilí Salímábád, Sundarkul Rudrapur Tappá Jahánpur, Parganá Bangáon, Tappá Sultánábád, Tappá Sultánpur, Parganá Kásimpur, Parganá Názírpur, Parganá Rájor, Tappá Havilí Nimak Mahal, Parganá Sibpur. These ten Parganás formed the whole of Parganá Salímábád, which was originally divided into two estates; the larger estate was afterwards equally subdivided into two estates, and one of these was again subdivided into two equal shares. It is one of these last shares, together with the five-sixteenths share bought by Kálí Sankar Ghoshál, that still belongs to the Ghoshál family. The lands of this Fiscal Division were long uncultivated, owing to its being a seat of the manufacture of salt. It is now one of the most profitable estates in this District.

Parganá Chandradwíp.—This Fiscal Division was assessed at £660 at the time of the Muhammadan Settlement of 1721. The rental in 1867 was returned at £20,138. The collection of the revenue of this Fiscal Division was a source of constant trouble to Government. It was under attachment for years; and, after fruitless endeavours to realise outstanding balances, it was put up for sale in 1799 A.D. At the time of the Decennial Settlement it was offered at the assessment of 1789, viz., £8972, 10s. One source of arrears lay in the very many independent *táluks* into which the Fiscal Division was subdivided. Among these were some very intricate rent-free tenures, particularly the *Nánkár* and *Hissázát*. The latter were lands originally exempted from the payment of revenue during the time of the native Government in consideration of the personal services of the zamíndár, and his supplying troops for repelling the incursions of the Maghs. Under instructions from Government, the Board eventually directed that *Nánkár* and *Hissázát* lands should be included in *málguzárí* or rent-paying lands.

Parganá Idalpur.—This Fiscal Division appears as the most troublesome in the whole District. So far back as 1790, the Col-

lector objected to settle the Parganá with the former proprietors, who were generally known as the Chaudhrís of Idalpur. The Board, however, in their letter dated 29th April 1790, directed the Collector to offer the Decennial Settlement to the Chaudhrís at the rental fixed in 1789, and thought that, in the absence of satisfactory proof of the profligacy of character with which the Collector charged them, they should have the first offer of the Decennial Settlement. The Fiscal Division had to be attached for arrears in 1791, and the arrears due from the proprietors could only be enforced after a decree of the Civil Court. This state of things went on for years. The Board, in their letter dated 20th July 1804, gave the proprietors one more chance, and directed the Collector to deliver over possession of the Parganá to the proprietors, on the distinct understanding that if they offered any further opposition, or showed any recusancy in the payment of their rents, the estate would be put up to sale. A few years afterwards, *i.e.*, in 1812, the Parganá was finally put up for sale, and bought by Mohiní Mohan Tagore, of Calcutta, an uncle of the celebrated Dwárkánáth Tagore. A very serious affray took place when the auction-purchaser ventured to take possession of his property, in consequence of the armed resistance offered to him by the Chaudhrís, the ex-proprietors of Idalpur. The transfer to the Tagores was attended with satisfactory results. The Government revenue has never been in jeopardy since that time, and the cultivators are, on the whole, said to be better cared for in this than in any other Fiscal Division in the District.

PARGANÁ KOTWÁLÍPÁRÁ.—The Government rental of this Fiscal Division at the time of the Muhammadan Settlement of 1721 was assessed at £692, 12s. In 1867 it was returned at £244, 18s. This is of some importance, as the present rental shows a considerable decrease on the former assessment,—a fact which can only be explained by the existence of infinitesimal shares in the Fiscal Division. It is a striking fact that, whilst the value of land has increased everywhere else in the District, and whilst the Government revenue has also increased in every other Fiscal Division, Kotwálípárá alone shows a decided decrease. The early records make but little reference to this Fiscal Division, which is remarkable for its almost infinitesimal subdivision of landed property. In 1867 there were no less than 502 estates borne on its rent-roll, of which 184 paid a rent of less than 2s. a year

to Government. The 28th June is the last day of payment fixed for all estates paying an annual rental of less than £1; and it is no uncommon thing for a pice, or even a pie (the twelfth part of an *ánd* = half a farthing), to be paid in as the balance of the smaller estates. It is not surprising that a Fiscal Division which comprises so many petty landholders should be involved in endless litigation. So serious was this difficulty, that the whole Fiscal Division was attached by the Civil Court in May 1815, and only released in June 1864. Quarrels among the several proprietors soon broke out again, and the Collector, in 1867, reported that a second attachment by the Civil Court was only a matter of time. This Fiscal Division, lying as it does in some of the most marshy lands of the District, is very much out of cultivation, and the Collector stated (in 1867) that the only hope for improvement was to take the first chance of arrears of revenue, and to bring it to the hammer. In the hands of a single wealthy and enterprising proprietor, Kotwálípárá, properly drained and embanked, might be converted into one of the most fertile tracts in the District.

THE DISTRICT LAND-TAX, the principal source of revenue, has increased from £89,566 in 1818 to £143,156 in 1871–72. In 1818 there were 4461 estates on the rent-roll of the District, held by 5088 registered proprietors or coparceners, paying a total land revenue of £89,566, representing an average payment of £20, 2s. by each estate, or £17, 12s. by each individual proprietor or coparcener. In 1850 the number of separate estates was 4208, possessed by 5160 proprietors or coparceners, and yielding a total land-tax of £105,012, the average payment for each estate being £25, and by each proprietor or partner £20, 8s. In 1870–72 there were 4729 estates, held by 5960 proprietors, who were assessed at a total land revenue of £143,156, 16s., representing an average payment of £30, 5s. by each estate, and £24 by each proprietor. These averages fairly represent the state of landed property in the District.

MODE OF COLLECTION OF GOVERNMENT REVENUE.—The following statement of Government procedure for realisation of rent is extracted from Mr Collector Sutherland's Report on Bákarganj, printed at page 161 of the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division":—"The revenue on account of estates of Decennial Settlement, and of those settled in perpetuity, is realised on the

latest days of payment, which are 12th January, 28th March, 28th June, and 28th September. If the revenue of any estate is not paid on or before the latest day of payment, it is realised by the sale of the estate; if the sale proceeds do not entirely meet the dues of Government, the balance may be recovered by the sale of the defaulter's other property, movable as well as immovable. This, however, is never necessary in the case of permanently-settled estates. The revenue on account of permanently-settled estates in the Government Fiscal Division of Bozargomedpur and Darichar Mahal is paid according to instalments. If the revenue of any instalment falls into arrears, it is realised by issue of warrants on the defaulter, and by attachment and sale of his property. If the arrears are not paid in at the end of the year, the rights and interests of the defaulter in the estate are put up for sale under Regulation VIII. of 1835, and Act VII. of 1865. The revenues on account of temporarily-settled estates in Parganá Bozargomedpur and Darichar Mahal are also paid according to instalments. If the revenue of any instalment falls into arrears, it is realised by issue of warrants, and by attachment and sale of the defaulting farmer's property. The revenue from farmers of resumed *jágír* and Government-purchased estates is paid according to instalments. If the revenue of any instalment falls into arrears, it is realised from the deposit of the defaulter, and by the sale of the property of his security. If the Government dues are not wholly realised from the deposit and by the sale of the security's property, the balance is recovered by the sale of the movable and immovable property of the defaulter. The revenue from farmers of the Sundarban estates is realised according to instalments. If the revenue of any instalment falls into arrears, it is realised by the sale of the rights and interests of the defaulter under Act XI. of 1859. The revenue on account of estates under the Court of Wards is collected through the Manager-General. The revenue from attached estates is collected through the Manager-General within the latest days of payment. If the revenue is not paid within any of the latest days, through the negligence of the proprietor of any portion of an estate which is not under attachment, it is realised at the end of the year by the sale of the estate. This practice also applies to estates under partition (*batwárá*)."

THE LAND LAWS.—The Collector in 1867 reported that there

is scarcely a District in Bengal where Act X. of 1859 is so thoroughly worked as in Bákarganj. Since the passing of the Act, the number of rent-suits instituted in the courts has been so great as to lead to a special report being called for, dated 19th January 1867. The number, however, has fallen off somewhat of late years, as the following comparative statement will show. In 1861–62 the number of original suits instituted under the provisions of this law was no less than 12,576, besides 5104 miscellaneous applications; in 1862–63 there were 8931 original suits, and 7882 miscellaneous applications; in 1866–67 there were 7471 original suits, and 7836 miscellaneous applications; and in 1868 the numbers were 6669 and 8060 respectively. A very large proportion of these cases were *ex parte* decrees, an indication of an unhealthy state of feeling between landlord and tenant. The Collector, in his letter of January 1867, states that one cause of there being so many *ex parte* cases in his District is that it is found in some instances cheaper to collect rents through the Courts than by means of the usual staff of Collectors. As an instance of this fact, he mentioned one of the wealthiest landlords, who declared that he found it cheaper to sue his tenants for rent, than to keep up an expensive collecting establishment. This is certainly a use to which it was never intended that the Act should be applied, and it is gratifying to know that these cases were gradually decreasing in number.

Protection to Person and Property has steadily increased of late years. In 1818, the year following that in which Bákarganj was formed into a separate District, there was but one Magisterial and three Revenue and Civil Courts in the whole District; in 1850 the number of Magisterial Courts had increased to three, and the Revenue and Civil Courts to ten in number; in 1862 the numbers were ten and eighteen; and in 1869, eight and fifteen respectively. The number of covenanted English officers at work throughout the year was three in 1818 and four in 1869.

Police.—In 1818, the machinery for protecting the District consisted of 182 foot constables, and 48 officers, the cost of officering the force from the rank of Head Constable upwards, amounting to £794. In 1860 there were 183 foot constables, and 46 officers, the cost of the latter amounting to £2154. At the present day, for police purposes, the District is divided into eighteen police circles, with twelve outpost stations. The police force consists of the Regular

District Police, a Village Watch, and a small Municipal force for the town of Barisál. At the close of 1871, the Regular Police consisted of the following strength:—3 European officers, receiving a total salary of £1620 per annum; 102 subordinate officers, of whom three are Eurasians and the rest natives, maintained at a total cost of £4078, or an average annual pay of £39, 19s. 7d. each; and 478 native foot constables, maintained at a total cost of £3374, 8s., equal to an average annual pay of £7, 1s. 2d. a year for each man. Total Regular Force of all ranks, 583. The total cost of the Regular Police of all ranks, including travelling allowances, pay of office establishment, and contingencies, amounted to £11,186. The area of the District, as returned by the Surveyor-General in 1871, is 4939·13 square miles; and the population, as ascertained by the Census of 1872, is 2,377,433 souls. According to this basis of calculation, there is one regular policeman to every 8·47 square miles of area, or one to every 4078 of the population, maintained at an average cost of £2, 5s. 3d. per square mile, or a fraction over one penny per head of the population. Attached to the Regular Police is a River Patrol, consisting of five boats, and manned by a crew of 35 men. The cost, which is included in the above, amounts to £312 per annum. The Village Watch, or rural police, is a force which in 1871 consisted of 5135 men, maintained at a cost of £18,486, paid by the landholders and villagers; the average pay of each village watchman being £3, 12s. a year, besides a small plot of ground rent free. According to the above calculations of area and population, there is one village watchman to every 9·6 square miles, or one to every 463 of the population. The cost of maintaining this force is £3, 14s. 10d. per square mile, or about 1¾d. per head of the population. Each village watchman has, on an average, 62 houses under his charge. The Municipal Police is a small force, consisting of 1 subordinate officer and 52 men, stationed at the towns of Barisál, Nalchití, Jhálakátí, and Daulat Khán. The cost of maintenance amounted in 1871 to £403, 14s., defrayed out of the municipal receipts. Including, therefore, the Regular Force, the Municipal Police, and the Village Watch, the police force of the District consists of a total of 5771 men of all ranks, maintained at a total cost of £30,075. Compared with the area and population, there is therefore one police officer to every ·85 square miles, or one to every 412 of the population. The cost

of protecting person and property in Bákarganj, amounts to £6, 1s. 9d. per square mile of area, or a fraction over 3d. per head of the population. During the year 1870, the police conducted 426 cognisable cases, and obtained convictions in one half of them, or in 222 cases. In the following year, 1871, there was a very great increase in the number of cognisable cases, the number ascertained to have occurred being 2082, the percentage of final convictions to men brought to trial being 40·6. In serious cases, the percentage of detections to offences committed was very small. No fewer than 32 murders were reported as having been committed during the year, but detection only followed in 8 instances. Sixteen cases of murder occurred in the following year; and, with regard to this crime, Bákarganj enjoys the unenviable reputation of having more murders than any other District in Bengal. Out of 8 gang robberies, which were reported to have occurred in 1870, only 1 case was brought home. In 1871, no fewer than 28 cases of gang robbery are reported, of which conviction followed only in 1. The value of property stolen in 1870 is reported at £1167, of which only £273, or 23 per cent., was recovered.

Criminal Classes.—I take the following paragraph from Mr J. H. Reilly's "Police Report":—"It is difficult to explain why the crime of murder is so common in Bákarganj. On asking the people, the only answer they give is that 'the men of the Bháti Des (tidal country) are very passionate.' The people are quite right that the men in the southern portion of Bákarganj are prone to violent and sudden outbursts of passion. I attribute this disposition to freedom from all wholesome social restraints, and to the feeling of independence in having money at their command, which has a tendency to make these men domineering. In the older Districts it is well known that the inhabitants congregate together for mutual protection against robbers, and live in communities. The country is divided into clusters of houses forming villages, with the cultivated land lying round each village. The men and women associate with each other, and are acquainted with each other's affairs. But in Bákarganj the features of the country are very different, and there are, strictly speaking, no villages. Each man builds his homestead on his own land, generally on the highest spot appertaining to his holding, without any reference to his neighbours. The consequence is, that the homesteads are far

apart from each other, with dense plantations of cocoa-nut and betel-nut surrounding each homestead. Families, for this reason, have little communication with each other, and owing to the numerous *kháls* or watercourses, and the swampy nature of the country, neighbourly visits are seldom exchanged between them. I believe this isolation of families has a great effect upon the character of the people. In the older Districts, owing to the social relationships subsisting between families, domestic disputes are settled either by neighbours or by a *Panchâyet* of the villagers, and a man finds himself restrained in his temper and manners by the fact that the eyes of his neighbours are upon him; if he beats his wife, it is known at once in the village, and forms the gossip of his friends. But in Bákarganj, owing to the isolation of families, the owner of the homestead is sole arbiter and ruler, independent of every social restraint. If a man of bad temper, he often develops into a despot or domestic tyrant. This will explain how a man of this lordly disposition, whose pride has been fostered by wifely homage, when returning home after a hard day's ploughing, and finding his rice uncooked or cold, seizes a club or a knife, and either batters or hacks his wife to death. It is crimes of this class that are so common in the District—hasty and violent ebullitions of temper, leading to sudden murder. I believe the household habits of the people, caused by the secluded lives they lead, will account in a great measure for the social and domestic murders so prevalent in the District. The prevention of murder among such a race is not the work of the police officer; it is the work of the schoolmaster and teacher, who by inculcating a purer religion and a higher standard of humanity, may civilise these savages, and soften their hearts and manners; until that is effected, murder will continue to be common in the District." Gang robberies are also of very frequent occurrence in Bákarganj. This crime is generally committed by gangs of professional robbers, who are known to each other, and who enjoy great facilities for crime from the only practicable mode of communication in this District, viz., by boats. Nothing but an efficient river police will be able to cope thoroughly with the organised river robberies, which are common. The numerous subdivisions of land-tenure give constant occasion for riots and affrays. In a District like Bákarganj, where land-tenures are so complicated, and title to property so contested, it is not to be wondered at that riots should take place. A very large number

of cases are instituted for enticing away married women. There is no offence of more constant occurrence in the District than this, a circumstance which may be explained in various ways. Early marriages, domestic quarrels arising out of the peculiar constitution of the Musalmán household, pecuniary temptations, strong passion and love of intrigue, combine to make breaches of the marriage law of very common occurrence. In this class of offences Musalmáns are almost always implicated, and such cases are for the most part unknown amongst the Hindus, except those of the very lowest castes.

The Bediyás are a class of professional thieves. In Bákarganj and other Districts of Eastern Bengal, these people live in boats, wandering from village to village at fair times, or to the different bázárs. These people are thus described in the Police Report for 1871:—"They are expert pickpockets and notorious gamblers. Their boats are of one uniform pattern, resembling an egg in shape. They are rapidly embracing Muhammadanism, with a firm determination not to live on shore. There is a well understood rule with them that at every encampment the men and women must be on board their boats before the jackal's howl is heard in the evening; any member absenting himself at this time, more especially a female, is instantly put out of caste. Beyond their extreme expertness in pilfering they are comparatively harmless."

Jail Statistics.—In 1857–58, the total number of prisoners admitted into the District Jail as well as the Subdivisional lock-ups was 662. The number discharged during the year included 40 transferred, 613 released, and 6 escaped, and 27 deaths: total, 686. The ratio of admissions into hospital amounted to 110·17 of the mean jail population, the proportion of deaths being 5·84 per cent. of the mean jail population. In 1860–61, the total number of prisoners received in the jail and lock-up amounted to 1134; the discharges were as under:—transferred, 378; released, 839; escaped, 5; died, 64; executed, 3: total, 1289. The total admissions into hospital were 124·58 per cent., and the deaths 15·27 per cent. of the mean jail population. In 1870, the total number of prisoners received in the jail and lock-ups amounted to 1572. The average daily number of prisoners in jail during the year was 393, or one criminal always in jail to every 6048 of the population. The prisoners discharged during the year were as follows:—transferred, 23; released, 1549; escaped, 8; died, 36; executed, 1;

total, 1617. The total admissions into hospital were 104·83 per cent., and the deaths 9·16 per cent. of the average jail population. The average term of residence of each prisoner in jail was 168 days. More than half the number of prisoners who were received into the jail were in a bad state of health on admission. The diseases from which they chiefly suffered were intermittent fever, diarrhœa, splenetis, rheumatism, dyspepsia, and colic. Notwithstanding this, the medical officer reports that the jail was healthy; but it is clear that the healthiness can only be taken in a comparative sense. The death-rate was lower in 1870 by 2·07 per cent. than in 1869, and the sickness rate for 1870 and the preceding five years was respectively 104 and 146 per cent. of the average number of prisoners in jail.

The average gross cost of maintenance of prisoners, excluding the cost of the jail police guards, amounted to £4, 9s. 9d. per head in 1857–58, and to £4, 14s. 5d. per head in 1860–61. In 1870, the cost per head amounted to £4, 10s. 5½d., exclusive of £1, 6s. 3d. per head for the cost of the police guard, making a total cost of £5, 16s. 8½d. per head to Government. No materials exist showing the separate cost of the police jail guard prior to 1870. The gross cost of the jail and lock-ups, including the prison guard, amounted in 1870 to £1932, 3s. 9d.

A certain proportion of the cost of jail maintenance, however, is defrayed by the prisoners' own labour. Prison manufactures have been carried on in Bákarganj jail for a period of twenty-eight years. In 1857–58, the gross receipts from prison labour amounted to £165, 7s. 5d., and the charges to £54, 18s. 4d., leaving a profit of £110, 9s. 1d., the average earning of each prisoner engaged in manufactures being £1, 4s. 3d. An 1860–61, the receipts from jail manufacture amounted to £367, 2s. 9d., and the charges to £177, 18s. 6d., leaving a profit of £189, 4s. 3d., the average earning of each prisoner engaged on manufactures being £1, 9s. 4d. In 1870, the total receipts from articles of jail produce amounted to £685, 15s., and the expenditure to £505, 9s. 9d., leaving a profit of £180, 5s. 3d., the average earning of each prisoner employed in manufactures being £2, 3s. 5d. Deducting the profits derived from prison labour from the gross cost of the jail in 1870, there remains a net charge to Government of £1751, 18s. 6d. for guarding and maintaining the prisoners of the District. The number of prisoners employed on remunerative prison labour in 1870 was 83; viz., 7 in

gardening, 16 in manufacturing cloth, 11 in bamboo rattan or reed work, 36 in manufacturing bricks and tiles, 8 in flour-grinding, 2 as carpenters, and 3 as bakers.

DISTRICT EDUCATIONAL STATISTICS.—As may be expected in a society almost wholly composed of petty husbandmen, of whom the majority are Muhammadans of the most bigoted tenets, education in Bákarganj is in a backward state. The Collector of the District states that the chief reason of this seems to be the want of an educated and comfortable middle class. Except at the Civil Station of Barisál, the community consists of a few traders and land agents, and an undistinguished crowd of petty landholders, peasants, and fishermen. These men are all intent on earning their daily rice, and as they do not see how education will help either them or their sons towards this, they care nothing about it. Almost as soon as a boy can walk alone, he is employed to tend his father's cattle: and when he is a little older, he rows in the boat, or climbs the *Supári* trees to gather the betel-nuts, &c. Even the little girls are made use of, and may be seen staggering home from the river bank under the weight of water-pots which are almost as big as themselves. The Collector adds, "It is vain to expect that education will flourish in such households, even if it were brought close to their doors, and were made free of cost. Far less will it succeed when it has to be sought in a village some five or six miles off, and on the other side of half a dozen unbridged rivers, and has moreover to be paid for." The central portion of the District, however, is an exception to these remarks. Nearly the whole of the Government and Aided Schools are contained in the small triangular tract situated between the Barisál, Ariál Khán, and Swarúpkátí rivers. This central oasis is rich in schools, and the Inspector reports it as one of the most forward educational tracts of East Bengal, both in the number of boys at school, and in the number of minor and vernacular scholarships which Barisál carries off. Barisál, too, supplies an unusually large number of pupils to the medical profession. The Barisál Government School is the largest in Eastern Bengal, and financially the most successful; the cost to Government in 1871 for its 355 pupils being only £31, 12s. In 1870, the cost to Government for the school, which then contained 347 pupils, amounted to £146, 7s. 4d.

The table opposite exhibits the number of State schools, the

[*Sentence continued on page* 236.]

RETURN OF GOVERNMENT AND AIDED SCHOOLS IN BÁKARGANJ DISTRICT FOR THE YEARS 1856–57, 1860–61, AND 1870–71.

Classification of Schools.	Number of Schools.			Number of Pupils.																	
				Hindus.			Muhammadans.			Others.			Total.			Cost to Government.			Fees and Local Subscriptions.			Total Cost.		
	1856–57.	1860–61.	1870–71.	1856–57.	1860–61.	1870–71.	1856–57.	1860–61.	1870–71.	1856–57.	1860–61.	1870–71.	1856–57.	1860–61.	1870–71.	1856–57	1860–61.	1870–71.	1856–57.	1860–61.	1870–71.	1856–57.	1860–61.	1870–71.
																£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.	£ s. d.
1. Government English School, .	1	1	1	220	283	313	23	24	28	2	1	6	245	308	347	56 4 10	251 17 4	146 7 4	371 6 9	305 14 3	730 10 7	427 11 7	557 11 7	876 17 11
2. Government Vernacular Schools,	...	...	3	...	...	40	...	...	61	...	...	...	...	...	101	...	...	71 1 4	...	...	3 14 10	...	...	74 16 2
3. Aided English Schools, . .	3	*2	25	200	Not given.	1146	11	Not given.	54	...	...	...	211	81	1200	50 9 0	Not given.	477 15 6	98 19 2	Not given.	954 18 0	150 8 11	Not given.	1492 5 7
4. Aided Vernacular Schools, . .	1	....	32	6	...	1306	20	...	100	...	...	4	26	...	1410	9 0 0	...	428 5 0	9 6 0	...	474 15 0	17 12 6	...	918 19 11
5. Aided Girls' Schools, . .	...	...	6	...	...	58	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	58	...	...	17 16 0	...	...	30 12 0	...	...	53 8 0
Total, . .	5	3	67	426	283	2863	54	24	243	2	1	10	482	389	3116	115 13 10	251 17 4	1141 5 2	479 11 11	305 14 3	2194 10 5	595 13 0	557 11 7	3416 7 7

* Details not given, only number of Schools and total number of Schools; no return of Expenditure.

number and creed
tion of the cost
school fees, subscr
1856–57, 1860–61,
ber of Government
to 67 in 1870–71,
same period. The
from £115, 13s. 1
while that derived
has increased in
£2194, 10s. 5d.
although forming n
tion, hold themselv
Only 243 Muham
Schools of Bákarga
amounted to 2863.
have been compile
Instruction for the

It must be remem
ment and Aided Sc
conducted by miss
tional Department.
359 pupils. The t
Education Departm
siderable number
spected by the De
can be given.

POSTAL STATIST
of service and pri
and despatched fr
receipts and expe
1870–71, illustrates
office. The receip
ratio, both having t
are the figures:—

STATEMENT OF LETTERS, NEWSPAPERS, &c., RECEIVED AT AND DESPATCHED FROM THE BÁKARGANJ POST-OFFICE, WITH POSTAL REVENUE AND EXPENDITURE FOR THE YEARS 1861-62, 1865-66, AND 1870-71.

	1861-62.	1865-66.	1870-71.
Service letters received,	16,285	13,744	... *
Private letters received,	51,618	61,561	...
Total letters received,	67,903	75,305	173,803
Service newspapers received,	706	507	...
Private newspapers received,	5993	7359	...
Total newspapers received,	6699	7866	15,177
Service parcels received,	1994	1268	...
Private parcels received,	308	252	...
Total parcels received,	2302	1520	6149
Books received,	869	1143	2477
Service letters despatched,	8356	10,204	... †
Private letters despatched,	48,934	66,168	...
Total letters despatched,	57,290	76,372	...
Service newspapers despatched,	*nil.*	*nil.*	...
Private newspapers despatched,	503	1072	...
Total parcels despatched,	645	1265	...
Books despatched,	86	152	...
Total post-office receipts,	£642 5 7	£1067 15 7	£1803 8 0
Total post-office charges,	399 8 11	548 6 9	1200 13 0

It will be observed that the total number of letters has nearly trebled during the ten years, and more than doubled during the last five of them. A similar progress appears in the total of newspapers received. In both cases the progress was slow at first, but very rapid during the subsequent years.

In the year 1866-67, the system of service stamps for all official communications and papers was introduced, and in 1870-71, the sale of these stamps amounted to £88, 12s. 4d.

* Service and private letters not shown separately, as all pay postage now.

† No return received of number of letters, newspapers, or books despatched during 1870-71.

Fiscal Divisions.—Materials do not exist showing the number of villages in former times, but in 1870 their number was estimated at 3056, containing, according to the rough census made at the time of the Revenue Survey, an average population of 272 souls each. The results of the Census of 1872 showed 4269 villages, containing an average population of 557 souls each. The Collector in 1871 returned the towns containing an estimated population of upwards of 2000 souls at nine in number, as follow:—Barisál, Nalchití, Jhálakátí or Maháráj ganj, Sáhibganj, Mádárípur, Kaliá Hát, Gangápur, Daulat Khán in the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur, and Khosnadí. The Census Report, however, disclosed no less than 137 towns or villages containing a population of upwards of 2000 souls. The Fiscal Divisions are fifty-four in number, and the following list, showing the area of each, number of estates it contains, amount of land revenue it pays, population, and the court to which it is subject, is compiled from the Board of Revenue's *Parganá* statistics of area, population, etc.

(1.) Abdullápur, area not known; comprises 3 estates; pays a Government land revenue of £356, 8s.; population not known; subject to the jurisdiction of the Subordinate Judge's Court at Daulat Khán in the island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur.

(2.) Ambarpur, area 2 acres; 1 estate; land revenue, 2s.; population, 25; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Daulat Khán.

(3.) Amírábád, area 40,457 acres, or 63·21 square miles; 1 estate; land revenue, £33, 12s.; population, 200; within the jurisdiction of the Subdivisional Court of Mádárípur.

(4.) Aurangpur, area 57,884 acres, or 90·44 square miles; 46 estates; land revenue, £4596, 6s.; population, 40,000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Patuákhálí.

(5.) Azímpur Tappá, area 16,178 acres, or 25·27 square miles; 47 estates; land revenue, £1083, 18s.; population, 2000; within the jurisdiction of the Mádárípur Court.

(6.) Bahádurpur Tappá, area 6321 acres, or 9·87 square miles; 4 estates; land revenue, £498; population, 6000; within the jurisdiction of the Courts at Barisál and Mádárípur.

(7.) Baikunthpur, area not known; 26 estates; land revenue, £23, 4s.; population not known; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Daulat Khán.

(8.) Bángrorá, area 77,046 acres, or 120·38 square miles; 949

estates; land rever
jurisdiction of the
(9.) Bikrampur,
land revenue, £3,
Mádárípur Court.
(10.) Bírmohan
285 estates; land
the jurisdiction of
(11.) Bírmohan
149 estates; land
the jurisdiction of
(12.) Bozargom
miles; 405 estates;
within the jurisdic
Pirozpur.
(13.) Chandra
miles; 133 estate
150,000; within
Barisál, and Daulat
(14.) Dakshín
square miles; 27
50,000; within the
(15.) Durdaná
1 estate; land re
jurisdiction of the
(16.) Durgápu
estates; land rev
jurisdiction of the
(17.) Fathijan
110 estates; land
the jurisdiction of
(18.) Gird Ba
estate; land reven
diction of the Baris
(19.) Habíbpur
estate; land rever
jurisdiction of the
(20.) Hayilf S
square miles; 13
20,000; within the

(21.) HAVILÍ TAPPÁ, area 3083 acres, or 4·81 square miles; 7 estates; land revenue, £112, 10s.; population, 5000; within the jurisdiction of the Barisál Court.

(22.) ISLAND, area 60,142 acres, or 93·97 square miles; 78 estates; land revenue, £3999, 6s.; population, 8000. Court not mentioned.

(23.) IDALPUR, area 155,387 acres, or 242·79 square miles; 502 estates; land revenue, £7977, 18s.; population, 104,000; within the jurisdiction of the Courts at Mádárípur and Daulat Khán.

(24.) IDRAKPUR, area 8667 acres, or 13·54 square miles; 63 estates; land revenue, £569, 10s.; population, 3000; within the jurisdiction of the Courts at Mádárípur and Patuákhálí.

(25.) ISWAR DATTA, area 5717 acres, or 8·93 square miles; 1 estate; land revenue, £442; population, 157; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Pirozpur.

(26.) JALÁLPUR, area 5542 acres, or 8·66 square milès; 5 estates; land revenue, £848, 10s.; population, 3000; within the jusisdictlon of the Court at Mádárípur.

(27.) JAHÁNPUR, area 5987 acres, or 9·35 square miles; 1 estate; land revenue, £85, 8s.; population, 1000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Mádárípur.

(28.) KÁDIRÁBÁD TAPPÁ, area 2164 acres, or 3·38 square miles; 2 estates; land revenue, £156, 4s.; population, 1000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Mádárípur.

(29.) KALMIR CHAR TARAF, area 1828 acres, or 2·85 square miles; 1 estate; land revenue, £184, 14s.; population, 2500; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Patuákhálí.

(30.) KÁSIMNAGAR, area 4691 acres, or 7·33 square miles; 1 estate; land revenue, £163, 8s.; population, 1000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Patuákhálí.

(31.) KÁSIMPUR SILÁPATI, area 3954 acres, or 6·17 square miles; 99 estates; land revenue, £812, 14s.; population, 5000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Mádárípur.

(32.) KHÁNJÁ BAHÁDURNAGAR, area 10,267 acres, or 16·04 square miles; 65 estates; land revenue, £747, 2s.; population, 5000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Patuákhálí.

(33.) KOTWÁLÍPÁRÁ, area 54,098 acres, or 84·52 square miles; 502 estates; land revenue, £244, 18s.; population, 25,000; within the jurisdiction of the Courts at Pirozpur and Mádárípur.

(34.) LAKSHMIRDIA TAPPÁ, area 15,717 acres, or 24·55 square

miles; 27 estates;
within the jurisdicti

(35.) MÁDÁRÍPUR
estates; land reven
jurisdiction of the

(36.) MAJARDÍ,
land revenue, £77,
the Court at Daulat

(37.) MURSHID
miles; 42 estates;
within the jurisdicti

(38.) NÁZÍRPUR
miles; 17 estates;
within the jurisdict
pur, and Daulat Kh

(39.) RÁJNAGAR,
land revenue, £85,
the Court at Daulat

(40.) RÁJ RÁJÍS
miles; 1 estate; la
the jurisdiction of t

(41.) RÁMNAGAR
estates; land reven
jurisdiction of the

(42.) RÁMPUR,
£2, 12s.; populati

(43.) RASÚLPUR,
estates; land reve
jurisdiction of the

(44.) RATANDÍ F
miles; 18 estates;
within the jurisdic
Daulat Khán.

(45.) SALÍMÁBÁD
74 estates; land
within the jurisdicti

(46.) SAYYIDPUR,
9 estates; land
within the jurisdicti

(47.) SHAFÍPUR KÁLÁ TAPPÁ, area 2048 acres, or 3·20 square miles; 86 estates; land revenue, £115, 10s.; population, 1400; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Mádárípur.

(48.) SHÁHZÁDPUR, area 13,407 acres, or 20·95 square miles; 37 estates; land revenue, £787, 16s.; population, 5000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Barisál.

(49.) SHÁISTÁBÁD, area 10,770 acres, or 15·82 square miles; 6 estates; land revenue, £203, 6s.; population, 5000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Barisál.

(50.) SHÁISTANAGAR, area 17,981 acres, or 28·09 square miles; 174 estates; land revenue, £1760, 14s.; population, 10,000; within the jurisdiction of the Courts at Barisál and Patuákhálí.

(51.) SRÍRÁMPUR, area 8167 acres, or 12·76 square miles; 137 estates; land revenue, £547, 6s.; population, 5000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Daulat Khán.

(52.) SULTÁNÁBÁD TAPPÁ, area 54,085 acres, or 84·50 square miles; 18 estates; land revenue, £2769, 18s.; population, 25,000; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Patuákhálí.

(53.) TELIHÁTÍ, area not known; 12 estates; land revenue, £7, 16s.; population not known; Court at Daulat Khán.

(54.) UTTAR SHÁHBÁZPUR, area 17,690 acres, or 27·64 square miles; 324 estates; land revenue, £1767, 16s.; population, 7500; within the jurisdiction of the Court at Daulat Khán.

TOTAL—area, 2,041,900 acres, or 3190·47 square miles; land revenue, £132,056, 12s.; population, 908,435 souls.

The above figures must be accepted with some degree of caution, as they are based upon the returns of a Survey, which was conducted some years ago. The estimates of population are invariably wrong, and must be doubled all round to make them approximate to anything like correctness. According to this list, there are six Fiscal Divisions, each with an area under one square mile, thirteen between one and ten square miles, seventeen between ten and fifty square miles, six between fifty and a hundred square miles, and eight above a hundred square miles. The above list of Fiscal Divisions does not, however, agree, either in names or numbers, with a return which has recently been prepared for me by the Collector of the District. This list gives the names of fifty-three Fiscal Divisions as follow:—(1) Abdullápur; (2) Alínagar Tappá; (3) Amírábád; (4) Amrápur; (5) Aurangpur;

(6) Azímpur Tappá; (7) Bahádurpur Tappá; (8) Baikunthpur; (9) Bángrorá; (10) Bikrampur; (11) Bírmohan; (12) Bírmohan Tappá; (13) Bozargomedpur; (14) Chandradwip; (15) Dakshín Sháhbázpur; (16) Durdaná Khánam; (17) Durgápur; (18) Fathijangpur; (19) Gird Bandar; (20) Gopálpur; (21) Habíbpur; (22) Havílí Salímábád; (23) Havílí; (24) Idalpur; (25) Idrakpur; (26) Jajirá; (27) Jalálpur; (28) Jahánpur; (29) Kadirábád Tappá; (30) Kasimnagar; (31) Kásimpur Silápatí; (32) Khánjá Bahádurnagar; (33) Kotwálípárá; (34) Krishnadebpur Tappá; (35) Lakshmírdiá Tappá; (36) Mádárípur; (37) Maijardí; (38) Murshid Kotwálí Jágír; (39) Názírpur Tappá; (40) Rájnagar; (41) Ráj Rájeswarpur; (42) Rámnagar; (43) Rasúlpur; (44) Ratandí Kálíkápur; (45) Salímábád; (46) Sayyidpur; (47) Shafípur Kálá; (48) Sháhzádpur; (49) Sháistábád; (50) Sháistánagar; (51) Srírámpur; (52) Sultánábád Tappá; and (53) Uttar Sháhbázpur.

Subdivisional Administration.—Bákarganj District is distributed into five Subdivisions. The principal, or headquarters, Subdivision of Barisál, which was established in May 1801, contained in 1870-71 eight Magisterial and Revenue Courts, and a total police force of 385 officers and men, besides 2622 village watchmen. The total cost of the subdivisional headquarters administration, including magisterial and revenue courts and police, amounted to £12,435. The Barisál headquarters comprise the five police circles (*thánás*) of Barisál, Jhálakátí, Nalchití, Bákarganj, and Mehndíganj. It contains an area of 964 square miles, 1232 villages or towns, 89,230 houses, and a total population of 711,180, of whom 360,800 are males and 350,380 females; proportion of males to total population, .50·7 per cent. The Muhammadans number 460,615, or 64·8 per cent.; the proportion of Musálmaṇ males to the total Muhammadan population being 50·9 per cent. The Hindus number 249,085, or 35 per cent.; the proportion of males to the total Hindu population being 50·4 per cent. The Buddhists only number 45 males. The Christians number 688 males and 695 females; total, 1383, or ·2 per cent. of the population; proportion of males to total Christian population, 49·1 per cent. Other denominations number only 52. Average density of population per square mile, 738; average number of houses per square mile, 93; average number of persons per house, 8.

The island of Dakshín Sháhbázpur was a Subdivision of Bákarganj

from the time when Bákarganj was erected into a separate District, up to 1822, when the island was separated and annexed to Noákhálí, and continued attached to that District till 1869. In this year it was re-transferred to Bákarganj, in accordance with a petition from the inhabitants of the island, who found the courts of Bákarganj nearer and readier of access than those of Noákhálí. In 1870–71 it contained 1 court, a regular police force of 75 officers and men, and a force of 482 village watchmen. The total cost of administering the Subdivision, including court, police, and village watch, amounted to £1525. Dakshín Sháhbázpur was created a separate administrative Subdivision in April 1845, when it formed part of Noákhálí District.

It comprises the two police circles (*thánás*) of Daulat Khán and Dhaniá Maniá, and contains, according to the Census of 1872, an area of 818 square miles, 345 villages, 23,715 houses, and a total population of 221,037, viz., 115,993 males and 105,044 females; proportion of males to total population, 52·5 per cent. The Muhammadans number 182,918, or 82·8 per cent. of the whole population of the Subdivision, the proportion of males to the Musalmán population being 51·9 per cent. The Hindus number 38,094, or 17·2 per cent. of the Subdivisional population; proportion of Hindu males to total Hindu population, 55·2 per cent. There are no Buddhists, and only one Christian is returned in the Subdivision, the number of people of other denominations being 24. Average density of population per square mile, 270; average number of persons per village, 640; average number of houses per square mile, 29; average number of persons per house, 9·3.

The Subdivision of Mádárípur, in the northern part of the District, was created on the 17th May 1854. At the end of 1870–71 it contained 1 court, a regular police force of 72 officers and men, and a village watch of 834 men. The total cost of the administration of the Subdivision, including court, police, and village police, amounted to £1662. It comprises the four police circles of Gaurnadí, Kotwálípárá, Mádárípur, and Mulfatganj, and contains, according to the Census of 1872, an area of 1070 square miles, 1334 villages, 81,144 houses, and a total population of 663,043 souls; namely, 325,005 males and 338,038 females; proportion of males to total population, 49 per cent. The Muhammadans number 360,085, or 54·3 per cent. of the Subdivisional population, the

proportion of Muhammadan males to the total Muhammadan population being 50·1 per cent. The Hindus number 299,540, or 45·2 per cent. of the Subdivisional population; proportion of Hindu males to total Hindu population, 47·7 per cent. Buddhists, *nil.*; Christians, 3375, or ·5 per cent. of the Subdivisional population; proportion of Christian males to total Christian population, 50·1 per cent. Other denominations only number 43. Average density of population, 620 per square mile; average number of inhabitants per village, 497; average number of houses per square mile, 76; average number of inmates per house, 8·2.

The Pirozpur Subdivision, in the east of Bákarganj, was created on the 28th October 1859. It contained in 1870–71, 1 Court, a regular police force of the strength of 69 officers and men, and a village watch of 755 men. The separate cost of administration for the Subdivision amounted to £1530. It comprises the three police circles of Kewárí, Pirozpur, and Mathbárí, and contains, according to the Census of 1872, an area of 626 square miles, 639 villages, 79,010 houses, and a total population of 363,426 souls—viz., 182,123 males, and 181,303 females; proportion of males to total population, 50·1 per cent. The Muhammadans number 199,104, or 54·8 per cent. of the Subdivisional population; proportion of Muhammadan males to the total Muhammadan population, 50·4. The Hindus number 164,277, or 45·2 per cent. of the Subdivisional population; proportion of Hindu males to total Hindu population, 49·8 per cent. Buddhists, *nil;* Christians, 31; and other denominations, 14. The average density of population is 581 per square mile; average number of inhabitants per village, 569; average number of houses per square mile, 126; average number of inmates per house, 4·6. The two Subdivisions of Mádárípur and Pirozpur were originally established with the object of suppressing river robberies, for which the Kachuá river was in former times notorious. The whole extent of country along this river was formerly unprotected, and hence great facilities were afforded to gangs of water-thieves. The establishment first of Pirozpur, and afterwards of Bágherhát Subdivision in the neighbouring District of Jessor, has had a very good effect in checking river robberies, and boats now travel up and down the Baleswar and Kachuá with much greater safety than they ever did before.

A new Subdivision, with its headquarters at Patuákhálí or Lankátí, was constituted on the 27th March 1867, with the intention

of bringing the distant southern tracts of the District within more easy access and control. I have no information as to the details of protection to person or property in this Subdivision, or its separate cost of administration. It comprises the four police circles of Bauphal, Mirzáganj, Gulsákhálí, and Khálsákhálí, and contains, according to the Census of 1872, an area of 1457 square miles, 719 villages, 48,558 houses, and a total population of 418,747 souls—viz., 220,316 males, and 198,431 females; proportion of males to total population, 52·6 per cent. The Muhammadans number 338,243, or 80·8 per cent. of the Subdivisional population; proportion of Muhammadan males to total Muhammadan population, 52 per cent. The Hindus number 76,397, and form 18·2 per cent. of the Subdivisional population; proportion of Hindu males to total Hindu population, 55·5 per cent. Nearly all the Buddhists of the District are found in this southern Subdivision, where they number 4004, or 1 per cent. of the Subdivisional population; proportion of Buddhist males to total Buddhists, 52·3 per cent. The Christians number 62, and other denominations 41. Average density of population, 287 per square mile; average number of persons per village, 582; average number of houses per square mile, 33; average number of inmates per house, 8·6. Mr Collector Sutherland, in his Report on the District, at page 146 of the "History and Statistics of the Dacca Division," states that from the rapid advance of cultivation and settlement of the Sundarbans, there can be no doubt that in the course of a few years another separate jurisdiction will have to be created in the southern tracts of Bákarganj and the Sundarbans.

CLIMATE.—The climate of Bákarganj is said to be one of the healthiest in Eastern Bengal, owing to the strong south-west monsoon, which comes up fresh from the Bay of Bengal, and keeps the atmosphere cool; although the heavy rainfall and consequent humidity of the atmosphere, combined with the use of bad water, act as sources of disease. The average annual temperature is from 78° minimum to 85° maximum. The range of the thermometer is from 62° to 98°. In 1871 the average temperature in the cold weather was 67°·8, and in the hot weather 78°·8. The rainfall in 1871 is returned at 96·24 inches at the Civil Station of Barisál, and at 112·96 inches at Daulat Khán.

CONSERVANCY.—The water-supply of the District is very bad. Most of the people use tank-water for drinking and cooking, and

these reservoirs, instead of being carefully kept clean, are used for washing, and for a variety of other purposes, and always contain a quantity of rank vegetation. No system is enforced for keeping the tanks free from the vilest pollutions, nor is there any attempt to regulate the public latrines, or preserve cleanliness. In the town of Barisál the river scours out the drains once a fortnight at spring tides, when most of the offal and refuse is washed away. Some attempt at municipal conservancy was commenced in 1871, and it is hoped that a better system will gradually be introduced.

DISEASES.—The endemic diseases of Bákarganj are fevers of the intermittent, remittent, and continued types, which are all attributable to the extreme dampness and malarious nature of the District. Repeated attacks of fever generally terminate in organic complications of the spleen and liver. Cholera may be also classed among the endemic diseases, as it is always present. The cases increase in number in the hot season and at the beginning of the cold weather. The Civil Surgeon states, that as far as he can learn, there was no attempt at sanitation or drainage in any part of the District until 1870, when orders were issued to clear the low jungle from about the inhabited localities. Cholera occasionally assumes an epidemic character, spreading from village to village, and causing great panic. Small-pox also occasionally makes its appearance in an epidemic form, frequently caused from the system of inoculation, which is practised to a great extent in Bákarganj by the native medical practitioners or *kabirájs*. No epidemic fever has made its appearance in the District for several years past. Cattle disease has been very prevalent during the last few years, and has caused great damage. The natives call the disease *guti*, or cattle small-pox, but the Civil Surgeon is of opinion, judging from the cases brought before him, that the disease was of a type resembling typhus fever. The symptoms seemed to him to point to that disease, and were attended at times with organic complications. *Petichæ* also appear on the skin, which has probably been the cause of the disease being mistaken for cow-pox. The Civil Surgeon states that the probable cause of the cattle-epidemic is the want of attention to the cattle-sheds, which are never cleaned until the whole floor becomes a putrid mud. *Vide* Dacca District.

FAIRS AND RELIGIOUS GATHERINGS.—The five principal fairs in the District are held at the following places:—Lákhutía, about six

miles westward of the town; Bánarípárá, twenty miles west of Barisál; Kulsokátí, about twenty miles south-east of Barisál; Jhálakátí, about twelve miles south; and Pirozpur, the head-quarters of the Subdivision of the same name, about thirty-five miles south-east of Barisál. The three first-named fairs are held in the month of November, the fourth in October, and the fifth in March. The Civil Surgeon reports that none of them has, strictly speaking, any exclusive object of adoration, but are really gatherings for the purposes of amusement, and the interchange of commodities. The largest of these fairs are attended by from five to six thousand persons, and are occasionally visited by outbreaks of cholera, caused by the absence of any sanitary arrangements.

NATIVE PRACTITIONERS.—There are no really good *kabirájs* or native medical practitioners in Bákarganj. The best of them seem to classify all diseases as originating from one of three causes, or from a combination of them, viz., *bái*, or wind; *pitta*, or bile; and *kaph*, or phlegm. In cases of fever their treatment is generally a combination of the following drugs:—*Kát karanjá* (cæsalpinia bonduc), *bhánt* (clerodendron viscosum), *gulanchá* (coculus cordifolia), *khet-páprá* (Oldenlandia beflora), and *akúrkorá* (anthemis pyrethrum). In cases of dysentery or diarrhœa, they administer the following:—*Bel* (ægle marmelos), *kurchi* (Wrightia antidysenterica), *bháng* (cannabis indica), *muthá* (cyperus pertenius), *báblá* (acacia arabica), *ámlá* (emblica officinalis), *mádár* (calotropis gigantia). For coughs the following drugs are given:—*Pipul* (piper longnum), *áddá* (zinziber officinalis), *bábui tulsí* (ocymum basilicum), *bach* (zinziber zerumbit), *bákas* (adhatoda vasica). For the scientific names I trust to the Civil Surgeon. The more intelligent native practitioners have now begun to use drugs from other parts of India, and even from Europe. Many of them employ quinine largely in fevers.

CHARITABLE DISPENSARIES.—The medical charities of Bákarganj consist of a hospital and dispensary at Barisál town, a branch dispensary at Pirozpur, and another branch dispensary at Mádárípur. The Barisál dispensary was established in 1847, and is under the charge of a native Sub-Assistant Surgeon. It is a large masonry building, well raised and ventilated. The hospital consists of a long central ward, with two verandah-rooms for female patients, and a room for seeing out-patients and dispensing medicines. A sum of £400 has recently been presented by Khwájá Abdul Ganí, C.S.I., a wealthy landholder, for the purpose of building a female ward, which